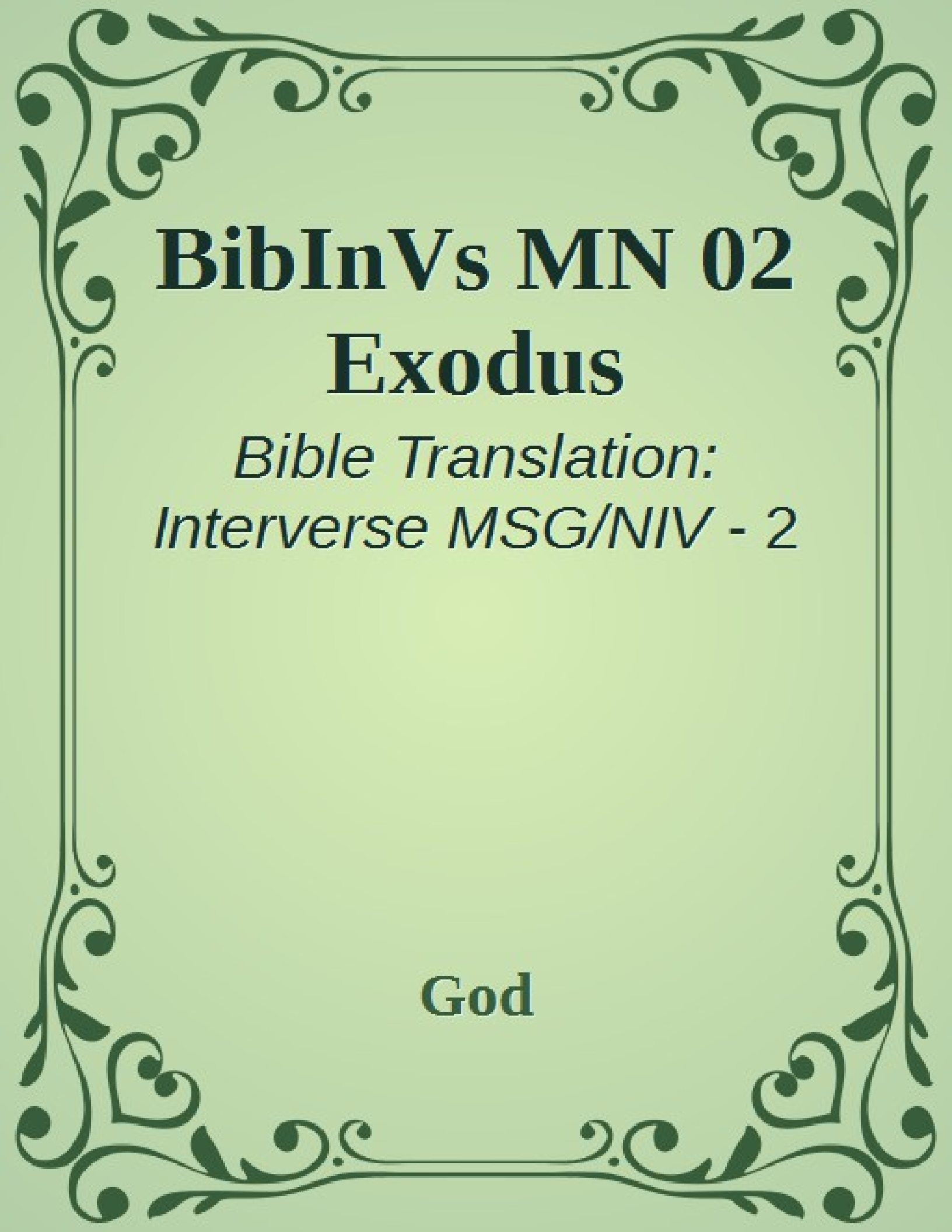


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 02

Exodus

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 2*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Exodus

Exodus 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 These are the names of the Israelites who went to Egypt with Jacob, each bringing his family members:
- 1 These are the names of the sons of Israel who went to Egypt with Jacob, each with his family:
 - 2 Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah,
 - 2 Reuben, Simeon, Levi and Judah;
 - 3 Issachar, Zebulun, and Benjamin,
 - 3 Issachar, Zebulun and Benjamin;
 - 4 Dan and Naphtali, Gad and Asher.
 - 4 Dan and Naphtali; Gad and Asher.
- 5 Seventy persons in all generated by Jacob's seed. Joseph was already in Egypt.
- 5 The descendants of Jacob numbered seventy in all; Joseph was already in Egypt.
- 6 Then Joseph died, and all his brothers--that whole generation.
- 6 Now Joseph and all his brothers and all that generation died,
- 7 But the children of Israel kept on reproducing. They were very prolific--a population explosion in their own right--and the land was filled with them.
- 7 but the Israelites were fruitful and multiplied greatly and became exceedingly numerous, so that the land was filled with them.
- 8 A new king came to power in Egypt who didn't know Joseph.
- 8 Then a new king, who did not know about Joseph, came to power in Egypt.
- 9 He spoke to his people in alarm, "There are way too many of these Israelites for us to handle.

- 9 Look, he said to his people, "the Israelites have become much too numerous for us.
- 10 We've got to do something: Let's devise a plan to contain them, lest if there's a war they should join our enemies, or just walk off and leave us."
- 10 Come, we must deal shrewdly with them or they will become even more numerous and, if war breaks out, will join our enemies, fight against us and leave the country."
- 11 So they organized them into work-gangs and put them to hard labor under gang-foremen. They built the storage cities Pithom and Rameses for Pharaoh.
- 11 So they put slave masters over them to oppress them with forced labor, and they built Pithom and Rameses as store cities for Pharaoh.
- 12 But the harder the Egyptians worked them the more children the Israelites had--children everywhere! The Egyptians got so they couldn't stand the Israelites
- 12 But the more they were oppressed, the more they multiplied and spread; so the Egyptians came to dread the Israelites
- 13 and treated them worse than ever, crushing them with slave labor.
- 13 and worked them ruthlessly.
- 14 They made them miserable with hard labor--making bricks and mortar and back-breaking work in the fields. They piled on the work, crushing them under the cruel workload.
- 14 They made their lives bitter with hard labor in brick and mortar and with all kinds of work in the fields; in all their hard labor the Egyptians used them ruthlessly.
- 15 The king of Egypt had a talk with the two Hebrew midwives; one was named Shiphrah and the other Puah.
- 15 The king of Egypt said to the Hebrew midwives, whose names were Shiphrah and Puah,
- 16 He said, "When you deliver the Hebrew women, look at the sex of the baby. If it's a boy, kill him; if it's a girl, let her live."
- 16 When you help the Hebrew women in childbirth and observe them on the delivery stool, if it is a boy, kill him; but if it is a girl, let her live.
- 17 But the midwives had far too much respect for God and didn't do what the king of Egypt ordered; they let the boy babies live.

- 17 The midwives, however, feared God and did not do what the king of Egypt had told them to do; they let the boys live.
- 18 The king of Egypt called in the midwives. "Why didn't you obey my orders? You've let those babies live!"
- 18 Then the king of Egypt summoned the midwives and asked them, "Why have you done this? Why have you let the boys live?"
- 19 The midwives answered Pharaoh, "The Hebrew women aren't like the Egyptian women; they're vigorous. Before the midwife can get there, they've already had the baby."
- 19 The midwives answered Pharaoh, "Hebrew women are not like Egyptian women; they are vigorous and give birth before the midwives arrive."
- 20 God was pleased with the midwives. The people continued to increase in number--a very strong people.
- 20 So God was kind to the midwives and the people increased and became even more numerous.
- 21 And because the midwives honored God, God gave them families of their own.
- 21 And because the midwives feared God, he gave them families of their own.
- 22 So Pharaoh issued a general order to all his people: "Every boy that is born, drown him in the Nile. But let the girls live."
- 22 Then Pharaoh gave this order to all his people: "Every boy that is born you must throw into the Nile, but let every girl live."

Exodus 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 A man from the family of Levi married a Levite woman.
- 1 Now a man of the house of Levi married a Levite woman,
- 2 The woman became pregnant and had a son. She saw there was something special about him and hid him. She hid him for three months.
- 2 and she became pregnant and gave birth to a son. When she saw that he was a fine child, she hid him for three months.

- 3 When she couldn't hide him any longer she got a little basket-boat made of papyrus, waterproofed it with tar and pitch, and placed the child in it. Then she set it afloat in the reeds at the edge of the Nile.
- 3 But when she could hide him no longer, she got a papyrus basket for him and coated it with tar and pitch. Then she placed the child in it and put it among the reeds along the bank of the Nile.
- 4 The baby's older sister found herself a vantage point a little way off and watched to see what would happen to him.
- 4 His sister stood at a distance to see what would happen to him.
- 5 Pharaoh's daughter came down to the Nile to bathe; her maidens strolled on the bank. She saw the basket-boat floating in the reeds and sent her maid to get it.
- 5 Then Pharaoh's daughter went down to the Nile to bathe, and her attendants were walking along the river bank. She saw the basket among the reeds and sent her slave girl to get it.
- 6 She opened it and saw the child--a baby crying! Her heart went out to him. She said, "This must be one of the Hebrew babies."
- 6 She opened it and saw the baby. He was crying, and she felt sorry for him. "This is one of the Hebrew babies," she said.
- 7 Then his sister was before her: "Do you want me to go and get a nursing mother from the Hebrews so she can nurse the baby for you?"
- 7 Then his sister asked Pharaoh's daughter, "Shall I go and get one of the Hebrew women to nurse the baby for you?"
- 8 Pharaoh's daughter said, "Yes. Go." The girl went and called the child's mother.
- 8 Yes, go, she answered. And the girl went and got the baby's mother.
- 9 Pharaoh's daughter told her, "Take this baby and nurse him for me. I'll pay you." The woman took the child and nursed him.
- 9 Pharaoh's daughter said to her, "Take this baby and nurse him for me, and I will pay you." So the woman took the baby and nursed him.
- 10 After the child was weaned, she presented him to Pharaoh's daughter who adopted him as her son. She named him Moses (Pulled-Out), saying, "I pulled him out of the water."
- 10 When the child grew older, she took him to Pharaoh's daughter and he became her son. She named him Moses, saying, "I drew him out of the water."

- 11 Time passed. Moses grew up. One day he went and saw his brothers, saw all that hard labor. Then he saw an Egyptian hit a Hebrew--one of his relatives!
- 11 One day, after Moses had grown up, he went out to where his own people were and watched them at their hard labor. He saw an Egyptian beating a Hebrew, one of his own people.
- 12 He looked this way and then that; when he realized there was no one in sight, he killed the Egyptian and buried him in the sand.
- 12 Glancing this way and that and seeing no one, he killed the Egyptian and hid him in the sand.
- 13 The next day he went out there again. Two Hebrew men were fighting. He spoke to the man who started it: "Why are you hitting your neighbor?"
- 13 The next day he went out and saw two Hebrews fighting. He asked the one in the wrong, "Why are you hitting your fellow Hebrew?"
- 14 The man shot back: "Who do you think you are, telling us what to do? Are you going to kill me the way you killed that Egyptian?" Then Moses panicked: "Word's gotten out--people know about this."
- 14 The man said, "Who made you ruler and judge over us? Are you thinking of killing me as you killed the Egyptian?" Then Moses was afraid and thought, "What I did must have become known."
- 15 Pharaoh heard about it and tried to kill Moses, but Moses got away to the land of Midian. He sat down by a well.
- 15 When Pharaoh heard of this, he tried to kill Moses, but Moses fled from Pharaoh and went to live in Midian, where he sat down by a well.
- 16 The priest of Midian had seven daughters. They came and drew water, filling the troughs and watering their father's sheep.
- 16 Now a priest of Midian had seven daughters, and they came to draw water and fill the troughs to water their father's flock.
- 17 When some shepherds came and chased the girls off, Moses came to their rescue and helped them water their sheep.
- 17 Some shepherds came along and drove them away, but Moses got up and came to their rescue and watered their flock.
- 18 When they got home to their father, Reuel, he said, "That didn't take long. Why are you back so soon?"

- 18 When the girls returned to Reuel their father, he asked them, "Why have you returned so early today?"
- 19 "An Egyptian," they said, "rescued us from a bunch of shepherds. Why, he even drew water for us and watered the sheep."
- 19 They answered, "An Egyptian rescued us from the shepherds. He even drew water for us and watered the flock."
- 20 He said, "So where is he? Why did you leave him behind? Invite him so he can have something to eat with us."
- 20 And where is he? he asked his daughters. "Why did you leave him? Invite him to have something to eat."
- 21 Moses agreed to settle down there with the man, who then gave his daughter Zipporah (Bird) to him for his wife.
- 21 Moses agreed to stay with the man, who gave his daughter Zipporah to Moses in marriage.
- 22 She had a son, and Moses named him Gershom (Sojourner), saying, "I'm a sojourner in a foreign country."
- 22 Zipporah gave birth to a son, and Moses named him Gershom, saying, "I have become an alien in a foreign land."
- 23 Many years later the king of Egypt died. The Israelites groaned under their slavery and cried out. Their cries for relief from their hard labor ascended to God:
- 23 During that long period, the king of Egypt died. The Israelites groaned in their slavery and cried out, and their cry for help because of their slavery went up to God.
- 24 God listened to their groanings. God remembered his covenant with Abraham, with Isaac, and with Jacob.
- 24 God heard their groaning and he remembered his covenant with Abraham, with Isaac and with Jacob.
- 25 God saw what was going on with Israel. God understood.
- 25 So God looked on the Israelites and was concerned about them.

Exodus 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Moses was shepherding the flock of Jethro, his father-in-law, the priest of Midian. He led the flock to the west end of the wilderness and came to the mountain of God, Horeb.
- 1 Now Moses was tending the flock of Jethro his father-in-law, the priest of Midian, and he led the flock to the far side of the desert and came to Horeb, the mountain of God.
- 2 The angel of GOD appeared to him in flames of fire blazing out of the middle of a bush. He looked. The bush was blazing away but it didn't burn up.
- 2 There the angel of the LORD appeared to him in flames of fire from within a bush. Moses saw that though the bush was on fire it did not burn up.
- 3 Moses said, "What's going on here? I can't believe this! Amazing! Why doesn't the bush burn up?"
- 3 So Moses thought, "I will go over and see this strange sight--why the bush does not burn up."
- 4 GOD saw that he had stopped to look. God called to him from out of the bush, "Moses! Moses!" He said, "Yes? I'm right here!"
- 4 When the LORD saw that he had gone over to look, God called to him from within the bush, "Moses! Moses!" And Moses said, "Here I am."
- 5 God said, "Don't come any closer. Remove your sandals from your feet. You're standing on holy ground."
- 5 Do not come any closer, God said. "Take off your sandals, for the place where you are standing is holy ground."
- 6 Then he said, "I am the God of your father: The God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, the God of Jacob." Moses hid his face, afraid to look at God.
- 6 Then he said, "I am the God of your father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob." At this, Moses hid his face, because he was afraid to look at God.
- 7 GOD said, "I've taken a good, long look at the affliction of my people in Egypt. I've heard their cries for deliverance from their slave masters; I know all about their pain.
- 7 The LORD said, "I have indeed seen the misery of my people in Egypt. I have heard them crying out because of their slave drivers, and I am concerned about their suffering.

- 8 And now I have come down to help them, pry them loose from the grip of Egypt, get them out of that country and bring them to a good land with wide-open spaces, a land lush with milk and honey, the land of the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite.
- 8 So I have come down to rescue them from the hand of the Egyptians and to bring them up out of that land into a good and spacious land, a land flowing with milk and honey--the home of the Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Perizzites, Hivites and Jebusites.
- 9 "The Israelite cry for help has come to me, and I've seen for myself how cruelly they're being treated by the Egyptians.
- 9 And now the cry of the Israelites has reached me, and I have seen the way the Egyptians are oppressing them.
- 10 It's time for you to go back: I'm sending you to Pharaoh to bring my people, the People of Israel, out of Egypt."
- 10 So now, go. I am sending you to Pharaoh to bring my people the Israelites out of Egypt."
- 11 Moses answered God, "But why me? What makes you think that I could ever go to Pharaoh and lead the children of Israel out of Egypt?"
- 11 But Moses said to God, "Who am I, that I should go to Pharaoh and bring the Israelites out of Egypt?"
- 12 "I'll be with you," God said. "And this will be the proof that I am the one who sent you: When you have brought my people out of Egypt, you will worship God right here at this very mountain."
- 12 And God said, "I will be with you. And this will be the sign to you that it is I who have sent you: When you have brought the people out of Egypt, you will worship God on this mountain."
- 13 Then Moses said to God, "Suppose I go to the People of Israel and I tell them, 'The God of your fathers sent me to you'; and they ask me, 'What is his name?' What do I tell them?"
- 13 Moses said to God, "Suppose I go to the Israelites and say to them, 'The God of your fathers has sent me to you,' and they ask me, 'What is his name?' Then what shall I tell them?"
- 14 God said to Moses, "I-AM-WHO-I-AM. Tell the People of Israel, 'I-AM sent me to you.'"

- 14 God said to Moses, "I AM WHO I AM. This is what you are to say to the Israelites: 'I AM has sent me to you.' "
- 15 God continued with Moses: "This is what you're to say to the Israelites: 'GOD, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob sent me to you.' This has always been my name, and this is how I always will be known.
- 15 God also said to Moses, "Say to the Israelites, 'The LORD, the God of your fathers--the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob--has sent me to you.' This is my name forever, the name by which I am to be remembered from generation to generation.
- 16 "Now be on your way. Gather the leaders of Israel. Tell them, 'GOD, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, appeared to me, saying, 'I've looked into what's being done to you in Egypt,
- 16 Go, assemble the elders of Israel and say to them, 'The LORD, the God of your fathers--the God of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob-- appeared to me and said: I have watched over you and have seen what has been done to you in Egypt.
- 17 and I've determined to get you out of the affliction of Egypt and take you to the land of the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite, a land brimming over with milk and honey.'"
- 17 And I have promised to bring you up out of your misery in Egypt into the land of the Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Perizzites, Hivites and Jebusites--a land flowing with milk and honey.'
- 18 "Believe me, they will listen to you. Then you and the leaders of Israel will go to the king of Egypt and say to him: 'GOD, the God of the Hebrews, has met with us. Let us take a three-day journey into the wilderness where we will worship GOD--our God.'
- 18 The elders of Israel will listen to you. Then you and the elders are to go to the king of Egypt and say to him, 'The LORD, the God of the Hebrews, has met with us. Let us take a three-day journey into the desert to offer sacrifices to the LORD our God.'
- 19 "I know that the king of Egypt won't let you go unless forced to,
- 19 But I know that the king of Egypt will not let you go unless a mighty hand compels him.
- 20 so I'll intervene and hit Egypt where it hurts--oh, my miracles will send them reeling!--after which they'll be glad to send you off.

- 20 So I will stretch out my hand and strike the Egyptians with all the wonders that I will perform among them. After that, he will let you go.
- 21 I'll see to it that this people get a hearty send-off by the Egyptians--when you leave, you won't leave empty-handed!
- 21 And I will make the Egyptians favorably disposed toward this people, so that when you leave you will not go empty-handed.
- 22 Each woman will ask her neighbor and any guests in her house for objects of silver and gold, for jewelry and extra clothes; you'll put them on your sons and daughters. Oh, you'll clean the Egyptians out!"
- 22 Every woman is to ask her neighbor and any woman living in her house for articles of silver and gold and for clothing, which you will put on your sons and daughters. And so you will plunder the Egyptians."

Exodus 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Moses objected, "They won't trust me. They won't listen to a word I say. They're going to say, 'GOD? Appear to him? Hardly!'"
- 1 Moses answered, "What if they do not believe me or listen to me and say, 'The LORD did not appear to you?'"
- 2 So GOD said, "What's that in your hand?" "A staff."
- 2 Then the LORD said to him, "What is that in your hand?" "A staff," he replied.
- 3 "Throw it on the ground." He threw it. It became a snake; Moses jumped back--fast!
- 3 The LORD said, "Throw it on the ground." Moses threw it on the ground and it became a snake, and he ran from it.
- 4 GOD said to Moses, "Reach out and grab it by the tail." He reached out and grabbed it--and he was holding his staff again.
- 4 Then the LORD said to him, "Reach out your hand and take it by the tail." So Moses reached out and took hold of the snake and it turned back into a staff in his hand.
- 5 "That's so they will trust that GOD appeared to you, the God of their fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob."

- 5 This, said the LORD, "is so that they may believe that the LORD, the God of their fathers--the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob--has appeared to you."
- 6 GOD then said, "Put your hand inside your shirt." He slipped his hand under his shirt, then took it out. His hand had turned leprous, like snow.
- 6 Then the LORD said, "Put your hand inside your cloak." So Moses put his hand into his cloak, and when he took it out, it was leprous, like snow.
- 7 He said, "Put your hand back under your shirt." He did it, then took it back out--as healthy as before.
- 7 Now put it back into your cloak, he said. So Moses put his hand back into his cloak, and when he took it out, it was restored, like the rest of his flesh.
- 8 "So if they don't trust you and aren't convinced by the first sign, the second sign should do it.
- 8 Then the LORD said, "If they do not believe you or pay attention to the first miraculous sign, they may believe the second.
- 9 But if it doesn't, if even after these two signs they don't trust you and listen to your message, take some water out of the Nile and pour it out on the dry land; the Nile water that you pour out will turn to blood when it hits the ground."
- 9 But if they do not believe these two signs or listen to you, take some water from the Nile and pour it on the dry ground. The water you take from the river will become blood on the ground."
- 10 Moses raised another objection to GOD: "Master, please, I don't talk well. I've never been good with words, neither before nor after you spoke to me. I stutter and stammer."
- 10 Moses said to the LORD, "O Lord, I have never been eloquent, neither in the past nor since you have spoken to your servant. I am slow of speech and tongue."
- 11 GOD said, "And who do you think made the human mouth? And who makes some mute, some deaf, some sighted, some blind? Isn't it I, GOD?
- 11 The LORD said to him, "Who gave man his mouth? Who makes him deaf or mute? Who gives him sight or makes him blind? Is it not I, the LORD?

- 12 So, get going. I'll be right there with you--with your mouth! I'll be right there to teach you what to say."
- 12 Now go; I will help you speak and will teach you what to say."
- 13 He said, "Oh, Master, please! Send somebody else!"
- 13 But Moses said, "O Lord, please send someone else to do it."
- 14 GOD got angry with Moses: "Don't you have a brother, Aaron the Levite? He's good with words, I know he is. He speaks very well. In fact, at this very moment he's on his way to meet you. When he sees you he's going to be glad.
- 14 Then the LORD's anger burned against Moses and he said, "What about your brother, Aaron the Levite? I know he can speak well. He is already on his way to meet you, and his heart will be glad when he sees you.
- 15 You'll speak to him and tell him what to say. I'll be right there with you as you speak and with him as he speaks, teaching you step by step.
- 15 You shall speak to him and put words in his mouth; I will help both of you speak and will teach you what to do.
- 16 He will speak to the people for you. He'll act as your mouth, but you'll decide what comes out of it.
- 16 He will speak to the people for you, and it will be as if he were your mouth and as if you were God to him.
- 17 Now take this staff in your hand; you'll use it to do the signs."
- 17 But take this staff in your hand so you can perform miraculous signs with it."
- 18 Moses went back to Jethro his father-in-law and said, "I need to return to my relatives who are in Egypt. I want to see if they're still alive." Jethro said, "Go. And peace be with you."
- 18 Then Moses went back to Jethro his father-in-law and said to him, "Let me go back to my own people in Egypt to see if any of them are still alive." Jethro said, "Go, and I wish you well."
- 19 GOD said to Moses in Midian: "Go. Return to Egypt. All the men who wanted to kill you are dead."
- 19 Now the LORD had said to Moses in Midian, "Go back to Egypt, for all the men who wanted to kill you are dead."
- 20 So Moses took his wife and sons and put them on a donkey for the return trip to Egypt. He had a firm grip on the staff of God.

20 So Moses took his wife and sons, put them on a donkey and started back to Egypt. And he took the staff of God in his hand.

21 GOD said to Moses, "When you get back to Egypt, be prepared: All the wonders that I will do through you, you'll do before Pharaoh. But I will make him stubborn so that he will refuse to let the people go.

21 The LORD said to Moses, "When you return to Egypt, see that you perform before Pharaoh all the wonders I have given you the power to do. But I will harden his heart so that he will not let the people go.

22 Then you are to tell Pharaoh, 'GOD's Message: Israel is my son, my firstborn!

22 Then say to Pharaoh, 'This is what the LORD says: Israel is my firstborn son,

23 I told you, "Free my son so that he can serve me." But you refused to free him. So now I'm going to kill your son, your firstborn.'"

23 and I told you, "Let my son go, so he may worship me." But you refused to let him go; so I will kill your firstborn son.' "

24 On the journey back, as they camped for the night, GOD met Moses and would have killed him but

24 At a lodging place on the way, the LORD met Moses and was about to kill him.

25 Zipporah took a flint knife and cut off her son's foreskin, and touched Moses' member with it. She said, "Oh! You're a bridegroom of blood to me!"

25 But Zipporah took a flint knife, cut off her son's foreskin and touched Moses' feet with it. "Surely you are a bridegroom of blood to me," she said.

26 Then GOD let him go. She used the phrase "bridegroom of blood" because of the circumcision.

26 So the LORD let him alone. (At that time she said "bridegroom of blood," referring to circumcision.)

27 GOD spoke to Aaron, "Go and meet Moses in the wilderness." He went and met him at the mountain of God and kissed him.

27 The LORD said to Aaron, "Go into the desert to meet Moses." So he met Moses at the mountain of God and kissed him.

28 Moses told Aaron the message that GOD had sent him to speak and the wonders he had commanded him to do.

- 28 Then Moses told Aaron everything the LORD had sent him to say, and also about all the miraculous signs he had commanded him to perform.
- 29 So Moses and Aaron proceeded to round up all the leaders of Israel.
- 29 Moses and Aaron brought together all the elders of the Israelites,
- 30 Aaron told them everything that GOD had told Moses and demonstrated the wonders before the people.
- 30 and Aaron told them everything the LORD had said to Moses. He also performed the signs before the people,
- 31 And the people trusted and listened believingly that GOD was concerned with what was going on with the Israelites and knew all about their affliction. They bowed low and they worshiped.
- 31 and they believed. And when they heard that the LORD was concerned about them and had seen their misery, they bowed down and worshiped.

Exodus 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 After that Moses and Aaron approached Pharaoh. They said, "GOD, the God of Israel, says, 'Free my people so that they can hold a festival for me in the wilderness.'"
- 1 Afterward Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and said, "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Let my people go, so that they may hold a festival to me in the desert.' "
- 2 Pharaoh said, "And who is GOD that I should listen to him and send Israel off? I know nothing of this so-called 'GOD' and I'm certainly not going to send Israel off."
- 2 Pharaoh said, "Who is the LORD, that I should obey him and let Israel go? I do not know the LORD and I will not let Israel go."
- 3 They said, "The God of the Hebrews has met with us. Let us take a three-day journey into the wilderness so we can worship our GOD lest he strike us with either disease or death."
- 3 Then they said, "The God of the Hebrews has met with us. Now let us take a three-day journey into the desert to offer sacrifices to the LORD our God, or he may strike us with plagues or with the sword."

- 4 But the king of Egypt said, "Why on earth, Moses and Aaron, would you suggest the people be given a holiday? Back to work!"
- 4 But the king of Egypt said, "Moses and Aaron, why are you taking the people away from their labor? Get back to your work!"
- 5 Pharaoh went on, "Look, I've got all these people bumming around, and now you want to reward them with time off?"
- 5 Then Pharaoh said, "Look, the people of the land are now numerous, and you are stopping them from working."
- 6 Pharaoh took immediate action. He sent down orders to the slave-drivers and their underlings:
- 6 That same day Pharaoh gave this order to the slave drivers and foremen in charge of the people:
- 7 "Don't provide straw for the people for making bricks as you have been doing. Make them get their own straw.
- 7 You are no longer to supply the people with straw for making bricks; let them go and gather their own straw.
- 8 And make them produce the same number of bricks--no reduction in their daily quotas! They're getting lazy. They're going around saying, 'Give us time off so we can worship our God.'
- 8 But require them to make the same number of bricks as before; don't reduce the quota. They are lazy; that is why they are crying out, 'Let us go and sacrifice to our God.'
- 9 Crack down on them. That'll cure them of their whining, their god-fantasies."
- 9 Make the work harder for the men so that they keep working and pay no attention to lies."
- 10 The slave-drivers and their underlings went out to the people with their new instructions. "Pharaoh's orders: No more straw provided.
- 10 Then the slave drivers and the foremen went out and said to the people, "This is what Pharaoh says: 'I will not give you any more straw.
- 11 Get your own straw wherever you can find it. And not one brick less in your daily work quota!"
- 11 Go and get your own straw wherever you can find it, but your work will not be reduced at all.' "
- 12 The people scattered all over Egypt scrabbling for straw.
- 12 So the people scattered all over Egypt to gather stubble to use for straw.

- 13 The slave-drivers were merciless, saying, "Complete your daily quota of bricks--the same number as when you were given straw."
- 13 The slave drivers kept pressing them, saying, "Complete the work required of you for each day, just as when you had straw."
- 14 The Israelite foremen whom the slave-drivers had appointed were beaten and badgered. "Why didn't you finish your quota of bricks yesterday or the day before--and now again today!"
- 14 The Israelite foremen appointed by Pharaoh's slave drivers were beaten and were asked, "Why didn't you meet your quota of bricks yesterday or today, as before?"
- 15 The Israelite foremen came to Pharaoh and cried out for relief: "Why are you treating your servants like this?"
- 15 Then the Israelite foremen went and appealed to Pharaoh: "Why have you treated your servants this way?"
- 16 Nobody gives us any straw and they tell us, 'Make bricks!' Look at us--we're being beaten. And it's not our fault."
- 16 Your servants are given no straw, yet we are told, 'Make bricks!' Your servants are being beaten, but the fault is with your own people."
- 17 But Pharaoh said, "Lazy! That's what you are! Lazy! That's why you whine, 'Let us go so we can worship GOD.'"
- 17 Pharaoh said, "Lazy, that's what you are--lazy! That is why you keep saying, 'Let us go and sacrifice to the LORD.'"
- 18 Well then, go--go back to work. Nobody's going to give you straw, and at the end of the day you better bring in your full quota of bricks."
- 18 Now get to work. You will not be given any straw, yet you must produce your full quota of bricks."
- 19 The Israelite foremen saw that they were in a bad way, having to go back and tell their workers, "Not one brick short in your daily quota."
- 19 The Israelite foremen realized they were in trouble when they were told, "You are not to reduce the number of bricks required of you for each day."
- 20 As they left Pharaoh, they found Moses and Aaron waiting to meet them.
- 20 When they left Pharaoh, they found Moses and Aaron waiting to meet them,

- 21 The foremen said to them, "May GOD see what you've done and judge you--you've made us stink before Pharaoh and his servants! You've put a weapon in his hand that's going to kill us!"
- 21 and they said, "May the LORD look upon you and judge you! You have made us a stench to Pharaoh and his officials and have put a sword in their hand to kill us."
- 22 Moses went back to GOD and said, "My Master, why are you treating this people so badly? And why did you ever send me?"
- 22 Moses returned to the LORD and said, "O Lord, why have you brought trouble upon this people? Is this why you sent me?"
- 23 From the moment I came to Pharaoh to speak in your name, things have only gotten worse for this people. And rescue? Does this look like rescue to you?"
- 23 Ever since I went to Pharaoh to speak in your name, he has brought trouble upon this people, and you have not rescued your people at all."

Exodus 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD said to Moses, "Now you'll see what I'll do to Pharaoh: With a strong hand he'll send them out free; with a strong hand he'll drive them out of his land."
- 1 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Now you will see what I will do to Pharaoh: Because of my mighty hand he will let them go; because of my mighty hand he will drive them out of his country."
- 2 God continued speaking to Moses, reassuring him, "I am GOD.
- 2 God also said to Moses, "I am the LORD.
- 3 I appeared to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob as The Strong God, but by my name GOD (I-Am-Present) I was not known to them.
- 3 I appeared to Abraham, to Isaac and to Jacob as God Almighty, but by my name the LORD I did not make myself known to them.
- 4 I also established my covenant with them to give them the land of Canaan, the country in which they lived as sojourners.
- 4 I also established my covenant with them to give them the land of Canaan, where they lived as aliens.

- 5 But now I've heard the groanings of the Israelites whom the Egyptians continue to enslave and I've remembered my covenant.
- 5 Moreover, I have heard the groaning of the Israelites, whom the Egyptians are enslaving, and I have remembered my covenant.
- 6 Therefore tell the Israelites: "I am GOD. I will bring you out from under the cruel hard labor of Egypt. I will rescue you from slavery. I will redeem you, intervening with great acts of judgment.
- 6 Therefore, say to the Israelites: 'I am the LORD, and I will bring you out from under the yoke of the Egyptians. I will free you from being slaves to them, and I will redeem you with an outstretched arm and with mighty acts of judgment.
- 7 I'll take you as my own people and I'll be God to you. You'll know that I am GOD, your God who brings you out from under the cruel hard labor of Egypt.
- 7 I will take you as my own people, and I will be your God. Then you will know that I am the LORD your God, who brought you out from under the yoke of the Egyptians.
- 8 I'll bring you into the land that I promised to give Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob and give it to you as your own country. I AM GOD."
- 8 And I will bring you to the land I swore with uplifted hand to give to Abraham, to Isaac and to Jacob. I will give it to you as a possession. I am the LORD.' "
- 9 But when Moses delivered this message to the Israelites, they didn't even hear him--they were that beaten down in spirit by the harsh slave conditions.
- 9 Moses reported this to the Israelites, but they did not listen to him because of their discouragement and cruel bondage.
- 10 Then GOD said to Moses,
- 10 Then the LORD said to Moses,
- 11 "Go and speak to Pharaoh king of Egypt so that he will release the Israelites from his land."
- 11 Go, tell Pharaoh king of Egypt to let the Israelites go out of his country.
- 12 Moses answered GOD, "Look--the Israelites won't even listen to me. How do you expect Pharaoh to? And besides, I stutter."
- 12 But Moses said to the LORD, "If the Israelites will not listen to me, why would Pharaoh listen to me, since I speak with faltering lips?"

- 13 But GOD again laid out the facts to Moses and Aaron regarding the Israelites and Pharaoh king of Egypt, and he again commanded them to lead the Israelites out of the land of Egypt.
- 13 Now the LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron about the Israelites and Pharaoh king of Egypt, and he commanded them to bring the Israelites out of Egypt.
- 14 These are the heads of the tribes: The sons of Reuben, Israel's firstborn: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi--these are the families of Reuben.
- 14 These were the heads of their families: The sons of Reuben the firstborn son of Israel were Hanoch and Pallu, Hezron and Carmi. These were the clans of Reuben.
- 15 The sons of Simeon: Jemuel, Jamin, Ohad, Jakin, Zohar, and Saul, the son of a Canaanite woman--these are the families of Simeon.
- 15 The sons of Simeon were Jemuel, Jamin, Ohad, Jakin, Zohar and Shaul the son of a Canaanite woman. These were the clans of Simeon.
- 16 These are the names of the sons of Levi in the order of their birth: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari. Levi lived 137 years.
- 16 These were the names of the sons of Levi according to their records: Gershon, Kohath and Merari. Levi lived 137 years.
- 17 The sons of Gershon by family: Libni and Shimei.
- 17 The sons of Gershon, by clans, were Libni and Shimei.
- 18 The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel. Kohath lived to be 133.
- 18 The sons of Kohath were Amram, Izhar, Hebron and Uzziel. Kohath lived 133 years.
- 19 The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. These are the sons of Levi in the order of their birth.
- 19 The sons of Merari were Mahli and Mushi. These were the clans of Levi according to their records.
- 20 Amram married his aunt Jochebed and she had Aaron and Moses. Amram lived to be 137.
- 20 Amram married his father's sister Jochebed, who bore him Aaron and Moses. Amram lived 137 years.
- 21 The sons of Izhar: Korah, Nepheg, and Zicri.
- 21 The sons of Izhar were Korah, Nepheg and Zicri.
- 22 The sons of Uzziel: Mishael, Elzaphan, and Sithri.

- 22 The sons of Uzziel were Mishael, Elzaphan and Sithri.
- 23 Aaron married Elisheba, the daughter of Amminadab and sister of Nahshon, and she had Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar.
- 23 Aaron married Elisheba, daughter of Amminadab and sister of Nahshon, and she bore him Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar.
- 24 The sons of Korah: Assir, Elkanah, and Abiasaph. These are the families of the Korahites.
- 24 The sons of Korah were Assir, Elkanah and Abiasaph. These were the Korahite clans.
- 25 Aaron's son Eleazar married one of the daughters of Putiel and she had Phinehas. These are the heads of the Levite families, family by family.
- 25 Eleazar son of Aaron married one of the daughters of Putiel, and she bore him Phinehas. These were the heads of the Levite families, clan by clan.
- 26 This is the Aaron and Moses whom GOD ordered: "Bring the Israelites out of the land of Egypt clan by clan."
- 26 It was this same Aaron and Moses to whom the LORD said, "Bring the Israelites out of Egypt by their divisions."
- 27 These are the men, Moses and Aaron, who told Pharaoh king of Egypt to release the Israelites from Egypt.
- 27 They were the ones who spoke to Pharaoh king of Egypt about bringing the Israelites out of Egypt. It was the same Moses and Aaron.
- 28 And that's how things stood when GOD next spoke to Moses in Egypt.
- 28 Now when the LORD spoke to Moses in Egypt,
- 29 God addressed Moses, saying, "I am GOD. Tell Pharaoh king of Egypt everything I say to you."
- 29 he said to him, "I am the LORD. Tell Pharaoh king of Egypt everything I tell you."
- 30 And Moses answered, "Look at me. I stutter. Why would Pharaoh listen to me?"
- 30 But Moses said to the LORD, "Since I speak with faltering lips, why would Pharaoh listen to me?"

Exodus 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD told Moses, "Look at me. I'll make you as a god to Pharaoh and your brother Aaron will be your prophet.
- 1 Then the LORD said to Moses, "See, I have made you like God to Pharaoh, and your brother Aaron will be your prophet.
- 2 You are to speak everything I command you, and your brother Aaron will tell it to Pharaoh. Then he will release the Israelites from his land.
- 2 You are to say everything I command you, and your brother Aaron is to tell Pharaoh to let the Israelites go out of his country.
- 3 At the same time I am going to put Pharaoh's back up and follow it up by filling Egypt with signs and wonders.
- 3 But I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and though I multiply my miraculous signs and wonders in Egypt,
- 4 Pharaoh is not going to listen to you, but I will have my way against Egypt and bring out my soldiers, my people the Israelites, from Egypt by mighty acts of judgment.
- 4 he will not listen to you. Then I will lay my hand on Egypt and with mighty acts of judgment I will bring out my divisions, my people the Israelites.
- 5 The Egyptians will realize that I am GOD when I step in and take the Israelites out of their country."
- 5 And the Egyptians will know that I am the LORD when I stretch out my hand against Egypt and bring the Israelites out of it."
- 6 Moses and Aaron did exactly what GOD commanded.
- 6 Moses and Aaron did just as the LORD commanded them.
- 7 Moses was eighty and Aaron eighty-three when they spoke to Pharaoh.
- 7 Moses was eighty years old and Aaron eighty-three when they spoke to Pharaoh.
- 8 Then GOD spoke to Moses and Aaron. He said,
- 8 The LORD said to Moses and Aaron,
- 9 "When Pharaoh speaks to you and says, 'Prove yourselves. Perform a miracle,' then tell Aaron, 'Take your staff and throw it down in front of Pharaoh: It will turn into a snake.'"
- 9 When Pharaoh says to you, 'Perform a miracle,' then say to Aaron, 'Take your staff and throw it down before Pharaoh,' and it will become a snake.

- 10 Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and did what GOD commanded. Aaron threw his staff down in front of Pharaoh and his servants, and it turned into a snake.
- 10 So Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and did just as the LORD commanded. Aaron threw his staff down in front of Pharaoh and his officials, and it became a snake.
- 11 Pharaoh called in his wise men and sorcerers. The magicians of Egypt did the same thing by their incantations:
- 11 Pharaoh then summoned wise men and sorcerers, and the Egyptian magicians also did the same things by their secret arts:
- 12 each man threw down his staff and they all turned into snakes. But then Aaron's staff swallowed their staffs.
- 12 Each one threw down his staff and it became a snake. But Aaron's staff swallowed up their staffs.
- 13 Yet Pharaoh was as stubborn as ever--he wouldn't listen to them, just as GOD had said.
- 13 Yet Pharaoh's heart became hard and he would not listen to them, just as the LORD had said.
- 14 GOD said to Moses: "Pharaoh is a stubborn man. He refuses to release the people.
- 14 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Pharaoh's heart is unyielding; he refuses to let the people go.
- 15 First thing in the morning, go and meet Pharaoh as he goes down to the river. At the shore of the Nile take the staff that turned into a snake
- 15 Go to Pharaoh in the morning as he goes out to the water. Wait on the bank of the Nile to meet him, and take in your hand the staff that was changed into a snake.
- 16 and say to him, 'GOD, the God of the Hebrews, sent me to you with this message, "Release my people so that they can worship me in the wilderness." So far you haven't listened.
- 16 Then say to him, 'The LORD, the God of the Hebrews, has sent me to say to you: Let my people go, so that they may worship me in the desert. But until now you have not listened.
- 17 This is how you'll know that I am GOD. I am going to take this staff that I'm holding and strike this Nile River water: The water will turn to blood;

- 17 This is what the LORD says: By this you will know that I am the LORD: With the staff that is in my hand I will strike the water of the Nile, and it will be changed into blood.
- 18 the fish in the Nile will die; the Nile will stink; and the Egyptians won't be able to drink the Nile water."
- 18 The fish in the Nile will die, and the river will stink; the Egyptians will not be able to drink its water.' "
- 19 GOD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Take your staff and wave it over the waters of Egypt--over its rivers, its canals, its ponds, all its bodies of water--so that they turn to blood.' There'll be blood everywhere in Egypt--even in the pots and pans."
- 19 The LORD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Take your staff and stretch out your hand over the waters of Egypt--over the streams and canals, over the ponds and all the reservoirs'--and they will turn to blood. Blood will be everywhere in Egypt, even in the wooden buckets and stone jars."
- 20 Moses and Aaron did exactly as GOD commanded them. Aaron raised his staff and hit the water in the Nile with Pharaoh and his servants watching. All the water in the Nile turned into blood.
- 20 Moses and Aaron did just as the LORD had commanded. He raised his staff in the presence of Pharaoh and his officials and struck the water of the Nile, and all the water was changed into blood.
- 21 The fish in the Nile died; the Nile stank; and the Egyptians couldn't drink the Nile water. The blood was everywhere in Egypt.
- 21 The fish in the Nile died, and the river smelled so bad that the Egyptians could not drink its water. Blood was everywhere in Egypt.
- 22 But the magicians of Egypt did the same thing with their incantations. Still Pharaoh remained stubborn. He wouldn't listen to them as GOD had said.
- 22 But the Egyptian magicians did the same things by their secret arts, and Pharaoh's heart became hard; he would not listen to Moses and Aaron, just as the LORD had said.
- 23 He turned on his heel and went home, never giving it a second thought.
- 23 Instead, he turned and went into his palace, and did not take even this to heart.
- 24 But all the Egyptians had to dig inland from the river for water because they couldn't drink the Nile water.

- 24 And all the Egyptians dug along the Nile to get drinking water, because they could not drink the water of the river.
- 25 Seven days went by after GOD had struck the Nile.
- 25 Seven days passed after the LORD struck the Nile.

Exodus 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh and tell him, 'GOD's Message: Release my people so they can worship me.
- 1 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh and say to him, 'This is what the LORD says: Let my people go, so that they may worship me.
- 2 If you refuse to release them, I'm warning you, I'll hit the whole country with frogs.
- 2 If you refuse to let them go, I will plague your whole country with frogs.
- 3 The Nile will swarm with frogs--they'll come up into your houses, into your bedrooms and into your beds, into your servants' quarters, among the people, into your ovens and pots and pans.
- 3 The Nile will teem with frogs. They will come up into your palace and your bedroom and onto your bed, into the houses of your officials and on your people, and into your ovens and kneading troughs.
- 4 They'll be all over you, all over everyone--frogs everywhere, on and in everything!'"
- 4 The frogs will go up on you and your people and all your officials.' "
- 5 GOD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Wave your staff over the rivers and canals and ponds. Bring up frogs on the land of Egypt.'"
- 5 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Stretch out your hand with your staff over the streams and canals and ponds, and make frogs come up on the land of Egypt.' "
- 6 Aaron stretched his staff over the waters of Egypt and a mob of frogs came up and covered the country.
- 6 So Aaron stretched out his hand over the waters of Egypt, and the frogs came up and covered the land.
- 7 But again the magicians did the same thing using their incantations--they also produced frogs in Egypt.

- 7 But the magicians did the same things by their secret arts; they also made frogs come up on the land of Egypt.
- 8 Pharaoh called in Moses and Aaron and said, "Pray to GOD to rid us of these frogs. I'll release the people so that they can make their sacrifices and worship GOD."
- 8 Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron and said, "Pray to the LORD to take the frogs away from me and my people, and I will let your people go to offer sacrifices to the LORD."
- 9 Moses said to Pharaoh, "Certainly. Set the time. When do you want the frogs out of here, away from your servants and people and out of your houses? You'll be rid of frogs except for those in the Nile."
- 9 Moses said to Pharaoh, "I leave to you the honor of setting the time for me to pray for you and your officials and your people that you and your houses may be rid of the frogs, except for those that remain in the Nile."
- 10 "Make it tomorrow." Moses said, "Tomorrow it is--so you'll realize that there is no God like our GOD.
- 10 Tomorrow, Pharaoh said. Moses replied, "It will be as you say, so that you may know there is no one like the LORD our God.
- 11 The frogs will be gone. You and your houses and your servants and your people, free of frogs. The only frogs left will be the ones in the Nile."
- 11 The frogs will leave you and your houses, your officials and your people; they will remain only in the Nile."
- 12 Moses and Aaron left Pharaoh, and Moses prayed to GOD about the frogs he had brought on Pharaoh.
- 12 After Moses and Aaron left Pharaoh, Moses cried out to the LORD about the frogs he had brought on Pharaoh.
- 13 GOD responded to Moses' prayer: The frogs died off--houses, courtyards, fields, all free of frogs.
- 13 And the LORD did what Moses asked. The frogs died in the houses, in the courtyards and in the fields.
- 14 They piled the frogs in heaps. The country reeked of dead frogs.
- 14 They were piled into heaps, and the land reeked of them.
- 15 But when Pharaoh saw that he had some breathing room, he got stubborn again and wouldn't listen to Moses and Aaron. Just as GOD had said.

- 15 But when Pharaoh saw that there was relief, he hardened his heart and would not listen to Moses and Aaron, just as the LORD had said.
- 16 GOD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Take your staff and strike the dust. The dust will turn into gnats all over Egypt.'"
- 16 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Tell Aaron, 'Stretch out your staff and strike the dust of the ground,' and throughout the land of Egypt the dust will become gnats."
- 17 He did it. Aaron grabbed his staff and struck the dust of the Earth; it turned into gnats, gnats all over people and animals. All the dust of the Earth turned into gnats, gnats everywhere in Egypt.
- 17 They did this, and when Aaron stretched out his hand with the staff and struck the dust of the ground, gnats came upon men and animals. All the dust throughout the land of Egypt became gnats.
- 18 The magicians tried to produce gnats with their incantations but this time they couldn't do it. There were gnats everywhere, all over people and animals.
- 18 But when the magicians tried to produce gnats by their secret arts, they could not. And the gnats were on men and animals.
- 19 The magicians said to Pharaoh, "This is God's doing." But Pharaoh was stubborn and wouldn't listen. Just as GOD had said.
- 19 The magicians said to Pharaoh, "This is the finger of God." But Pharaoh's heart was hard and he would not listen, just as the LORD had said.
- 20 GOD said to Moses, "Get up early in the morning and confront Pharaoh as he goes down to the water. Tell him, 'GOD's Message: Release my people so they can worship me.'
- 20 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Get up early in the morning and confront Pharaoh as he goes to the water and say to him, 'This is what the LORD says: Let my people go, so that they may worship me.'
- 21 If you don't release my people, I'll release swarms of flies on you, your servants, your people, and your homes. The houses of the Egyptians and even the ground under their feet will be thick with flies.
- 21 If you do not let my people go, I will send swarms of flies on you and your officials, on your people and into your houses. The houses of the Egyptians will be full of flies, and even the ground where they are.

- 22 But when it happens, I'll set Goshen where my people live aside as a sanctuary--no flies in Goshen. That will show you that I am GOD in this land.
- 22 'But on that day I will deal differently with the land of Goshen, where my people live; no swarms of flies will be there, so that you will know that I, the LORD, am in this land.
- 23 I'll make a sharp distinction between your people and mine. This sign will occur tomorrow.' "
- 23 I will make a distinction between my people and your people. This miraculous sign will occur tomorrow.' "
- 24 And GOD did just that. Thick swarms of flies in Pharaoh's palace and the houses of his servants. All over Egypt, the country ruined by flies.
- 24 And the LORD did this. Dense swarms of flies poured into Pharaoh's palace and into the houses of his officials, and throughout Egypt the land was ruined by the flies.
- 25 Pharaoh called in Moses and Aaron and said, "Go ahead. Sacrifice to your God--but do it here in this country."
- 25 Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron and said, "Go, sacrifice to your God here in the land."
- 26 Moses said, "That would not be wise. What we sacrifice to our GOD would give great offense to Egyptians. If we openly sacrifice what is so deeply offensive to Egyptians, they'll kill us.
- 26 But Moses said, "That would not be right. The sacrifices we offer the LORD our God would be detestable to the Egyptians. And if we offer sacrifices that are detestable in their eyes, will they not stone us?
- 27 Let us go three days' journey into the wilderness and sacrifice to our GOD, just as he instructed us."
- 27 We must take a three-day journey into the desert to offer sacrifices to the LORD our God, as he commands us."
- 28 Pharaoh said, "All right. I'll release you to go and sacrifice to your GOD in the wilderness. Only don't go too far. Now pray for me."
- 28 Pharaoh said, "I will let you go to offer sacrifices to the LORD your God in the desert, but you must not go very far. Now pray for me."
- 29 Moses said, "As soon as I leave here, I will pray to GOD that tomorrow the flies will leave Pharaoh, his servants, and his people. But don't play

games with us and change your mind about releasing us to sacrifice to GOD."

29 Moses answered, "As soon as I leave you, I will pray to the LORD, and tomorrow the flies will leave Pharaoh and his officials and his people. Only be sure that Pharaoh does not act deceitfully again by not letting the people go to offer sacrifices to the LORD."

30 Moses left Pharaoh and prayed to GOD.

30 Then Moses left Pharaoh and prayed to the LORD,

31 GOD did what Moses asked. He got rid of the flies from Pharaoh and his servants and his people. There wasn't a fly left.

31 and the LORD did what Moses asked: The flies left Pharaoh and his officials and his people; not a fly remained.

32 But Pharaoh became stubborn once again and wouldn't release the people.

32 But this time also Pharaoh hardened his heart and would not let the people go.

Exodus 9

MSG

NIV

1 GOD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh and tell him, 'GOD, the God of the Hebrews, says: Release my people so they can worship me.

1 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh and say to him, 'This is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: "Let my people go, so that they may worship me."

2 If you refuse to release them and continue to hold on to them,

2 If you refuse to let them go and continue to hold them back,

3 I'm giving you fair warning: GOD will come down hard on your livestock out in the fields--horses, donkeys, camels, cattle, sheep--striking them with a severe disease.

3 the hand of the LORD will bring a terrible plague on your livestock in the field--on your horses and donkeys and camels and on your cattle and sheep and goats.

4 GOD will draw a sharp line between the livestock of Israel and the livestock of Egypt. Not one animal that belongs to the Israelites will

die."

- 4 But the LORD will make a distinction between the livestock of Israel and that of Egypt, so that no animal belonging to the Israelites will die.' "
- 5 Then GOD set the time: "Tomorrow GOD will do this thing."
- 5 The LORD set a time and said, "Tomorrow the LORD will do this in the land."
- 6 And the next day GOD did it. All the livestock of Egypt died, but not one animal of the Israelites died.
- 6 And the next day the LORD did it: All the livestock of the Egyptians died, but not one animal belonging to the Israelites died.
- 7 Pharaoh sent men to find out what had happened and there it was: none of the livestock of the Israelites had died--not one death. But Pharaoh stayed stubborn. He wouldn't release the people.
- 7 Pharaoh sent men to investigate and found that not even one of the animals of the Israelites had died. Yet his heart was unyielding and he would not let the people go.
- 8 GOD said to Moses and Aaron, "Take fistfuls of soot from a furnace and have Moses throw it into the air right before Pharaoh's eyes;
- 8 Then the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, "Take handfuls of soot from a furnace and have Moses toss it into the air in the presence of Pharaoh.
- 9 it will become a film of fine dust all over Egypt and cause sores, an eruption of boils on people and animals throughout Egypt."
- 9 It will become fine dust over the whole land of Egypt, and festering boils will break out on men and animals throughout the land."
- 10 So they took soot from a furnace, stood in front of Pharaoh, and threw it up into the air. It caused boils to erupt on people and animals.
- 10 So they took soot from a furnace and stood before Pharaoh. Moses tossed it into the air, and festering boils broke out on men and animals.
- 11 The magicians weren't able to compete with Moses this time because of the boils--they were covered with boils just like everyone else in Egypt.
- 11 The magicians could not stand before Moses because of the boils that were on them and on all the Egyptians.
- 12 GOD hardened Pharaoh in his stubbornness. He wouldn't listen, just as GOD had said to Moses.
- 12 But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart and he would not listen to Moses and Aaron, just as the LORD had said to Moses.

- 13 GOD said to Moses, "Get up early in the morning and confront Pharaoh. Tell him, 'GOD, the God of the Hebrews, says: Release my people so they can worship me.
- 13 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Get up early in the morning, confront Pharaoh and say to him, 'This is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: Let my people go, so that they may worship me,
- 14 This time I am going to strike you and your servants and your people with the full force of my power so you'll get it into your head that there's no one like me anywhere in all the Earth.
- 14 or this time I will send the full force of my plagues against you and against your officials and your people, so you may know that there is no one like me in all the earth.
- 15 You know that by now I could have struck you and your people with deadly disease and there would be nothing left of you, not a trace.
- 15 For by now I could have stretched out my hand and struck you and your people with a plague that would have wiped you off the earth.
- 16 But for one reason only I've kept you on your feet: To make you recognize my power so that my reputation spreads in all the Earth.
- 16 But I have raised you up for this very purpose, that I might show you my power and that my name might be proclaimed in all the earth.
- 17 You are still building yourself up at my people's expense. You are not letting them go.
- 17 You still set yourself against my people and will not let them go.
- 18 So here's what's going to happen: At this time tomorrow I'm sending a terrific hailstorm--there's never been a storm like this in Egypt from the day of its founding until now.
- 18 Therefore, at this time tomorrow I will send the worst hailstorm that has ever fallen on Egypt, from the day it was founded till now.
- 19 So get your livestock under roof--everything exposed in the open fields, people and animals, will die when the hail comes down."
- 19 Give an order now to bring your livestock and everything you have in the field to a place of shelter, because the hail will fall on every man and animal that has not been brought in and is still out in the field, and they will die.' "
- 20 All of Pharaoh's servants who had respect for GOD's word got their workers and animals under cover as fast as they could,

20 Those officials of Pharaoh who feared the word of the LORD hurried to bring their slaves and their livestock inside.

21 but those who didn't take GOD's word seriously left their workers and animals out in the field.

21 But those who ignored the word of the LORD left their slaves and livestock in the field.

22 GOD said to Moses: "Stretch your hands to the skies. Signal the hail to fall all over Egypt on people and animals and crops exposed in the fields of Egypt."

22 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand toward the sky so that hail will fall all over Egypt--on men and animals and on everything growing in the fields of Egypt."

23 Moses lifted his staff to the skies and GOD sent peals of thunder and hail shot through with lightning strikes. GOD rained hail down on the land of Egypt.

23 When Moses stretched out his staff toward the sky, the LORD sent thunder and hail, and lightning flashed down to the ground. So the LORD rained hail on the land of Egypt;

24 The hail came, hail and lightning--a fierce hailstorm. There had been nothing like it in Egypt in its entire history.

24 hail fell and lightning flashed back and forth. It was the worst storm in all the land of Egypt since it had become a nation.

25 The hail hit hard all over Egypt. Everything exposed out in the fields, people and animals and crops, was smashed. Even the trees in the fields were shattered.

25 Throughout Egypt hail struck everything in the fields--both men and animals; it beat down everything growing in the fields and stripped every tree.

26 Except for Goshen where the Israelites lived; there was no hail in Goshen.

26 The only place it did not hail was the land of Goshen, where the Israelites were.

27 Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron. He said, "I've sinned for sure this time--GOD is in the right and I and my people are in the wrong.

27 Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron. "This time I have sinned," he said to them. "The LORD is in the right, and I and my people are in

- the wrong.
- 28 Pray to GOD. We've had enough of GOD's thunder and hail. I'll let you go. The sooner you're out of here the better."
- 28 Pray to the LORD, for we have had enough thunder and hail. I will let you go; you don't have to stay any longer."
- 29 Moses said, "As soon as I'm out of the city, I'll stretch out my arms to GOD. The thunder will stop and the hail end so you'll know that the land is GOD's land.
- 29 Moses replied, "When I have gone out of the city, I will spread out my hands in prayer to the LORD. The thunder will stop and there will be no more hail, so you may know that the earth is the LORD's.
- 30 Still, I know that you and your servants have no respect for GOD."
- 30 But I know that you and your officials still do not fear the LORD God."
- 31 (The flax and the barley were ruined, for they were just ripening,
- 31 (The flax and barley were destroyed, since the barley had headed and the flax was in bloom.
- 32 but the wheat and spelt weren't hurt--they ripen later.)
- 32 The wheat and spelt, however, were not destroyed, because they ripen later.)
- 33 Moses left Pharaoh and the city and stretched out his arms to GOD. The thunder and hail stopped; the storm cleared.
- 33 Then Moses left Pharaoh and went out of the city. He spread out his hands toward the LORD; the thunder and hail stopped, and the rain no longer poured down on the land.
- 34 But when Pharaoh saw that the rain and hail and thunder had stopped, he kept right on sinning, stubborn as ever, both he and his servants.
- 34 When Pharaoh saw that the rain and hail and thunder had stopped, he sinned again: He and his officials hardened their hearts.
- 35 Pharaoh's heart turned rock-hard. He refused to release the Israelites, as GOD had ordered through Moses.
- 35 So Pharaoh's heart was hard and he would not let the Israelites go, just as the LORD had said through Moses.

Exodus 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD said to Moses: "Go to Pharaoh. I've made him stubborn, him and his servants, so that I can force him to look at these signs
- 1 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go to Pharaoh, for I have hardened his heart and the hearts of his officials so that I may perform these miraculous signs of mine among them
- 2 and so you'll be able to tell your children and grandchildren how I toyed with the Egyptians, like a cat with a mouse; you'll tell them the stories of the signs that I brought down on them, so that you'll all know that I am GOD."
- 2 that you may tell your children and grandchildren how I dealt harshly with the Egyptians and how I performed my signs among them, and that you may know that I am the LORD."
- 3 Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and said to him, "GOD, the God of the Hebrews, says, 'How long are you going to refuse to knuckle under? Release my people so that they can worship me.
- 3 So Moses and Aaron went to Pharaoh and said to him, "This is what the LORD, the God of the Hebrews, says: 'How long will you refuse to humble yourself before me? Let my people go, so that they may worship me.
- 4 If you refuse to release my people, watch out; tomorrow I'm bringing locusts into your country.
- 4 If you refuse to let them go, I will bring locusts into your country tomorrow.
- 5 They'll cover every square inch of ground; no one will be able to see the ground. They'll devour everything left over from the hailstorm, even the saplings out in the fields--they'll clear-cut the trees.
- 5 They will cover the face of the ground so that it cannot be seen. They will devour what little you have left after the hail, including every tree that is growing in your fields.
- 6 And they'll invade your houses, filling the houses of your servants, filling every house in Egypt. Nobody will have ever seen anything like this, from the time your ancestors first set foot on this soil until today.'" Then he turned on his heel and left Pharaoh.
- 6 They will fill your houses and those of all your officials and all the Egyptians--something neither your fathers nor your forefathers have ever

- seen from the day they settled in this land till now.' " Then Moses turned and left Pharaoh.
- 7 Pharaoh's servants said to him, "How long are you going to let this man harass us? Let these people go and worship their GOD. Can't you see that Egypt is on its last legs?"
- 7 Pharaoh's officials said to him, "How long will this man be a snare to us? Let the people go, so that they may worship the LORD their God. Do you not yet realize that Egypt is ruined?"
- 8 So Moses and Aaron were brought back to Pharaoh. He said to them, "Go ahead then. Go worship your GOD. But just who exactly is going with you?"
- 8 Then Moses and Aaron were brought back to Pharaoh. "Go, worship the LORD your God," he said. "But just who will be going?"
- 9 Moses said, "We're taking young and old, sons and daughters, flocks and herds--this is our worship-celebration of GOD."
- 9 Moses answered, "We will go with our young and old, with our sons and daughters, and with our flocks and herds, because we are to celebrate a festival to the LORD."
- 10 He said, "I'd sooner send you off with GOD's blessings than let you go with your children. Look, you're up to no good--it's written all over your faces.
- 10 Pharaoh said, "The LORD be with you--if I let you go, along with your women and children! Clearly you are bent on evil.
- 11 Nothing doing. Just the men are going--go ahead and worship GOD. That's what you want so badly." And they were thrown out of Pharaoh's presence.
- 11 No! Have only the men go; and worship the LORD, since that's what you have been asking for." Then Moses and Aaron were driven out of Pharaoh's presence.
- 12 GOD said to Moses: "Stretch your hand over Egypt and signal the locusts to cover the land of Egypt, devouring every blade of grass in the country, everything that the hail didn't get."
- 12 And the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over Egypt so that locusts will swarm over the land and devour everything growing in the fields, everything left by the hail."

- 13 Moses stretched out his staff over the land of Egypt. GOD let loose an east wind. It blew that day and night. By morning the east wind had brought in the locusts.
- 13 So Moses stretched out his staff over Egypt, and the LORD made an east wind blow across the land all that day and all that night. By morning the wind had brought the locusts;
- 14 The locusts covered the country of Egypt, settling over every square inch of Egypt; the place was thick with locusts. There never was an invasion of locusts like it in the past, and never will be again.
- 14 they invaded all Egypt and settled down in every area of the country in great numbers. Never before had there been such a plague of locusts, nor will there ever be again.
- 15 The ground was completely covered, black with locusts. They ate everything, every blade of grass, every piece of fruit, anything that the hail didn't get. Nothing left but bare trees and bare fields--not a sign of green in the whole land of Egypt.
- 15 They covered all the ground until it was black. They devoured all that was left after the hail--everything growing in the fields and the fruit on the trees. Nothing green remained on tree or plant in all the land of Egypt.
- 16 Pharaoh had Moses and Aaron back in no time. He said, "I've sinned against your GOD and against you.
- 16 Pharaoh quickly summoned Moses and Aaron and said, "I have sinned against the LORD your God and against you.
- 17 Overlook my sin one more time. Pray to your GOD to get me out of this--get death out of here!"
- 17 Now forgive my sin once more and pray to the LORD your God to take this deadly plague away from me."
- 18 Moses left Pharaoh and prayed to GOD.
- 18 Moses then left Pharaoh and prayed to the LORD.
- 19 GOD reversed the wind--a powerful west wind took the locusts and dumped them into the Red Sea. There wasn't a single locust left in the whole country of Egypt.
- 19 And the LORD changed the wind to a very strong west wind, which caught up the locusts and carried them into the Red Sea. Not a locust was left anywhere in Egypt.

20 But GOD made Pharaoh stubborn as ever. He still didn't release the Israelites.

20 But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he would not let the Israelites go.

21 GOD said to Moses: "Stretch your hand to the skies. Let darkness descend on the land of Egypt--a darkness so dark you can touch it."

21 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand toward the sky so that darkness will spread over Egypt--darkness that can be felt."

22 Moses stretched out his hand to the skies. Thick darkness descended on the land of Egypt for three days.

22 So Moses stretched out his hand toward the sky, and total darkness covered all Egypt for three days.

23 Nobody could see anybody. For three days no one could so much as move. Except for the Israelites: they had light where they were living.

23 No one could see anyone else or leave his place for three days. Yet all the Israelites had light in the places where they lived.

24 Pharaoh called in Moses: "Go and worship GOD. Leave your flocks and herds behind. But go ahead and take your children."

24 Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and said, "Go, worship the LORD. Even your women and children may go with you; only leave your flocks and herds behind."

25 But Moses said, "You have to let us take our sacrificial animals and offerings with us so we can sacrifice them in worship to our GOD.

25 But Moses said, "You must allow us to have sacrifices and burnt offerings to present to the LORD our God.

26 Our livestock has to go with us with not a hoof left behind; they are part of the worship of our GOD. And we don't know just what will be needed until we get there."

26 Our livestock too must go with us; not a hoof is to be left behind. We have to use some of them in worshiping the LORD our God, and until we get there we will not know what we are to use to worship the LORD."

27 But GOD kept Pharaoh stubborn as ever. He wouldn't agree to release them.

27 But the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he was not willing to let them go.

- 28 Pharaoh said to Moses: "Get out of my sight! And watch your step. I don't want to ever see you again. If I lay eyes on you again, you're dead."
- 28 Pharaoh said to Moses, "Get out of my sight! Make sure you do not appear before me again! The day you see my face you will die."
- 29 Moses said, "Have it your way. You won't see my face again."
- 29 Just as you say, Moses replied, "I will never appear before you again."

Exodus 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 God said to Moses: "I'm going to hit Pharaoh and Egypt one final time, and then he'll let you go. When he releases you, that will be the end of Egypt for you; he won't be able to get rid of you fast enough."
- 1 Now the LORD had said to Moses, "I will bring one more plague on Pharaoh and on Egypt. After that, he will let you go from here, and when he does, he will drive you out completely."
- 2 "So here's what you do. Tell the people to ask, each man from his neighbor and each woman from her neighbor, for things made of silver and gold."
- 2 Tell the people that men and women alike are to ask their neighbors for articles of silver and gold."
- 3 GOD saw to it that the Egyptians liked the people. Also, Moses was greatly admired by the Egyptians, a respected public figure among both Pharaoh's servants and the people at large.
- 3 (The LORD made the Egyptians favorably disposed toward the people, and Moses himself was highly regarded in Egypt by Pharaoh's officials and by the people.)
- 4 Then Moses confronted Pharaoh: "GOD's Message: 'At midnight I will go through Egypt'
- 4 So Moses said, "This is what the LORD says: 'About midnight I will go throughout Egypt.
- 5 and every firstborn child in Egypt will die, from the firstborn of Pharaoh, who sits on his throne, to the firstborn of the slave girl working at her hand mill. Also the firstborn of animals.

- 5 Every firstborn son in Egypt will die, from the firstborn son of Pharaoh, who sits on the throne, to the firstborn son of the slave girl, who is at her hand mill, and all the firstborn of the cattle as well.
- 6 Widespread wailing will erupt all over the country, lament such as has never been and never will be again.
- 6 There will be loud wailing throughout Egypt--worse than there has ever been or ever will be again.
- 7 But against the Israelites--man, woman, or animal--there won't be so much as a dog's bark, so that you'll know that GOD makes a clear distinction between Egypt and Israel.'
- 7 But among the Israelites not a dog will bark at any man or animal.' Then you will know that the LORD makes a distinction between Egypt and Israel.
- 8 "Then all these servants of yours will go to their knees, begging me to leave, 'Leave! You and all the people who follow you!' And I will most certainly leave." Moses, seething with anger, left Pharaoh.
- 8 All these officials of yours will come to me, bowing down before me and saying, 'Go, you and all the people who follow you!' After that I will leave." Then Moses, hot with anger, left Pharaoh.
- 9 GOD said to Moses, "Pharaoh's not going to listen to a thing you say so that the signs of my presence and work are going to multiply in the land of Egypt."
- 9 The LORD had said to Moses, "Pharaoh will refuse to listen to you--so that my wonders may be multiplied in Egypt."
- 10 Moses and Aaron had performed all these signs in Pharaoh's presence, but GOD turned Pharaoh more stubborn than ever--yet again he refused to release the Israelites from his land.
- 10 Moses and Aaron performed all these wonders before Pharaoh, but the LORD hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he would not let the Israelites go out of his country.

Exodus 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD said to Moses and Aaron while still in Egypt,

- 1 The LORD said to Moses and Aaron in Egypt,
- 2 "This month is to be the first month of the year for you.
- 2 This month is to be for you the first month, the first month of your year.
- 3 Address the whole community of Israel; tell them that on the tenth of this month each man is to take a lamb for his family, one lamb to a house.
- 3 Tell the whole community of Israel that on the tenth day of this month each man is to take a lamb for his family, one for each household.
- 4 If the family is too small for a lamb, then share it with a close neighbor, depending on the number of persons involved. Be mindful of how much each person will eat.
- 4 If any household is too small for a whole lamb, they must share one with their nearest neighbor, having taken into account the number of people there are. You are to determine the amount of lamb needed in accordance with what each person will eat.
- 5 Your lamb must be a healthy male, one year old; you can select it from either the sheep or the goats.
- 5 The animals you choose must be year-old males without defect, and you may take them from the sheep or the goats.
- 6 Keep it penned until the fourteenth day of this month and then slaughter it--the entire community of Israel will do this--at dusk.
- 6 Take care of them until the fourteenth day of the month, when all the people of the community of Israel must slaughter them at twilight.
- 7 Then take some of the blood and smear it on the two doorposts and the lintel of the houses in which you will eat it.
- 7 Then they are to take some of the blood and put it on the sides and tops of the doorframes of the houses where they eat the lambs.
- 8 You are to eat the meat, roasted in the fire, that night, along with bread, made without yeast, and bitter herbs.
- 8 That same night they are to eat the meat roasted over the fire, along with bitter herbs, and bread made without yeast.
- 9 Don't eat any of it raw or boiled in water; make sure it's roasted--the whole animal, head, legs, and innards.
- 9 Do not eat the meat raw or cooked in water, but roast it over the fire--head, legs and inner parts.
- 10 Don't leave any of it until morning; if there are leftovers, burn them in the fire.

- 10 Do not leave any of it till morning; if some is left till morning, you must burn it.
- 11 "And here is how you are to eat it: Be fully dressed with your sandals on and your stick in your hand. Eat in a hurry; it's the Passover to GOD.
- 11 This is how you are to eat it: with your cloak tucked into your belt, your sandals on your feet and your staff in your hand. Eat it in haste; it is the LORD's Passover.
- 12 "I will go through the land of Egypt on this night and strike down every firstborn in the land of Egypt, whether human or animal, and bring judgment on all the gods of Egypt. I am GOD.
- 12 On that same night I will pass through Egypt and strike down every firstborn--both men and animals--and I will bring judgment on all the gods of Egypt. I am the LORD.
- 13 The blood will serve as a sign on the houses where you live. When I see the blood I will pass over you--no disaster will touch you when I strike the land of Egypt.
- 13 The blood will be a sign for you on the houses where you are; and when I see the blood, I will pass over you. No destructive plague will touch you when I strike Egypt.
- 14 "This will be a memorial day for you; you will celebrate it as a festival to GOD down through the generations, a fixed festival celebration to be observed always.
- 14 This is a day you are to commemorate; for the generations to come you shall celebrate it as a festival to the LORD-- a lasting ordinance.
- 15 You will eat unraised bread (matzoth) for seven days: On the first day get rid of all yeast from your houses--anyone who eats anything with yeast from the first day to the seventh day will be cut off from Israel.
- 15 For seven days you are to eat bread made without yeast. On the first day remove the yeast from your houses, for whoever eats anything with yeast in it from the first day through the seventh must be cut off from Israel.
- 16 The first and the seventh days are set aside as holy; do no work on those days. Only what you have to do for meals; each person can do that.
- 16 On the first day hold a sacred assembly, and another one on the seventh day. Do no work at all on these days, except to prepare food for everyone to eat--that is all you may do.

- 17 "Keep the Festival of Unraised Bread! This marks the exact day I brought you out in force from the land of Egypt. Honor the day down through your generations, a fixed festival to be observed always.
- 17 Celebrate the Feast of Unleavened Bread, because it was on this very day that I brought your divisions out of Egypt. Celebrate this day as a lasting ordinance for the generations to come.
- 18 In the first month, beginning on the fourteenth day at evening until the twenty-first day at evening, you are to eat unraised bread.
- 18 In the first month you are to eat bread made without yeast, from the evening of the fourteenth day until the evening of the twenty-first day.
- 19 For those seven days not a trace of yeast is to be found in your houses. Anyone, whether a visitor or a native of the land, who eats anything raised shall be cut off from the community of Israel.
- 19 For seven days no yeast is to be found in your houses. And whoever eats anything with yeast in it must be cut off from the community of Israel, whether he is an alien or native-born.
- 20 Don't eat anything raised. Only matzoth."
- 20 Eat nothing made with yeast. Wherever you live, you must eat unleavened bread."
- 21 Moses assembled all the elders of Israel. He said, "Select a lamb for your families and slaughter the Passover lamb.
- 21 Then Moses summoned all the elders of Israel and said to them, "Go at once and select the animals for your families and slaughter the Passover lamb.
- 22 Take a bunch of hyssop and dip it in the bowl of blood and smear it on the lintel and on the two doorposts. No one is to leave the house until morning.
- 22 Take a bunch of hyssop, dip it into the blood in the basin and put some of the blood on the top and on both sides of the doorframe. Not one of you shall go out the door of his house until morning.
- 23 GOD will pass through to strike Egypt down. When he sees the blood on the lintel and the two door posts, GOD will pass over the doorway; he won't let the destroyer enter your house to strike you down with ruin.
- 23 When the LORD goes through the land to strike down the Egyptians, he will see the blood on the top and sides of the doorframe and will pass

- over that doorway, and he will not permit the destroyer to enter your houses and strike you down.
- 24 "Keep this word. It's the law for you and your children, forever.
- 24 Obey these instructions as a lasting ordinance for you and your descendants.
- 25 When you enter the land which GOD will give you as he promised, keep doing this.
- 25 When you enter the land that the LORD will give you as he promised, observe this ceremony.
- 26 And when your children say to you, 'Why are we doing this?'
- 26 And when your children ask you, 'What does this ceremony mean to you?'
- 27 tell them: 'It's the Passover-sacrifice to GOD who passed over the homes of the Israelites in Egypt when he hit Egypt with death but rescued us.'" The people bowed and worshiped.
- 27 then tell them, 'It is the Passover sacrifice to the LORD, who passed over the houses of the Israelites in Egypt and spared our homes when he struck down the Egyptians.' " Then the people bowed down and worshiped.
- 28 The Israelites then went and did what GOD had commanded Moses and Aaron. They did it all.
- 28 The Israelites did just what the LORD commanded Moses and Aaron.
- 29 At midnight GOD struck every firstborn in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh, who sits on his throne, right down to the firstborn of the prisoner locked up in jail. Also the firstborn of the animals.
- 29 At midnight the LORD struck down all the firstborn in Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh, who sat on the throne, to the firstborn of the prisoner, who was in the dungeon, and the firstborn of all the livestock as well.
- 30 Pharaoh got up that night, he and all his servants and everyone else in Egypt--what wild wailing and lament in Egypt! There wasn't a house in which someone wasn't dead.
- 30 Pharaoh and all his officials and all the Egyptians got up during the night, and there was loud wailing in Egypt, for there was not a house without someone dead.

- 31 Pharaoh called in Moses and Aaron that very night and said, "Get out of here and be done with you--you and your Israelites! Go worship GOD on your own terms.
- 31 During the night Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron and said, "Up! Leave my people, you and the Israelites! Go, worship the LORD as you have requested.
- 32 And yes, take your sheep and cattle as you've insisted, but go. And bless me."
- 32 Take your flocks and herds, as you have said, and go. And also bless me."
- 33 The Egyptians couldn't wait to get rid of them; they pushed them to hurry up, saying, "We're all as good as dead."
- 33 The Egyptians urged the people to hurry and leave the country. "For otherwise," they said, "we will all die!"
- 34 The people grabbed their bread dough before it had risen, bundled their bread bowls in their cloaks and threw them over their shoulders.
- 34 So the people took their dough before the yeast was added, and carried it on their shoulders in kneading troughs wrapped in clothing.
- 35 The Israelites had already done what Moses had told them; they had asked the Egyptians for silver and gold things and clothing.
- 35 The Israelites did as Moses instructed and asked the Egyptians for articles of silver and gold and for clothing.
- 36 GOD saw to it that the Egyptians liked the people and so readily gave them what they asked for. Oh yes! They picked those Egyptians clean.
- 36 The LORD had made the Egyptians favorably disposed toward the people, and they gave them what they asked for; so they plundered the Egyptians.
- 37 The Israelites moved on from Rameses to Succoth, about 600,000 on foot, besides their dependents.
- 37 The Israelites journeyed from Rameses to Succoth. There were about six hundred thousand men on foot, besides women and children.
- 38 There was also a crowd of riffraff tagging along, not to mention the large flocks and herds of livestock.
- 38 Many other people went up with them, as well as large droves of livestock, both flocks and herds.

- 39 They baked unraised cakes with the bread dough they had brought out of Egypt; it hadn't raised--they'd been rushed out of Egypt and hadn't time to fix food for the journey.
- 39 With the dough they had brought from Egypt, they baked cakes of unleavened bread. The dough was without yeast because they had been driven out of Egypt and did not have time to prepare food for themselves.
- 40 The Israelites had lived in Egypt 430 years.
- 40 Now the length of time the Israelite people lived in Egypt was 430 years.
- 41 At the end of the 430 years, to the very day, GOD's entire army left Egypt.
- 41 At the end of the 430 years, to the very day, all the LORD's divisions left Egypt.
- 42 GOD kept watch all night, watching over the Israelites as he brought them out of Egypt. Because GOD kept watch, all Israel for all generations will honor GOD by keeping watch this night--a watchnight.
- 42 Because the LORD kept vigil that night to bring them out of Egypt, on this night all the Israelites are to keep vigil to honor the LORD for the generations to come.
- 43 GOD said to Moses and Aaron, "These are the rules for the Passover: No foreigners are to eat it.
- 43 The LORD said to Moses and Aaron, "These are the regulations for the Passover: "No foreigner is to eat of it.
- 44 Any slave, if he's paid for and circumcised, can eat it.
- 44 Any slave you have bought may eat of it after you have circumcised him,
- 45 No casual visitor or hired hand can eat it.
- 45 but a temporary resident and a hired worker may not eat of it.
- 46 Eat it in one house--don't take the meat outside the house. Don't break any of the bones.
- 46 It must be eaten inside one house; take none of the meat outside the house. Do not break any of the bones.
- 47 The whole community of Israel is to be included in the meal.
- 47 The whole community of Israel must celebrate it.

- 48 "If an immigrant is staying with you and wants to keep the Passover to GOD, every male in his family must be circumcised, then he can participate in the Meal--he will then be treated as a native son. But no uncircumcised person can eat it.
- 48 An alien living among you who wants to celebrate the LORD's Passover must have all the males in his household circumcised; then he may take part like one born in the land. No uncircumcised male may eat of it.
- 49 "The same law applies both to the native and the immigrant who is staying with you."
- 49 The same law applies to the native-born and to the alien living among you."
- 50 All the Israelites did exactly as GOD commanded Moses and Aaron.
- 50 All the Israelites did just what the LORD had commanded Moses and Aaron.
- 51 That very day GOD brought the Israelites out of the land of Egypt, tribe by tribe.
- 51 And on that very day the LORD brought the Israelites out of Egypt by their divisions.

Exodus 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD spoke to Moses, saying,
- 1 The LORD said to Moses,
- 2 "Consecrate every firstborn to me--the first one to come from the womb among the Israelites, whether person or animal, is mine."
- 2 Consecrate to me every firstborn male. The first offspring of every womb among the Israelites belongs to me, whether man or animal.
- 3 Moses said to the people, "Always remember this day. This is the day when you came out of Egypt from a house of slavery. GOD brought you out of here with a powerful hand. Don't eat any raised bread.
- 3 Then Moses said to the people, "Commemorate this day, the day you came out of Egypt, out of the land of slavery, because the LORD brought you out of it with a mighty hand. Eat nothing containing yeast.
- 4 "You are leaving in the spring month of Abib.

- 4 Today, in the month of Abib, you are leaving.
- 5 When GOD brings you into the land of the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite, which he promised to your fathers to give you, a land lavish with milk and honey, you are to observe this service during this month:
- 5 When the LORD brings you into the land of the Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Hivites and Jebusites--the land he swore to your forefathers to give you, a land flowing with milk and honey--you are to observe this ceremony in this month:
- 6 "You are to eat unraised bread for seven days; on the seventh day there is a festival celebration to GOD.
- 6 For seven days eat bread made without yeast and on the seventh day hold a festival to the LORD.
- 7 "Only unraised bread is to be eaten for seven days. There is not to be a trace of anything fermented--no yeast anywhere.
- 7 Eat unleavened bread during those seven days; nothing with yeast in it is to be seen among you, nor shall any yeast be seen anywhere within your borders.
- 8 "Tell your child on that day: 'This is because of what GOD did for me when I came out of Egypt.'
- 8 On that day tell your son, 'I do this because of what the LORD did for me when I came out of Egypt.'
- 9 "The day of observance will be like a sign on your hand, a memorial between your eyes, and the teaching of GOD in your mouth. It was with a powerful hand that GOD brought you out of Egypt.
- 9 This observance will be for you like a sign on your hand and a reminder on your forehead that the law of the LORD is to be on your lips. For the LORD brought you out of Egypt with his mighty hand.
- 10 Follow these instructions at the set time, year after year after year.
- 10 You must keep this ordinance at the appointed time year after year.
- 11 "When GOD brings you into the land of the Canaanites, as he promised you and your fathers, and turns it over to you,
- 11 After the LORD brings you into the land of the Canaanites and gives it to you, as he promised on oath to you and your forefathers,
- 12 you are to set aside the first birth out of every womb to GOD. Every first birth from your livestock belongs to GOD.

- 12 you are to give over to the LORD the first offspring of every womb. All the firstborn males of your livestock belong to the LORD.
- 13 You can redeem every first birth of a donkey if you want to by substituting a lamb; if you decide not to redeem it, you must break its neck. "Redeem every firstborn child among your sons.
- 13 Redeem with a lamb every firstborn donkey, but if you do not redeem it, break its neck. Redeem every firstborn among your sons.
- 14 When the time comes and your son asks you, 'What does this mean?' you tell him, 'GOD brought us out of Egypt, out of a house of slavery, with a powerful hand.
- 14 In days to come, when your son asks you, 'What does this mean?' say to him, 'With a mighty hand the LORD brought us out of Egypt, out of the land of slavery.
- 15 When Pharaoh stubbornly refused to let us go, GOD killed every firstborn in Egypt, the firstborn of both humans and animals. That's why I make a sacrifice for every first male birth from the womb to GOD and redeem every firstborn son.'
- 15 When Pharaoh stubbornly refused to let us go, the LORD killed every firstborn in Egypt, both man and animal. This is why I sacrifice to the LORD the first male offspring of every womb and redeem each of my firstborn sons.'
- 16 The observance functions like a sign on your hands or a symbol on the middle of your forehead: GOD brought us out of Egypt with a powerful hand."
- 16 And it will be like a sign on your hand and a symbol on your forehead that the LORD brought us out of Egypt with his mighty hand."
- 17 It so happened that after Pharaoh released the people, God didn't lead them by the road through the land of the Philistines, which was the shortest route, for God thought, "If the people encounter war, they'll change their minds and go back to Egypt."
- 17 When Pharaoh let the people go, God did not lead them on the road through the Philistine country, though that was shorter. For God said, "If they face war, they might change their minds and return to Egypt."
- 18 So God led the people on the wilderness road, looping around to the Red Sea. The Israelites left Egypt in military formation.

- 18 So God led the people around by the desert road toward the Red Sea. The Israelites went up out of Egypt armed for battle.
- 19 Moses took the bones of Joseph with him, for Joseph had made the Israelites solemnly swear to do it, saying, "God will surely hold you accountable, so make sure you bring my bones from here with you."
- 19 Moses took the bones of Joseph with him because Joseph had made the sons of Israel swear an oath. He had said, "God will surely come to your aid, and then you must carry my bones up with you from this place."
- 20 They moved on from Succoth and then camped at Etham at the edge of the wilderness.
- 20 After leaving Succoth they camped at Etham on the edge of the desert.
- 21 GOD went ahead of them in a Pillar of Cloud during the day to guide them on the way, and at night in a Pillar of Fire to give them light; thus they could travel both day and night.
- 21 By day the LORD went ahead of them in a pillar of cloud to guide them on their way and by night in a pillar of fire to give them light, so that they could travel by day or night.
- 22 The Pillar of Cloud by day and the Pillar of Fire by night never left the people.
- 22 Neither the pillar of cloud by day nor the pillar of fire by night left its place in front of the people.

Exodus 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD spoke to Moses:
- 1 Then the LORD said to Moses,
- 2 "Tell the Israelites to turn around and make camp at Pi Hahiroth, between Migdol and the sea. Camp on the shore of the sea opposite Baal Zephon.
- 2 Tell the Israelites to turn back and encamp near Pi Hahiroth, between Migdol and the sea. They are to encamp by the sea, directly opposite Baal Zephon.
- 3 "Pharaoh will think, 'The Israelites are lost; they're confused. The wilderness has closed in on them.'

- 3 Pharaoh will think, 'The Israelites are wandering around the land in confusion, hemmed in by the desert.'
- 4 Then I'll make Pharaoh's heart stubborn again and he'll chase after them. And I'll use Pharaoh and his army to put my Glory on display. Then the Egyptians will realize that I am GOD." And that's what happened.
- 4 And I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and he will pursue them. But I will gain glory for myself through Pharaoh and all his army, and the Egyptians will know that I am the LORD." So the Israelites did this.
- 5 When the king of Egypt was told that the people were gone, he and his servants changed their minds. They said, "What have we done, letting Israel, our slave labor, go free?"
- 5 When the king of Egypt was told that the people had fled, Pharaoh and his officials changed their minds about them and said, "What have we done? We have let the Israelites go and have lost their services!"
- 6 So he had his chariots harnessed up and got his army together.
- 6 So he had his chariot made ready and took his army with him.
- 7 He took six hundred of his best chariots, with the rest of the Egyptian chariots and their drivers coming along.
- 7 He took six hundred of the best chariots, along with all the other chariots of Egypt, with officers over all of them.
- 8 GOD made Pharaoh king of Egypt stubborn, determined to chase the Israelites as they walked out on him without even looking back.
- 8 The LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh king of Egypt, so that he pursued the Israelites, who were marching out boldly.
- 9 The Egyptians gave chase and caught up with them where they had made camp by the sea--all Pharaoh's horse-drawn chariots and their riders, all his foot soldiers there at Pi Hahiroth opposite Baal Zephon.
- 9 The Egyptians--all Pharaoh's horses and chariots, horsemen and troops--pursued the Israelites and overtook them as they camped by the sea near Pi Hahiroth, opposite Baal Zephon.
- 10 As Pharaoh approached, the Israelites looked up and saw them--Egyptians! Coming at them! They were totally afraid. They cried out in terror to GOD.
- 10 As Pharaoh approached, the Israelites looked up, and there were the Egyptians, marching after them. They were terrified and cried out to the LORD.

- 11 They told Moses, "Weren't the cemeteries large enough in Egypt so that you had to take us out here in the wilderness to die? What have you done to us, taking us out of Egypt?"
- 11 They said to Moses, "Was it because there were no graves in Egypt that you brought us to the desert to die? What have you done to us by bringing us out of Egypt?"
- 12 Back in Egypt didn't we tell you this would happen? Didn't we tell you, 'Leave us alone here in Egypt--we're better off as slaves in Egypt than as corpses in the wilderness.'"
- 12 Didn't we say to you in Egypt, 'Leave us alone; let us serve the Egyptians'? It would have been better for us to serve the Egyptians than to die in the desert!"
- 13 Moses spoke to the people: "Don't be afraid. Stand firm and watch GOD do his work of salvation for you today. Take a good look at the Egyptians today for you're never going to see them again.
- 13 Moses answered the people, "Do not be afraid. Stand firm and you will see the deliverance the LORD will bring you today. The Egyptians you see today you will never see again.
- 14 GOD will fight the battle for you. And you? You keep your mouths shut!"
- 14 The LORD will fight for you; you need only to be still."
- 15 GOD said to Moses: "Why cry out to me? Speak to the Israelites. Order them to get moving.
- 15 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Why are you crying out to me? Tell the Israelites to move on.
- 16 Hold your staff high and stretch your hand out over the sea: Split the sea! The Israelites will walk through the sea on dry ground.
- 16 Raise your staff and stretch out your hand over the sea to divide the water so that the Israelites can go through the sea on dry ground.
- 17 "Meanwhile I'll make sure the Egyptians keep up their stubborn chase-- I'll use Pharaoh and his entire army, his chariots and horsemen,
- 17 I will harden the hearts of the Egyptians so that they will go in after them. And I will gain glory through Pharaoh and all his army, through his chariots and his horsemen.
- 18 to put my Glory on display so that the Egyptians will realize that I am GOD."

- 18 The Egyptians will know that I am the LORD when I gain glory through Pharaoh, his chariots and his horsemen."
- 19 The angel of God that had been leading the camp of Israel now shifted and got behind them. And the Pillar of Cloud that had been in front also shifted to the rear.
- 19 Then the angel of God, who had been traveling in front of Israel's army, withdrew and went behind them. The pillar of cloud also moved from in front and stood behind them,
- 20 The Cloud was now between the camp of Egypt and the camp of Israel. The Cloud enshrouded one camp in darkness and flooded the other with light. The two camps didn't come near each other all night.
- 20 coming between the armies of Egypt and Israel. Throughout the night the cloud brought darkness to the one side and light to the other side; so neither went near the other all night long.
- 21 Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea and GOD, with a terrific east wind all night long, made the sea go back. He made the sea dry ground. The seawaters split.
- 21 Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and all that night the LORD drove the sea back with a strong east wind and turned it into dry land. The waters were divided,
- 22 The Israelites walked through the sea on dry ground with the waters a wall to the right and to the left.
- 22 and the Israelites went through the sea on dry ground, with a wall of water on their right and on their left.
- 23 The Egyptians came after them in full pursuit, every horse and chariot and driver of Pharaoh racing into the middle of the sea.
- 23 The Egyptians pursued them, and all Pharaoh's horses and chariots and horsemen followed them into the sea.
- 24 It was now the morning watch. GOD looked down from the Pillar of Fire and Cloud on the Egyptian army and threw them into a panic.
- 24 During the last watch of the night the LORD looked down from the pillar of fire and cloud at the Egyptian army and threw it into confusion.
- 25 He clogged the wheels of their chariots; they were stuck in the mud. The Egyptians said, "Run from Israel! GOD is fighting on their side and against Egypt!"

- 25 He made the wheels of their chariots come off so that they had difficulty driving. And the Egyptians said, "Let's get away from the Israelites! The LORD is fighting for them against Egypt."
- 26 GOD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over the sea and the waters will come back over the Egyptians, over their chariots, over their horsemen."
- 26 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over the sea so that the waters may flow back over the Egyptians and their chariots and horsemen."
- 27 Moses stretched his hand out over the sea: As the day broke and the Egyptians were running, the sea returned to its place as before. GOD dumped the Egyptians in the middle of the sea.
- 27 Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and at daybreak the sea went back to its place. The Egyptians were fleeing toward it, and the LORD swept them into the sea.
- 28 The waters returned, drowning the chariots and riders of Pharaoh's army that had chased after Israel into the sea. Not one of them survived.
- 28 The water flowed back and covered the chariots and horsemen--the entire army of Pharaoh that had followed the Israelites into the sea. Not one of them survived.
- 29 But the Israelites walked right through the middle of the sea on dry ground, the waters forming a wall to the right and to the left.
- 29 But the Israelites went through the sea on dry ground, with a wall of water on their right and on their left.
- 30 GOD delivered Israel that day from the oppression of the Egyptians. And Israel looked at the Egyptian dead, washed up on the shore of the sea,
- 30 That day the LORD saved Israel from the hands of the Egyptians, and Israel saw the Egyptians lying dead on the shore.
- 31 and realized the tremendous power that GOD brought against the Egyptians. The people were in reverent awe before GOD and trusted in GOD and his servant Moses.
- 31 And when the Israelites saw the great power the LORD displayed against the Egyptians, the people feared the LORD and put their trust in him and in Moses his servant.

Exodus 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then Moses and the Israelites sang this song to GOD, giving voice together, I'm singing my heart out to GOD--what a victory! He pitched horse and rider into the sea.
- 1 Then Moses and the Israelites sang this song to the LORD: "I will sing to the LORD, for he is highly exalted. The horse and its rider he has hurled into the sea.
- 2 GOD is my strength, GOD is my song, and, yes! GOD is my salvation. This is the kind of God I have and I'm telling the world! This is the God of my father-- I'm spreading the news far and wide!
- 2 The LORD is my strength and my song; he has become my salvation. He is my God, and I will praise him, my father's God, and I will exalt him.
- 3 GOD is a fighter, pure GOD, through and through.
- 3 The LORD is a warrior; the LORD is his name.
- 4 Pharaoh's chariots and army he dumped in the sea, The elite of his officers he drowned in the Red Sea.
- 4 Pharaoh's chariots and his army he has hurled into the sea. The best of Pharaoh's officers are drowned in the Red Sea.
- 5 Wild ocean waters poured over them; they sank like a rock in the deep blue sea.
- 5 The deep waters have covered them; they sank to the depths like a stone.
- 6 Your strong right hand, GOD, shimmers with power; your strong right hand shatters the enemy.
- 6 Your right hand, O LORD, was majestic in power. Your right hand, O LORD, shattered the enemy.
- 7 In your mighty majesty you smash your upstart enemies, You let loose your hot anger and burn them to a crisp.
- 7 In the greatness of your majesty you threw down those who opposed you. You unleashed your burning anger; it consumed them like stubble.
- 8 At a blast from your nostrils the waters piled up; Tumbling streams dammed up, wild oceans curdled into a swamp.
- 8 By the blast of your nostrils the waters piled up. The surging waters stood firm like a wall; the deep waters congealed in the heart of the sea.

- 9 The enemy spoke, "I'll pursue, I'll hunt them down, I'll divide up the plunder, I'll glut myself on them; I'll pull out my sword, my fist will send them reeling."
- 9 The enemy boasted, 'I will pursue, I will overtake them. I will divide the spoils; I will gorge myself on them. I will draw my sword and my hand will destroy them.'
- 10 You blew with all your might and the sea covered them. They sank like a lead weight in the majestic waters.
- 10 But you blew with your breath, and the sea covered them. They sank like lead in the mighty waters.
- 11 Who compares with you among gods, O GOD? Who compares with you in power, in holy majesty, In awesome praises, wonder-working God?
- 11 Who among the gods is like you, O LORD? Who is like you-- majestic in holiness, awesome in glory, working wonders?
- 12 You stretched out your right hand and the Earth swallowed them up.
- 12 You stretched out your right hand and the earth swallowed them.
- 13 But the people you redeemed, you led in merciful love; You guided them under your protection to your holy pasture.
- 13 In your unfailing love you will lead the people you have redeemed. In your strength you will guide them to your holy dwelling.
- 14 When people heard, they were scared; Philistines writhed and trembled;
- 14 The nations will hear and tremble; anguish will grip the people of Philistia.
- 15 Yes, even the head men in Edom were shaken, and the big bosses in Moab. Everybody in Canaan panicked and fell faint.
- 15 The chiefs of Edom will be terrified, the leaders of Moab will be seized with trembling, the people of Canaan will melt away;
- 16 Dread and terror sent them reeling. Before your brandished right arm they were struck dumb like a stone,
- 16 terror and dread will fall upon them. By the power of your arm they will be as still as a stone-- until your people pass by, O LORD, until the people you bought pass by.
- 17 Until your people crossed over and entered, O GOD, until the people you made crossed over and entered. You brought them and planted them on the mountain of your heritage, The place where you live, the place

you made, Your sanctuary, Master, that you established with your own hands.

17 You will bring them in and plant them on the mountain of your inheritance-- the place, O LORD, you made for your dwelling, the sanctuary, O Lord, your hands established.

18 Let GOD rule forever, for eternity!

18 The LORD will reign for ever and ever."

19 Yes, Pharaoh's horses and chariots and riders went into the sea and GOD turned the waters back on them; but the Israelites walked on dry land right through the middle of the sea.

19 When Pharaoh's horses, chariots and horsemen went into the sea, the LORD brought the waters of the sea back over them, but the Israelites walked through the sea on dry ground.

20 Miriam the prophetess, Aaron's sister, took a tambourine, and all the women followed her with tambourines, dancing.

20 Then Miriam the prophetess, Aaron's sister, took a tambourine in her hand, and all the women followed her, with tambourines and dancing.

21 Miriam led them in singing, Sing to GOD-- what a victory! He pitched horse and rider into the sea!

21 Miriam sang to them: "Sing to the LORD, for he is highly exalted. The horse and its rider he has hurled into the sea."

22 Moses led Israel from the Red Sea on to the Wilderness of Shur. They traveled for three days through the wilderness without finding any water.

22 Then Moses led Israel from the Red Sea and they went into the Desert of Shur. For three days they traveled in the desert without finding water.

23 They got to Marah, but they couldn't drink the water at Marah; it was bitter. That's why they called the place Marah (Bitter).

23 When they came to Marah, they could not drink its water because it was bitter. (That is why the place is called Marah.)

24 And the people complained to Moses, "So what are we supposed to drink?"

24 So the people grumbled against Moses, saying, "What are we to drink?"

25 So Moses cried out in prayer to GOD. GOD pointed him to a stick of wood. Moses threw it into the water and the water turned sweet.

25 Then Moses cried out to the LORD, and the LORD showed him a piece of wood. He threw it into the water, and the water became sweet. There

- the LORD made a decree and a law for them, and there he tested them.
- 26 That's the place where GOD set up rules and procedures; that's where he started testing them. GOD said, "If you listen, listen obediently to how GOD tells you to live in his presence, obeying his commandments and keeping all his laws, then I won't strike you with all the diseases that I inflicted on the Egyptians; I am GOD your healer."
- 26 He said, "If you listen carefully to the voice of the LORD your God and do what is right in his eyes, if you pay attention to his commands and keep all his decrees, I will not bring on you any of the diseases I brought on the Egyptians, for I am the LORD, who heals you."
- 27 They came to Elim where there were twelve springs of water and seventy palm trees. They set up camp there by the water.
- 27 Then they came to Elim, where there were twelve springs and seventy palm trees, and they camped there near the water.

Exodus 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 On the fifteenth day of the second month after they had left Egypt, the whole company of Israel moved on from Elim to the Wilderness of Sin which is between Elim and Sinai.
- 1 The whole Israelite community set out from Elim and came to the Desert of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai, on the fifteenth day of the second month after they had come out of Egypt.
- 2 The whole company of Israel complained against Moses and Aaron there in the wilderness.
- 2 In the desert the whole community grumbled against Moses and Aaron.
- 3 The Israelites said, "Why didn't GOD let us die in comfort in Egypt where we had lamb stew and all the bread we could eat? You've brought us out into this wilderness to starve us to death, the whole company of Israel!"
- 3 The Israelites said to them, "If only we had died by the LORD's hand in Egypt! There we sat around pots of meat and ate all the food we wanted, but you have brought us out into this desert to starve this entire assembly to death."

- 4 GOD said to Moses, "I'm going to rain bread down from the skies for you. The people will go out and gather each day's ration. I'm going to test them to see if they'll live according to my Teaching or not.
- 4 Then the LORD said to Moses, "I will rain down bread from heaven for you. The people are to go out each day and gather enough for that day. In this way I will test them and see whether they will follow my instructions.
- 5 On the sixth day, when they prepare what they have gathered, it will turn out to be twice as much as their daily ration."
- 5 On the sixth day they are to prepare what they bring in, and that is to be twice as much as they gather on the other days."
- 6 Moses and Aaron told the People of Israel, "This evening you will know that it is GOD who brought you out of Egypt;
- 6 So Moses and Aaron said to all the Israelites, "In the evening you will know that it was the LORD who brought you out of Egypt,
- 7 and in the morning you will see the Glory of GOD. Yes, he's listened to your complaints against him. You haven't been complaining against us, you know, but against GOD."
- 7 and in the morning you will see the glory of the LORD, because he has heard your grumbling against him. Who are we, that you should grumble against us?"
- 8 Moses said, "Since it will be GOD who gives you meat for your meal in the evening and your fill of bread in the morning, it's GOD who will have listened to your complaints against him. Who are we in all this? You haven't been complaining to us--you've been complaining to GOD!"
- 8 Moses also said, "You will know that it was the LORD when he gives you meat to eat in the evening and all the bread you want in the morning, because he has heard your grumbling against him. Who are we? You are not grumbling against us, but against the LORD."
- 9 Moses instructed Aaron: "Tell the whole company of Israel: 'Come near to GOD. He's heard your complaints.'"
- 9 Then Moses told Aaron, "Say to the entire Israelite community, 'Come before the LORD, for he has heard your grumbling.' "
- 10 When Aaron gave out the instructions to the whole company of Israel, they turned to face the wilderness. And there it was: the Glory of GOD visible in the Cloud.

- 10 While Aaron was speaking to the whole Israelite community, they looked toward the desert, and there was the glory of the LORD appearing in the cloud.
- 11 GOD spoke to Moses,
- 11 The LORD said to Moses,
- 12 "I've listened to the complaints of the Israelites. Now tell them: 'At dusk you will eat meat and at dawn you'll eat your fill of bread; and you'll realize that I am GOD, your God.'"
- 12 I have heard the grumbling of the Israelites. Tell them, 'At twilight you will eat meat, and in the morning you will be filled with bread. Then you will know that I am the LORD your God.'
- 13 That evening quail flew in and covered the camp and in the morning there was a layer of dew all over the camp.
- 13 That evening quail came and covered the camp, and in the morning there was a layer of dew around the camp.
- 14 When the layer of dew had lifted, there on the wilderness ground was a fine flaky something, fine as frost on the ground.
- 14 When the dew was gone, thin flakes like frost on the ground appeared on the desert floor.
- 15 The Israelites took one look and said to one another, man-hu (What is it?). They had no idea what it was. So Moses told them, "It's the bread GOD has given you to eat.
- 15 When the Israelites saw it, they said to each other, "What is it?" For they did not know what it was. Moses said to them, "It is the bread the LORD has given you to eat.
- 16 And these are GOD's instructions: 'Gather enough for each person, about two quarts per person; gather enough for everyone in your tent.'"
- 16 This is what the LORD has commanded: 'Each one is to gather as much as he needs. Take an omer for each person you have in your tent.' "
- 17 The People of Israel went to work and started gathering, some more, some less,
- 17 The Israelites did as they were told; some gathered much, some little.
- 18 but when they measured out what they had gathered, those who gathered more had no extra and those who gathered less weren't short--each person had gathered as much as was needed.

- 18 And when they measured it by the omer, he who gathered much did not have too much, and he who gathered little did not have too little. Each one gathered as much as he needed.
- 19 Moses said to them, "Don't leave any of it until morning."
- 19 Then Moses said to them, "No one is to keep any of it until morning."
- 20 But they didn't listen to Moses. A few of the men kept back some of it until morning. It got wormy and smelled bad. And Moses lost his temper with them.
- 20 However, some of them paid no attention to Moses; they kept part of it until morning, but it was full of maggots and began to smell. So Moses was angry with them.
- 21 They gathered it every morning, each person according to need. Then the sun heated up and it melted.
- 21 Each morning everyone gathered as much as he needed, and when the sun grew hot, it melted away.
- 22 On the sixth day they gathered twice as much bread, about four quarts per person. Then the leaders of the company came to Moses and reported.
- 22 On the sixth day, they gathered twice as much--two omers for each person--and the leaders of the community came and reported this to Moses.
- 23 Moses said, "This is what GOD was talking about: Tomorrow is a day of rest, a holy Sabbath to GOD. Whatever you plan to bake, bake today; and whatever you plan to boil, boil today. Then set aside the leftovers until morning."
- 23 He said to them, "This is what the LORD commanded: 'Tomorrow is to be a day of rest, a holy Sabbath to the LORD. So bake what you want to bake and boil what you want to boil. Save whatever is left and keep it until morning.' "
- 24 They set aside what was left until morning, as Moses had commanded. It didn't smell bad and there were no worms in it.
- 24 So they saved it until morning, as Moses commanded, and it did not stink or get maggots in it.
- 25 Moses said, "Now eat it; this is the day, a Sabbath for GOD. You won't find any of it on the ground today."

- 25 Eat it today, Moses said, "because today is a Sabbath to the LORD. You will not find any of it on the ground today.
- 26 Gather it every day for six days, but the seventh day is Sabbath; there won't be any of it on the ground."
- 26 Six days you are to gather it, but on the seventh day, the Sabbath, there will not be any."
- 27 On the seventh day, some of the people went out to gather anyway but they didn't find anything.
- 27 Nevertheless, some of the people went out on the seventh day to gather it, but they found none.
- 28 GOD said to Moses, "How long are you going to disobey my commands and not follow my instructions?"
- 28 Then the LORD said to Moses, "How long will you refuse to keep my commands and my instructions?"
- 29 Don't you see that GOD has given you the Sabbath? So on the sixth day he gives you bread for two days. So, each of you, stay home. Don't leave home on the seventh day."
- 29 Bear in mind that the LORD has given you the Sabbath; that is why on the sixth day he gives you bread for two days. Everyone is to stay where he is on the seventh day; no one is to go out."
- 30 So the people quit working on the seventh day.
- 30 So the people rested on the seventh day.
- 31 The Israelites named it manna (What is it?). It looked like coriander seed, whitish. And it tasted like a cracker with honey.
- 31 The people of Israel called the bread manna. It was white like coriander seed and tasted like wafers made with honey.
- 32 Moses said, "This is GOD's command: 'Keep a two-quart jar of it, an omer, for future generations so they can see the bread that I fed you in the wilderness after I brought you out of Egypt.'"
- 32 Moses said, "This is what the LORD has commanded: 'Take an omer of manna and keep it for the generations to come, so they can see the bread I gave you to eat in the desert when I brought you out of Egypt.' "
- 33 Moses told Aaron, "Take a jar and fill it with two quarts of manna. Place it before GOD, keeping it safe for future generations."
- 33 So Moses said to Aaron, "Take a jar and put an omer of manna in it. Then place it before the LORD to be kept for the generations to come."

34 Aaron did what GOD commanded Moses. He set it aside before The Testimony to preserve it.

34 As the LORD commanded Moses, Aaron put the manna in front of the Testimony, that it might be kept.

35 The Israelites ate the manna for forty years until they arrived at the land where they would settle down. They ate manna until they reached the border into Canaan.

35 The Israelites ate manna forty years, until they came to a land that was settled; they ate manna until they reached the border of Canaan.

36 According to ancient measurements, an omer is one-tenth of an ephah.

36 (An omer is one tenth of an ephah.)

Exodus 17

MSG

NIV

1 Directed by GOD, the whole company of Israel moved on by stages from the Wilderness of Sin. They set camp at Rephidim. And there wasn't a drop of water for the people to drink.

1 The whole Israelite community set out from the Desert of Sin, traveling from place to place as the LORD commanded. They camped at Rephidim, but there was no water for the people to drink.

2 The people took Moses to task: "Give us water to drink." But Moses said, "Why pester me? Why are you testing GOD?"

2 So they quarreled with Moses and said, "Give us water to drink." Moses replied, "Why do you quarrel with me? Why do you put the LORD to the test?"

3 But the people were thirsty for water there. They complained to Moses, "Why did you take us from Egypt and drag us out here with our children and animals to die of thirst?"

3 But the people were thirsty for water there, and they grumbled against Moses. They said, "Why did you bring us up out of Egypt to make us and our children and livestock die of thirst?"

4 Moses cried out in prayer to GOD, "What can I do with these people? Any minute now they'll kill me!"

- 4 Then Moses cried out to the LORD, "What am I to do with these people? They are almost ready to stone me."
- 5 GOD said to Moses, "Go on out ahead of the people, taking with you some of the elders of Israel. Take the staff you used to strike the Nile. And go."
- 5 The LORD answered Moses, "Walk on ahead of the people. Take with you some of the elders of Israel and take in your hand the staff with which you struck the Nile, and go."
- 6 I'm going to be present before you there on the rock at Horeb. You are to strike the rock. Water will gush out of it and the people will drink." Moses did what he said, with the elders of Israel right there watching.
- 6 I will stand there before you by the rock at Horeb. Strike the rock, and water will come out of it for the people to drink." So Moses did this in the sight of the elders of Israel.
- 7 He named the place Massah (Testing-Place) and Meribah (Quarreling) because of the quarreling of the Israelites and because of their testing of GOD when they said, "Is GOD here with us, or not?"
- 7 And he called the place Massah and Meribah because the Israelites quarreled and because they tested the LORD saying, "Is the LORD among us or not?"
- 8 Amalek came and fought Israel at Rephidim.
- 8 The Amalekites came and attacked the Israelites at Rephidim.
- 9 Moses ordered Joshua: "Select some men for us and go out and fight Amalek. Tomorrow I will take my stand on top of the hill holding God's staff."
- 9 Moses said to Joshua, "Choose some of our men and go out to fight the Amalekites. Tomorrow I will stand on top of the hill with the staff of God in my hands."
- 10 Joshua did what Moses ordered in order to fight Amalek. And Moses, Aaron, and Hur went to the top of the hill.
- 10 So Joshua fought the Amalekites as Moses had ordered, and Moses, Aaron and Hur went to the top of the hill.
- 11 It turned out that whenever Moses raised his hands, Israel was winning, but whenever he lowered his hands, Amalek was winning.
- 11 As long as Moses held up his hands, the Israelites were winning, but whenever he lowered his hands, the Amalekites were winning.

- 12 But Moses' hands got tired. So they got a stone and set it under him. He sat on it and Aaron and Hur held up his hands, one on each side. So his hands remained steady until the sun went down.
- 12 When Moses' hands grew tired, they took a stone and put it under him and he sat on it. Aaron and Hur held his hands up--one on one side, one on the other--so that his hands remained steady till sunset.
- 13 Joshua defeated Amalek and its army in battle.
- 13 So Joshua overcame the Amalekite army with the sword.
- 14 GOD said to Moses, "Write this up as a reminder to Joshua, to keep it before him, because I will most certainly wipe the very memory of Amalek off the face of the Earth."
- 14 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Write this on a scroll as something to be remembered and make sure that Joshua hears it, because I will completely blot out the memory of Amalek from under heaven."
- 15 Moses built an altar and named it "GOD My Banner."
- 15 Moses built an altar and called it The LORD is my Banner.
- 16 He said, Salute GOD's rule! GOD at war with Amalek Always and forever!
- 16 He said, "For hands were lifted up to the throne of the LORD. The LORD will be at war against the Amalekites from generation to generation."

Exodus 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jethro, priest of Midian and father-in-law to Moses, heard the report of all that God had done for Moses and Israel his people, the news that God had delivered Israel from Egypt.
- 1 Now Jethro, the priest of Midian and father-in-law of Moses, heard of everything God had done for Moses and for his people Israel, and how the LORD had brought Israel out of Egypt.
- 2 Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, had taken in Zipporah, Moses' wife who had been sent back home,
- 2 After Moses had sent away his wife Zipporah, his father-in-law Jethro received her

- 3 and her two sons. The name of the one was Gershom (Sojourner) for he had said, "I'm a sojourner in a foreign land";
- 3 and her two sons. One son was named Gershom, for Moses said, "I have become an alien in a foreign land";
- 4 the name of the other was Eliezer (God's-Help) because "The God of my father is my help and saved me from death by Pharaoh."
- 4 and the other was named Eliezer, for he said, "My father's God was my helper; he saved me from the sword of Pharaoh."
- 5 Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, brought Moses his sons and his wife there in the wilderness where he was camped at the mountain of God.
- 5 Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, together with Moses' sons and wife, came to him in the desert, where he was camped near the mountain of God.
- 6 He had sent a message ahead to Moses: "I, your father-in-law, am coming to you with your wife and two sons."
- 6 Jethro had sent word to him, "I, your father-in-law Jethro, am coming to you with your wife and her two sons."
- 7 Moses went out to welcome his father-in-law. He bowed to him and kissed him. Each asked the other how things had been with him. Then they went into the tent.
- 7 So Moses went out to meet his father-in-law and bowed down and kissed him. They greeted each other and then went into the tent.
- 8 Moses told his father-in-law the story of all that GOD had done to Pharaoh and Egypt in helping Israel, all the trouble they had experienced on the journey, and how GOD had delivered them.
- 8 Moses told his father-in-law about everything the LORD had done to Pharaoh and the Egyptians for Israel's sake and about all the hardships they had met along the way and how the LORD had saved them.
- 9 Jethro was delighted in all the good that GOD had done for Israel in delivering them from Egyptian oppression.
- 9 Jethro was delighted to hear about all the good things the LORD had done for Israel in rescuing them from the hand of the Egyptians.
- 10 Jethro said, "Blessed be GOD who has delivered you from the power of Egypt and Pharaoh, who has delivered his people from the oppression of Egypt.
- 10 He said, "Praise be to the LORD, who rescued you from the hand of the Egyptians and of Pharaoh, and who rescued the people from the hand of

the Egyptians.

- 11 Now I know that GOD is greater than all gods because he's done this to all those who treated Israel arrogantly."
- 11 Now I know that the LORD is greater than all other gods, for he did this to those who had treated Israel arrogantly."
- 12 Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, brought a Whole-Burnt-Offering and sacrifices to God. And Aaron, along with all the elders of Israel, came and ate the meal with Moses' father-in-law in the presence of God.
- 12 Then Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, brought a burnt offering and other sacrifices to God, and Aaron came with all the elders of Israel to eat bread with Moses' father-in-law in the presence of God.
- 13 The next day Moses took his place to judge the people. People were standing before him all day long, from morning to night.
- 13 The next day Moses took his seat to serve as judge for the people, and they stood around him from morning till evening.
- 14 When Moses' father-in-law saw all that he was doing for the people, he said, "What's going on here? Why are you doing all this, and all by yourself, letting everybody line up before you from morning to night?"
- 14 When his father-in-law saw all that Moses was doing for the people, he said, "What is this you are doing for the people? Why do you alone sit as judge, while all these people stand around you from morning till evening?"
- 15 Moses said to his father-in-law, "Because the people come to me with questions about God.
- 15 Moses answered him, "Because the people come to me to seek God's will.
- 16 When something comes up, they come to me. I judge between a man and his neighbor and teach them God's laws and instructions."
- 16 Whenever they have a dispute, it is brought to me, and I decide between the parties and inform them of God's decrees and laws."
- 17 Moses' father-in-law said, "This is no way to go about it.
- 17 Moses' father-in-law replied, "What you are doing is not good.
- 18 You'll burn out, and the people right along with you. This is way too much for you--you can't do this alone.
- 18 You and these people who come to you will only wear yourselves out. The work is too heavy for you; you cannot handle it alone.

- 19 Now listen to me. Let me tell you how to do this so that God will be in this with you. Be there for the people before God, but let the matters of concern be presented to God.
- 19 Listen now to me and I will give you some advice, and may God be with you. You must be the people's representative before God and bring their disputes to him.
- 20 Your job is to teach them the rules and instructions, to show them how to live, what to do.
- 20 Teach them the decrees and laws, and show them the way to live and the duties they are to perform.
- 21 And then you need to keep a sharp eye out for competent men--men who fear God, men of integrity, men who are incorruptible--and appoint them as leaders over groups organized by the thousand, by the hundred, by fifty, and by ten.
- 21 But select capable men from all the people--men who fear God, trustworthy men who hate dishonest gain--and appoint them as officials over thousands, hundreds, fifties and tens.
- 22 They'll be responsible for the everyday work of judging among the people. They'll bring the hard cases to you, but in the routine cases they'll be the judges. They will share your load and that will make it easier for you.
- 22 Have them serve as judges for the people at all times, but have them bring every difficult case to you; the simple cases they can decide themselves. That will make your load lighter, because they will share it with you.
- 23 If you handle the work this way, you'll have the strength to carry out whatever God commands you, and the people in their settings will flourish also."
- 23 If you do this and God so commands, you will be able to stand the strain, and all these people will go home satisfied."
- 24 Moses listened to the counsel of his father-in-law and did everything he said.
- 24 Moses listened to his father-in-law and did everything he said.
- 25 Moses picked competent men from all Israel and set them as leaders over the people who were organized by the thousand, by the hundred, by fifty, and by ten.

- 25 He chose capable men from all Israel and made them leaders of the people, officials over thousands, hundreds, fifties and tens.
- 26 They took over the everyday work of judging among the people. They brought the hard cases to Moses, but in the routine cases they were the judges.
- 26 They served as judges for the people at all times. The difficult cases they brought to Moses, but the simple ones they decided themselves.
- 27 Then Moses said good-bye to his father-in-law who went home to his own country.
- 27 Then Moses sent his father-in-law on his way, and Jethro returned to his own country.

Exodus 19

MSG

NIV

- 1 Three months after leaving Egypt the Israelites entered the Wilderness of Sinai.
- 1 In the third month after the Israelites left Egypt--on the very day--they came to the Desert of Sinai.
- 2 They followed the route from Rephidim, arrived at the Wilderness of Sinai, and set up camp. Israel camped there facing the mountain.
- 2 After they set out from Rephidim, they entered the Desert of Sinai, and Israel camped there in the desert in front of the mountain.
- 3 As Moses went up to meet God, GOD called down to him from the mountain: "Speak to the House of Jacob, tell the People of Israel:
- 3 Then Moses went up to God, and the LORD called to him from the mountain and said, "This is what you are to say to the house of Jacob and what you are to tell the people of Israel:
- 4 'You have seen what I did to Egypt and how I carried you on eagles' wings and brought you to me.
- 4 'You yourselves have seen what I did to Egypt, and how I carried you on eagles' wings and brought you to myself.
- 5 If you will listen obediently to what I say and keep my covenant, out of all peoples you'll be my special treasure. The whole Earth is mine to choose from,

5 Now if you obey me fully and keep my covenant, then out of all nations you will be my treasured possession. Although the whole earth is mine,
6 but you're special: a kingdom of priests, a holy nation.' "This is what I want you to tell the People of Israel."
6 you will be for me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation.' These are the words you are to speak to the Israelites."
7 Moses came back and called the elders of Israel together and set before them all these words which GOD had commanded him.
7 So Moses went back and summoned the elders of the people and set before them all the words the LORD had commanded him to speak.
8 The people were unanimous in their response: "Everything GOD says, we will do." Moses took the people's answer back to GOD.
8 The people all responded together, "We will do everything the LORD has said." So Moses brought their answer back to the LORD.
9 GOD said to Moses, "Get ready. I'm about to come to you in a thick cloud so that the people can listen in and trust you completely when I speak with you." Again Moses reported the people's answer to GOD.
9 The LORD said to Moses, "I am going to come to you in a dense cloud, so that the people will hear me speaking with you and will always put their trust in you." Then Moses told the LORD what the people had said.
10 GOD said to Moses, "Go to the people. For the next two days get these people ready to meet the Holy GOD. Have them scrub their clothes
10 And the LORD said to Moses, "Go to the people and consecrate them today and tomorrow. Have them wash their clothes
11 so that on the third day they'll be fully prepared, because on the third day GOD will come down on Mount Sinai and make his presence known to all the people.
11 and be ready by the third day, because on that day the LORD will come down on Mount Sinai in the sight of all the people.
12 Post boundaries for the people all around, telling them, 'Warning! Don't climb the mountain. Don't even touch its edge. Whoever touches the mountain dies--a certain death.
12 Put limits for the people around the mountain and tell them, 'Be careful that you do not go up the mountain or touch the foot of it. Whoever touches the mountain shall surely be put to death.

- 13 And no one is to touch that person, he's to be stoned. That's right--stoned. Or shot with arrows, shot to death. Animal or man, whichever--put to death.' "A long blast from the horn will signal that it's safe to climb the mountain."
- 13 He shall surely be stoned or shot with arrows; not a hand is to be laid on him. Whether man or animal, he shall not be permitted to live.' Only when the ram's horn sounds a long blast may they go up to the mountain."
- 14 Moses went down the mountain to the people and prepared them for the holy meeting. They gave their clothes a good scrubbing.
- 14 After Moses had gone down the mountain to the people, he consecrated them, and they washed their clothes.
- 15 Then he addressed the people: "Be ready in three days. Don't sleep with a woman."
- 15 Then he said to the people, "Prepare yourselves for the third day. Abstain from sexual relations."
- 16 On the third day at daybreak, there were loud claps of thunder, flashes of lightning, a thick cloud covering the mountain, and an ear-piercing trumpet blast. Everyone in the camp shuddered in fear.
- 16 On the morning of the third day there was thunder and lightning, with a thick cloud over the mountain, and a very loud trumpet blast. Everyone in the camp trembled.
- 17 Moses led the people out of the camp to meet God. They stood at attention at the base of the mountain.
- 17 Then Moses led the people out of the camp to meet with God, and they stood at the foot of the mountain.
- 18 Mount Sinai was all smoke because GOD had come down on it as fire. Smoke poured from it like smoke from a furnace. The whole mountain shuddered in huge spasms.
- 18 Mount Sinai was covered with smoke, because the LORD descended on it in fire. The smoke billowed up from it like smoke from a furnace, the whole mountain trembled violently,
- 19 The trumpet blasts grew louder and louder. Moses spoke and God answered in thunder.
- 19 and the sound of the trumpet grew louder and louder. Then Moses spoke and the voice of God answered him.

- 20 GOD descended to the peak of Mount Sinai. GOD called Moses up to the peak and Moses climbed up.
- 20 The LORD descended to the top of Mount Sinai and called Moses to the top of the mountain. So Moses went up
- 21 GOD said to Moses, "Go down. Warn the people not to break through the barricades to get a look at GOD lest many of them die.
- 21 and the LORD said to him, "Go down and warn the people so they do not force their way through to see the LORD and many of them perish.
- 22 And the priests also, warn them to prepare themselves for the holy meeting, lest GOD break out against them."
- 22 Even the priests, who approach the LORD, must consecrate themselves, or the LORD will break out against them."
- 23 Moses said to GOD, "But the people can't climb Mount Sinai. You've already warned us well telling us: 'Post boundaries around the mountain. Respect the holy mountain.'"
- 23 Moses said to the LORD, "The people cannot come up Mount Sinai, because you yourself warned us, 'Put limits around the mountain and set it apart as holy.' "
- 24 GOD told him, "Go down and then bring Aaron back up with you. But make sure that the priests and the people don't break through and come up to GOD, lest he break out against them."
- 24 The LORD replied, "Go down and bring Aaron up with you. But the priests and the people must not force their way through to come up to the LORD, or he will break out against them."
- 25 So Moses went down to the people. He said to them:
- 25 So Moses went down to the people and told them.

Exodus 20

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD spoke all these words:
- 1 And God spoke all these words:
- 2 I am GOD, your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of a life of slavery.

- 2 I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of Egypt, out of the land of slavery.
- 3 No other gods, only me.
- 3 You shall have no other gods before me.
- 4 No carved gods of any size, shape, or form of anything whatever, whether of things that fly or walk or swim.
- 4 You shall not make for yourself an idol in the form of anything in heaven above or on the earth beneath or in the waters below.
- 5 Don't bow down to them and don't serve them because I am GOD, your God, and I'm a most jealous God, punishing the children for any sins their parents pass on to them to the third, and yes, even to the fourth generation of those who hate me.
- 5 You shall not bow down to them or worship them; for I, the LORD your God, am a jealous God, punishing the children for the sin of the fathers to the third and fourth generation of those who hate me,
- 6 But I'm unswervingly loyal to the thousands who love me and keep my commandments.
- 6 but showing love to a thousand generations of those who love me and keep my commandments.
- 7 No using the name of GOD, your God, in curses or silly banter; GOD won't put up with the irreverent use of his name.
- 7 You shall not misuse the name of the LORD your God, for the LORD will not hold anyone guiltless who misuses his name.
- 8 Observe the Sabbath day, to keep it holy.
- 8 Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy.
- 9 Work six days and do everything you need to do.
- 9 Six days you shall labor and do all your work,
- 10 But the seventh day is a Sabbath to GOD, your God. Don't do any work—not you, nor your son, nor your daughter, nor your servant, nor your maid, nor your animals, not even the foreign guest visiting in your town.
- 10 but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD your God. On it you shall not do any work, neither you, nor your son or daughter, nor your manservant or maidservant, nor your animals, nor the alien within your gates.
- 11 For in six days GOD made Heaven, Earth, and sea, and everything in them; he rested on the seventh day. Therefore GOD blessed the Sabbath

day; he set it apart as a holy day.

11 For in six days the LORD made the heavens and the earth, the sea, and all that is in them, but he rested on the seventh day. Therefore the LORD blessed the Sabbath day and made it holy.

12 Honor your father and mother so that you'll live a long time in the land that GOD, your God, is giving you.

12 Honor your father and your mother, so that you may live long in the land the LORD your God is giving you.

13 No murder.

13 You shall not murder.

14 No adultery.

14 You shall not commit adultery.

15 No stealing.

15 You shall not steal.

16 No lies about your neighbor.

16 You shall not give false testimony against your neighbor.

17 No lusting after your neighbor's house--or wife or servant or maid or ox or donkey. Don't set your heart on anything that is your neighbor's.

17 You shall not covet your neighbor's house. You shall not covet your neighbor's wife, or his manservant or maidservant, his ox or donkey, or anything that belongs to your neighbor.

18 All the people, experiencing the thunder and lightning, the trumpet blast and the smoking mountain, were afraid--they pulled back and stood at a distance.

18 When the people saw the thunder and lightning and heard the trumpet and saw the mountain in smoke, they trembled with fear. They stayed at a distance

19 They said to Moses, "You speak to us and we'll listen, but don't have God speak to us or we'll die."

19 and said to Moses, "Speak to us yourself and we will listen. But do not have God speak to us or we will die."

20 Moses spoke to the people: "Don't be afraid. God has come to test you and instill a deep and reverent awe within you so that you won't sin."

20 Moses said to the people, "Do not be afraid. God has come to test you, so that the fear of God will be with you to keep you from sinning."

- 21 The people kept their distance while Moses approached the thick cloud where God was.
- 21 The people remained at a distance, while Moses approached the thick darkness where God was.
- 22 GOD said to Moses, "Give this Message to the People of Israel: 'You've experienced firsthand how I spoke with you from Heaven.
- 22 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Tell the Israelites this: 'You have seen for yourselves that I have spoken to you from heaven:
- 23 Don't make gods of silver and gods of gold and then set them alongside me.
- 23 Do not make any gods to be alongside me; do not make for yourselves gods of silver or gods of gold.
- 24 Make me an earthen Altar. Sacrifice your Whole-Burnt-Offerings, your Peace-Offerings, your sheep, and your cattle on it. Every place where I cause my name to be honored in your worship, I'll be there myself and bless you.
- 24 'Make an altar of earth for me and sacrifice on it your burnt offerings and fellowship offerings, your sheep and goats and your cattle. Wherever I cause my name to be honored, I will come to you and bless you.
- 25 If you use stones to make my Altar, don't use dressed stones. If you use a chisel on the stones you'll profane the Altar.
- 25 If you make an altar of stones for me, do not build it with dressed stones, for you will defile it if you use a tool on it.
- 26 Don't use steps to climb to my Altar because that will expose your nakedness.'
- 26 And do not go up to my altar on steps, lest your nakedness be exposed on it.'

Exodus 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 "These are the laws that you are to place before them:
- 1 These are the laws you are to set before them:
- 2 "When you buy a Hebrew slave, he will serve six years. The seventh year he goes free, for nothing.
- 2 If you buy a Hebrew servant, he is to serve you for six years. But in the seventh year, he shall go free, without paying anything.
- 3 If he came in single he leaves single. If he came in married he leaves with his wife.
- 3 If he comes alone, he is to go free alone; but if he has a wife when he comes, she is to go with him.
- 4 If the master gives him a wife and she gave him sons and daughters, the wife and children stay with the master and he leaves by himself.
- 4 If his master gives him a wife and she bears him sons or daughters, the woman and her children shall belong to her master, and only the man shall go free.
- 5 But suppose the slave should say, 'I love my master and my wife and children--I don't want my freedom,'
- 5 But if the servant declares, 'I love my master and my wife and children and do not want to go free,'
- 6 then his master is to bring him before God and to a door or doorpost and pierce his ear with an awl, a sign that he is a slave for life.
- 6 then his master must take him before the judges. He shall take him to the door or the doorpost and pierce his ear with an awl. Then he will be his servant for life.
- 7 "When a man sells his daughter to be a handmaid, she doesn't go free after six years like the men.
- 7 If a man sells his daughter as a servant, she is not to go free as menservants do.
- 8 If she doesn't please her master, her family must buy her back; her master doesn't have the right to sell her to foreigners since he broke his word to her.

- 8 If she does not please the master who has selected her for himself, he must let her be redeemed. He has no right to sell her to foreigners, because he has broken faith with her.
- 9 If he turns her over to his son, he has to treat her like a daughter.
- 9 If he selects her for his son, he must grant her the rights of a daughter.
- 10 If he marries another woman, she retains all her full rights to meals, clothing, and marital relations.
- 10 If he marries another woman, he must not deprive the first one of her food, clothing and marital rights.
- 11 If he won't do any of these three things for her, she goes free, for nothing.
- 11 If he does not provide her with these three things, she is to go free, without any payment of money.
- 12 "If someone hits another and death results, the penalty is death.
- 12 Anyone who strikes a man and kills him shall surely be put to death.
- 13 But if there was no intent to kill--if it was an accident, an 'act of God'-- I'll set aside a place to which the killer can flee for refuge.
- 13 However, if he does not do it intentionally, but God lets it happen, he is to flee to a place I will designate.
- 14 But if the murder was premeditated, cunningly plotted, then drag the killer away, even if it's from my Altar, to be put to death.
- 14 But if a man schemes and kills another man deliberately, take him away from my altar and put him to death.
- 15 "If someone hits father or mother, the penalty is death.
- 15 Anyone who attacks his father or his mother must be put to death.
- 16 "If someone kidnaps a person, the penalty is death, regardless of whether the person has been sold or is still held in possession.
- 16 Anyone who kidnaps another and either sells him or still has him when he is caught must be put to death.
- 17 "If someone curses father or mother, the penalty is death.
- 17 Anyone who curses his father or mother must be put to death.
- 18 "If a quarrel breaks out and one hits the other with a rock or a fist and the injured one doesn't die but is confined to bed
- 18 If men quarrel and one hits the other with a stone or with his fist and he does not die but is confined to bed,

- 19 and then later gets better and can get about on a crutch, the one who hit him is in the clear, except to pay for the loss of time and make sure of complete recovery.
- 19 the one who struck the blow will not be held responsible if the other gets up and walks around outside with his staff; however, he must pay the injured man for the loss of his time and see that he is completely healed.
- 20 "If a slave owner hits a slave, male or female, with a stick and the slave dies on the spot, the slave must be avenged.
- 20 If a man beats his male or female slave with a rod and the slave dies as a direct result, he must be punished,
- 21 But if the slave survives a day or two, he's not to be avenged--the slave is the owner's property.
- 21 but he is not to be punished if the slave gets up after a day or two, since the slave is his property.
- 22 "When there's a fight and in the fight a pregnant woman is hit so that she miscarries but is not otherwise hurt, the one responsible has to pay whatever the husband demands in compensation.
- 22 If men who are fighting hit a pregnant woman and she gives birth prematurely but there is no serious injury, the offender must be fined whatever the woman's husband demands and the court allows.
- 23 But if there is further damage, then you must give life for life--
- 23 But if there is serious injury, you are to take life for life,
- 24 eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot,
- 24 eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot,
- 25 burn for burn, wound for wound, bruise for bruise.
- 25 burn for burn, wound for wound, bruise for bruise.
- 26 "If a slave owner hits the eye of a slave or handmaid and ruins it, the owner must let the slave go free because of the eye.
- 26 If a man hits a manservant or maidservant in the eye and destroys it, he must let the servant go free to compensate for the eye.
- 27 If the owner knocks out the tooth of the male or female slave, the slave must be released and go free because of the tooth.
- 27 And if he knocks out the tooth of a manservant or maidservant, he must let the servant go free to compensate for the tooth.

- 28 "If an ox gores a man or a woman to death, the ox must be stoned. The meat cannot be eaten but the owner of the ox is in the clear.
- 28 If a bull gores a man or a woman to death, the bull must be stoned to death, and its meat must not be eaten. But the owner of the bull will not be held responsible.
- 29 But if the ox has a history of goring and the owner knew it and did nothing to guard against it, then if the ox kills a man or a woman, the ox is to be stoned and the owner given the death penalty.
- 29 If, however, the bull has had the habit of goring and the owner has been warned but has not kept it penned up and it kills a man or woman, the bull must be stoned and the owner also must be put to death.
- 30 If a ransom is agreed upon instead of death, he must pay it in full as a redemption for his life.
- 30 However, if payment is demanded of him, he may redeem his life by paying whatever is demanded.
- 31 If a son or daughter is gored, the same judgment holds.
- 31 This law also applies if the bull gores a son or daughter.
- 32 If it is a slave or a handmaid the ox gores, thirty shekels of silver is to be paid to the owner and the ox stoned.
- 32 If the bull gores a male or female slave, the owner must pay thirty shekels of silver to the master of the slave, and the bull must be stoned.
- 33 "If someone uncovers a cistern or digs a pit and leaves it open and an ox or donkey falls into it,
- 33 If a man uncovers a pit or digs one and fails to cover it and an ox or a donkey falls into it,
- 34 the owner of the pit must pay whatever the animal is worth to its owner but can keep the dead animal.
- 34 the owner of the pit must pay for the loss; he must pay its owner, and the dead animal will be his.
- 35 "If someone's ox injures a neighbor's ox and the ox dies, they must sell the live ox and split the price; they must also split the dead animal.
- 35 If a man's bull injures the bull of another and it dies, they are to sell the live one and divide both the money and the dead animal equally.
- 36 But if the ox had a history of goring and the owner knew it and did nothing to guard against it, the owner must pay an ox for an ox but can keep the dead animal.

36 However, if it was known that the bull had the habit of goring, yet the owner did not keep it penned up, the owner must pay, animal for animal, and the dead animal will be his.

Exodus 22

MSG

NIV

- 1 "If someone steals an ox or a lamb and slaughters or sells it, the thief must pay five cattle in place of the ox and four sheep in place of the lamb.
- 1 If a man steals an ox or a sheep and slaughters it or sells it, he must pay back five head of cattle for the ox and four sheep for the sheep.
- 2 If the thief is caught while breaking in and is hit hard and dies, there is no bloodguilt.
- 2 If a thief is caught breaking in and is struck so that he dies, the defender is not guilty of bloodshed;
- 3 But if it happens after daybreak, there is bloodguilt. "A thief must make full restitution for what is stolen. The thief who is unable to pay is to be sold for his thieving.
- 3 but if it happens after sunrise, he is guilty of bloodshed. "A thief must certainly make restitution, but if he has nothing, he must be sold to pay for his theft.
- 4 If caught red-handed with the stolen goods, and the ox or donkey or lamb is still alive, the thief pays double.
- 4 If the stolen animal is found alive in his possession-- whether ox or donkey or sheep--he must pay back double.
- 5 "If someone grazes livestock in a field or vineyard but lets them loose so they graze in someone else's field, restitution must be made from the best of the owner's field or vineyard.
- 5 If a man grazes his livestock in a field or vineyard and lets them stray and they graze in another man's field, he must make restitution from the best of his own field or vineyard.
- 6 "If fire breaks out and spreads to the brush so that the sheaves of grain or the standing grain or even the whole field is burned up, whoever started the fire must pay for the damages.

- 6 If a fire breaks out and spreads into thornbushes so that it burns shocks of grain or standing grain or the whole field, the one who started the fire must make restitution.
- 7 "If someone gives a neighbor money or things for safekeeping and they are stolen from the neighbor's house, the thief, if caught, must pay back double.
- 7 If a man gives his neighbor silver or goods for safekeeping and they are stolen from the neighbor's house, the thief, if he is caught, must pay back double.
- 8 If the thief is not caught, the owner must be brought before God to determine whether the owner was the one who took the neighbor's goods.
- 8 But if the thief is not found, the owner of the house must appear before the judges to determine whether he has laid his hands on the other man's property.
- 9 "In all cases of stolen goods, whether oxen, donkeys, sheep, clothing, anything in fact missing of which someone says, 'That's mine,' both parties must come before the judges. The one the judges pronounce guilty must pay double to the other.
- 9 In all cases of illegal possession of an ox, a donkey, a sheep, a garment, or any other lost property about which somebody says, 'This is mine,' both parties are to bring their cases before the judges. The one whom the judges declare guilty must pay back double to his neighbor.
- 10 "If someone gives a donkey or ox or lamb or any kind of animal to another for safekeeping and it dies or is injured or lost and there is no witness,
- 10 If a man gives a donkey, an ox, a sheep or any other animal to his neighbor for safekeeping and it dies or is injured or is taken away while no one is looking,
- 11 an oath before GOD must be made between them to decide whether one has laid hands on the property of the other. The owner must accept this and no damages are assessed.
- 11 the issue between them will be settled by the taking of an oath before the LORD that the neighbor did not lay hands on the other person's property. The owner is to accept this, and no restitution is required.
- 12 But if it turns out it was stolen, the owner must be compensated.

- 12 But if the animal was stolen from the neighbor, he must make restitution to the owner.
- 13 If it has been torn by wild beasts, the torn animal must be brought in as evidence; no damages have to be paid.
- 13 If it was torn to pieces by a wild animal, he shall bring in the remains as evidence and he will not be required to pay for the torn animal.
- 14 "If someone borrows an animal from a neighbor and it gets injured or dies while the owner is not present, he must pay for it.
- 14 If a man borrows an animal from his neighbor and it is injured or dies while the owner is not present, he must make restitution.
- 15 But if the owner was with it, he doesn't have to pay. If the animal was hired, the payment covers the loss.
- 15 But if the owner is with the animal, the borrower will not have to pay. If the animal was hired, the money paid for the hire covers the loss.
- 16 "If a man seduces a virgin who is not engaged to be married and sleeps with her, he must pay the marriage price and marry her.
- 16 If a man seduces a virgin who is not pledged to be married and sleeps with her, he must pay the bride-price, and she shall be his wife.
- 17 If her father absolutely refuses to give her away, the man must still pay the marriage price for virgins.
- 17 If her father absolutely refuses to give her to him, he must still pay the bride-price for virgins.
- 18 "Don't let a sorceress live.
- 18 Do not allow a sorceress to live.
- 19 "Anyone who has sex with an animal gets the death penalty.
- 19 Anyone who has sexual relations with an animal must be put to death.
- 20 "Anyone who sacrifices to a god other than GOD alone must be put to death.
- 20 Whoever sacrifices to any god other than the LORD must be destroyed.
- 21 "Don't abuse or take advantage of strangers; you, remember, were once strangers in Egypt.
- 21 Do not mistreat an alien or oppress him, for you were aliens in Egypt.
- 22 "Don't mistreat widows or orphans.
- 22 Do not take advantage of a widow or an orphan.
- 23 If you do and they cry out to me, you can be sure I'll take them most seriously;

- 23 If you do and they cry out to me, I will certainly hear their cry.
- 24 I'll show my anger and come raging among you with the sword, and your wives will end up widows and your children orphans.
- 24 My anger will be aroused, and I will kill you with the sword; your wives will become widows and your children fatherless.
- 25 "If you lend money to my people, to any of the down-and-out among you, don't come down hard on them and gouge them with interest.
- 25 If you lend money to one of my people among you who is needy, do not be like a moneylender; charge him no interest.
- 26 "If you take your neighbor's coat as security, give it back before nightfall;
- 26 If you take your neighbor's cloak as a pledge, return it to him by sunset,
- 27 it may be your neighbor's only covering--what else does the person have to sleep in? And if I hear the neighbor crying out from the cold, I'll step in--I'm compassionate.
- 27 because his cloak is the only covering he has for his body. What else will he sleep in? When he cries out to me, I will hear, for I am compassionate.
- 28 "Don't curse God; and don't damn your leaders.
- 28 Do not blaspheme God or curse the ruler of your people.
- 29 "Don't be stingy as your wine vats fill up. "Dedicate your firstborn sons to me.
- 29 Do not hold back offerings from your granaries or your vats. You must give me the firstborn of your sons.
- 30 The same with your cattle and sheep--they are to stay for seven days with their mother, then give them to me.
- 30 Do the same with your cattle and your sheep. Let them stay with their mothers for seven days, but give them to me on the eighth day.
- 31 "Be holy for my sake. "Don't eat mutilated flesh you find in the fields; throw it to the dogs.
- 31 You are to be my holy people. So do not eat the meat of an animal torn by wild beasts; throw it to the dogs.

Exodus 23

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Don't pass on malicious gossip. "Don't link up with a wicked person and give corrupt testimony.
- 1 Do not spread false reports. Do not help a wicked man by being a malicious witness.
- 2 Don't go along with the crowd in doing evil and don't fudge your testimony in a case just to please the crowd.
- 2 Do not follow the crowd in doing wrong. When you give testimony in a lawsuit, do not pervert justice by siding with the crowd,
- 3 And just because someone is poor, don't show favoritism in a dispute.
- 3 and do not show favoritism to a poor man in his lawsuit.
- 4 "If you find your enemy's ox or donkey loose, take it back to him.
- 4 If you come across your enemy's ox or donkey wandering off, be sure to take it back to him.
- 5 If you see the donkey of someone who hates you lying helpless under its load, don't walk off and leave it. Help it up.
- 5 If you see the donkey of someone who hates you fallen down under its load, do not leave it there; be sure you help him with it.
- 6 "When there is a dispute concerning your poor, don't tamper with the justice due them.
- 6 Do not deny justice to your poor people in their lawsuits.
- 7 "Stay clear of false accusations. Don't contribute to the death of innocent and good people. I don't let the wicked off the hook.
- 7 Have nothing to do with a false charge and do not put an innocent or honest person to death, for I will not acquit the guilty.
- 8 "Don't take bribes. Bribes blind perfectly good eyes and twist the speech of good people.
- 8 Do not accept a bribe, for a bribe blinds those who see and twists the words of the righteous.
- 9 "Don't take advantage of a stranger. You know what it's like to be a stranger; you were strangers in Egypt.
- 9 Do not oppress an alien; you yourselves know how it feels to be aliens, because you were aliens in Egypt.
- 10 "Sow your land for six years and gather in its crops,
- 10 For six years you are to sow your fields and harvest the crops,

- 11 but in the seventh year leave it alone and give it a rest so that your poor may eat from it. What they leave, let the wildlife have. Do the same with your vineyards and olive groves.
- 11 but during the seventh year let the land lie unplowed and unused. Then the poor among your people may get food from it, and the wild animals may eat what they leave. Do the same with your vineyard and your olive grove.
- 12 "Work for six days and rest the seventh so your ox and donkey may rest and your servant and migrant workers may have time to get their needed rest.
- 12 Six days do your work, but on the seventh day do not work, so that your ox and your donkey may rest and the slave born in your household, and the alien as well, may be refreshed.
- 13 "Listen carefully to everything I tell you. Don't pay attention to other gods--don't so much as mention their names.
- 13 Be careful to do everything I have said to you. Do not invoke the names of other gods; do not let them be heard on your lips.
- 14 "Three times a year you are to hold a festival for me.
- 14 Three times a year you are to celebrate a festival to me.
- 15 "Hold the spring Festival of Unraised Bread when you eat unraised bread for seven days at the time set for the month of Abib, as I commanded you. That was the month you came out of Egypt. No one should show up before me empty-handed.
- 15 Celebrate the Feast of Unleavened Bread; for seven days eat bread made without yeast, as I commanded you. Do this at the appointed time in the month of Abib, for in that month you came out of Egypt. No one is to appear before me empty-handed.
- 16 "Hold the summer Festival of Harvest when you bring in the firstfruits of all your work in the fields. "Hold the autumn Festival of Ingathering at the end of the season when you bring in the year's crops.
- 16 Celebrate the Feast of Harvest with the firstfruits of the crops you sow in your field. Celebrate the Feast of Ingathering at the end of the year, when you gather in your crops from the field.
- 17 "Three times a year all your males are to appear before the Master, GOD.

- 17 Three times a year all the men are to appear before the Sovereign LORD.
- 18 "Don't offer the blood of a sacrifice to me with anything that has yeast in it. "Don't leave the fat from my festival offering out overnight.
- 18 Do not offer the blood of a sacrifice to me along with anything containing yeast. The fat of my festival offerings must not be kept until morning.
- 19 "Bring the choice first produce of the year to the house of your GOD. "Don't boil a kid in its mother's milk.
- 19 Bring the best of the firstfruits of your soil to the house of the LORD your God. Do not cook a young goat in its mother's milk.
- 20 "Now get yourselves ready. I'm sending my Angel ahead of you to guard you in your travels, to lead you to the place that I've prepared.
- 20 See, I am sending an angel ahead of you to guard you along the way and to bring you to the place I have prepared.
- 21 Pay close attention to him. Obey him. Don't go against him. He won't put up with your rebellions because he's acting on my authority.
- 21 Pay attention to him and listen to what he says. Do not rebel against him; he will not forgive your rebellion, since my Name is in him.
- 22 But if you obey him and do everything I tell you, I'll be an enemy to your enemies, I'll fight those who fight you.
- 22 If you listen carefully to what he says and do all that I say, I will be an enemy to your enemies and will oppose those who oppose you.
- 23 When my Angel goes ahead of you and leads you to the land of the Amorites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the Canaanites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites, I'll clear the country of them.
- 23 My angel will go ahead of you and bring you into the land of the Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Canaanites, Hivites and Jebusites, and I will wipe them out.
- 24 So don't worship or serve their gods; don't do anything they do because I'm going to wipe them right off the face of the Earth and smash their sacred phallic pillars to bits.
- 24 Do not bow down before their gods or worship them or follow their practices. You must demolish them and break their sacred stones to pieces.

25 "But you--you serve your GOD and he'll bless your food and your water. I'll get rid of the sickness among you;
25 Worship the LORD your God, and his blessing will be on your food and water. I will take away sickness from among you,
26 there won't be any miscarriages nor barren women in your land. I'll make sure you live full and complete lives.
26 and none will miscarry or be barren in your land. I will give you a full life span.
27 "I'll send my Terror on ahead of you and throw those peoples you're approaching into a panic. All you'll see of your enemies is the backs of their necks.
27 I will send my terror ahead of you and throw into confusion every nation you encounter. I will make all your enemies turn their backs and run.
28 "And I'll send Despair on ahead of you. It will push the Hivites, the Canaanites, and the Hittites out of your way.
28 I will send the hornet ahead of you to drive the Hivites, Canaanites and Hittites out of your way.
29 I won't get rid of them all at once lest the land grow up in weeds and the wild animals take over.
29 But I will not drive them out in a single year, because the land would become desolate and the wild animals too numerous for you.
30 Little by little I'll get them out of there while you have a chance to get your crops going and make the land your own.
30 Little by little I will drive them out before you, until you have increased enough to take possession of the land.
31 I will make your borders stretch from the Red Sea to the Mediterranean Sea and from the Wilderness to the Euphrates River. I'm turning everyone living in that land over to you; go ahead and drive them out.
31 I will establish your borders from the Red Sea to the Sea of the Philistines, and from the desert to the River. I will hand over to you the people who live in the land and you will drive them out before you.
32 "Don't make any deals with them or their gods.
32 Do not make a covenant with them or with their gods.
33 They are not to stay in the same country with you lest they get you to sin by worshiping their gods. Beware. That's a huge danger."

33 Do not let them live in your land, or they will cause you to sin against me, because the worship of their gods will certainly be a snare to you."

Exodus 24

MSG

NIV

- 1 He said to Moses, "Climb the mountain to GOD, you and Aaron, Nadab, Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel. They will worship from a distance;
- 1 Then he said to Moses, "Come up to the LORD, you and Aaron, Nadab and Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel. You are to worship at a distance,
- 2 only Moses will approach GOD. The rest are not to come close. And the people are not to climb the mountain at all."
- 2 but Moses alone is to approach the LORD; the others must not come near. And the people may not come up with him."
- 3 So Moses went to the people and told them everything GOD had said--all the rules and regulations. They all answered in unison: "Everything GOD said, we'll do."
- 3 When Moses went and told the people all the LORD's words and laws, they responded with one voice, "Everything the LORD has said we will do."
- 4 Then Moses wrote it all down, everything GOD had said. He got up early the next morning and built an Altar at the foot of the mountain using twelve pillar-stones for the twelve tribes of Israel.
- 4 Moses then wrote down everything the LORD had said. He got up early the next morning and built an altar at the foot of the mountain and set up twelve stone pillars representing the twelve tribes of Israel.
- 5 Then he directed young Israelite men to offer Whole-Burnt-Offerings and sacrifice Peace-Offerings of bulls.
- 5 Then he sent young Israelite men, and they offered burnt offerings and sacrificed young bulls as fellowship offerings to the LORD.
- 6 Moses took half the blood and put it in bowls; the other half he threw against the Altar.

- 6 Moses took half of the blood and put it in bowls, and the other half he sprinkled on the altar.
- 7 Then he took the Book of the Covenant and read it as the people listened. They said, "Everything GOD said, we'll do. Yes, we'll obey."
- 7 Then he took the Book of the Covenant and read it to the people. They responded, "We will do everything the LORD has said; we will obey."
- 8 Moses took the rest of the blood and threw it out over the people, saying, "This is the blood of the covenant which GOD has made with you out of all these words I have spoken."
- 8 Moses then took the blood, sprinkled it on the people and said, "This is the blood of the covenant that the LORD has made with you in accordance with all these words."
- 9 Then they climbed the mountain--Moses and Aaron, Nadab and Abihu, and seventy of the elders of Israel--
- 9 Moses and Aaron, Nadab and Abihu, and the seventy elders of Israel went up
- 10 and saw the God of Israel. He was standing on a pavement of something like sapphires--pure, clear sky-blue.
- 10 and saw the God of Israel. Under his feet was something like a pavement made of sapphire, clear as the sky itself.
- 11 He didn't hurt these pillar-leaders of the Israelites: They saw God; and they ate and drank.
- 11 But God did not raise his hand against these leaders of the Israelites; they saw God, and they ate and drank.
- 12 GOD said to Moses, "Climb higher up the mountain and wait there for me; I'll give you tablets of stone, the teachings and commandments that I've written to instruct them."
- 12 The LORD said to Moses, "Come up to me on the mountain and stay here, and I will give you the tablets of stone, with the law and commands I have written for their instruction."
- 13 So Moses got up, accompanied by Joshua his aide. And Moses climbed up the mountain of God.
- 13 Then Moses set out with Joshua his aide, and Moses went up on the mountain of God.
- 14 He told the elders of Israel, "Wait for us here until we return to you. You have Aaron and Hur with you; if there are any problems, go to them."

- 14 He said to the elders, "Wait here for us until we come back to you. Aaron and Hur are with you, and anyone involved in a dispute can go to them."
- 15 Then Moses climbed the mountain. The Cloud covered the mountain.
- 15 When Moses went up on the mountain, the cloud covered it,
- 16 The Glory of GOD settled over Mount Sinai. The Cloud covered it for six days. On the seventh day he called out of the Cloud to Moses.
- 16 and the glory of the LORD settled on Mount Sinai. For six days the cloud covered the mountain, and on the seventh day the LORD called to Moses from within the cloud.
- 17 In the view of the Israelites below, the Glory of God looked like a raging fire at the top of the mountain.
- 17 To the Israelites the glory of the LORD looked like a consuming fire on top of the mountain.
- 18 Moses entered the middle of the Cloud and climbed the mountain. Moses was on the mountain forty days and forty nights.
- 18 Then Moses entered the cloud as he went on up the mountain. And he stayed on the mountain forty days and forty nights.

Exodus 25

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD spoke to Moses:
- 1 The LORD said to Moses,
- 2 "Tell the Israelites that they are to set aside offerings for me. Receive the offerings from everyone who is willing to give.
- 2 Tell the Israelites to bring me an offering. You are to receive the offering for me from each man whose heart prompts him to give.
- 3 These are the offerings I want you to receive from them: gold, silver, bronze;
- 3 These are the offerings you are to receive from them: gold, silver and bronze;
- 4 blue, purple, and scarlet material; fine linen; goats' hair;
- 4 blue, purple and scarlet yarn and fine linen; goat hair;
- 5 tanned rams' skins; dolphin skins; acacia wood;

- 5 ram skins dyed red and hides of sea cows; acacia wood;
6 lamp oil; spices for anointing oils and for fragrant incense;
6 olive oil for the light; spices for the anointing oil and for the fragrant incense;
7 onyx stones and other stones for setting in the Ephod and the Breastpiece.
7 and onyx stones and other gems to be mounted on the ephod and breastpiece.
- 8 Let them construct a Sanctuary for me so that I can live among them.
8 Then have them make a sanctuary for me, and I will dwell among them.
9 You are to construct it following the plans I've given you, the design for The Dwelling and the design for all its furnishings.
9 Make this tabernacle and all its furnishings exactly like the pattern I will show you.
- 10 "First let them make a Chest using acacia wood: make it three and three-quarters feet long and two and one-quarter feet wide and deep
10 Have them make a chest of acacia wood--two and a half cubits long, a cubit and a half wide, and a cubit and a half high.
11 . Cover it with a veneer of pure gold inside and out and make a molding of gold all around it.
11 Overlay it with pure gold, both inside and out, and make a gold molding around it.
- 12 Cast four gold rings and attach them to its four feet, two rings on one side and two rings on the other.
12 Cast four gold rings for it and fasten them to its four feet, with two rings on one side and two rings on the other.
- 13 Make poles from acacia wood and cover them with a veneer of gold
13 Then make poles of acacia wood and overlay them with gold.
14 and insert them into the rings on the sides of the Chest for carrying the Chest.
14 Insert the poles into the rings on the sides of the chest to carry it.
15 The poles are to stay in the rings; they must not be removed.
15 The poles are to remain in the rings of this ark; they are not to be removed.
- 16 "Place The Testimony that I give you in the Chest.
16 Then put in the ark the Testimony, which I will give you.

- 17 "Now make a lid of pure gold for the Chest, an Atonement-Cover, three and three-quarters feet long and two and one-quarter feet wide.
- 17 Make an atonement cover of pure gold--two and a half cubits long and a cubit and a half wide.
- 18 "Sculpt two winged angels out of hammered gold for either end of the Atonement-Cover,
- 18 And make two cherubim out of hammered gold at the ends of the cover.
- 19 one angel at one end, one angel at the other. Make them of one piece with the Atonement-Cover.
- 19 Make one cherub on one end and the second cherub on the other; make the cherubim of one piece with the cover, at the two ends.
- 20 Make the angels with their wings spread, hovering over the Atonement-Cover, facing one another but looking down on it.
- 20 The cherubim are to have their wings spread upward, overshadowing the cover with them. The cherubim are to face each other, looking toward the cover.
- 21 Set the Atonement-Cover as a lid over the Chest and place in the Chest The Testimony that I will give you.
- 21 Place the cover on top of the ark and put in the ark the Testimony, which I will give you.
- 22 I will meet you there at set times and speak with you from above the Atonement-Cover and from between the angel-figures that are on it, speaking the commands that I have for the Israelites.
- 22 There, above the cover between the two cherubim that are over the ark of the Testimony, I will meet with you and give you all my commands for the Israelites.
- 23 "Next make a Table from acacia wood. Make it three feet long, one and one-half feet wide and two and one-quarter feet high.
- 23 Make a table of acacia wood--two cubits long, a cubit wide and a cubit and a half high.
- 24 Cover it with a veneer of pure gold. Make a molding all around it of gold.
- 24 Overlay it with pure gold and make a gold molding around it.
- 25 Make the border a handbreadth wide all around it and a rim of gold for the border.

- 25 Also make around it a rim a handbreadth wide and put a gold molding on the rim.
- 26 Make four rings of gold and attach the rings to the four legs
- 26 Make four gold rings for the table and fasten them to the four corners, where the four legs are.
- 27 parallel to the table top. They will serve as holders for the poles used to carry the Table.
- 27 The rings are to be close to the rim to hold the poles used in carrying the table.
- 28 Make the poles of acacia wood and cover them with a veneer of gold. They will be used to carry the Table.
- 28 Make the poles of acacia wood, overlay them with gold and carry the table with them.
- 29 "Make plates, bowls, jars, and jugs for pouring out offerings. Make them of pure gold.
- 29 And make its plates and dishes of pure gold, as well as its pitchers and bowls for the pouring out of offerings.
- 30 "Always keep fresh Bread of the Presence on the Table before me.
- 30 Put the bread of the Presence on this table to be before me at all times.
- 31 "Make a Lampstand of pure hammered gold. Make its stem and branches, cups, calyxes, and petals all of one piece.
- 31 Make a lampstand of pure gold and hammer it out, base and shaft; its flowerlike cups, buds and blossoms shall be of one piece with it.
- 32 Give it six branches, three from one side and three from the other;
- 32 Six branches are to extend from the sides of the lampstand--three on one side and three on the other.
- 33 put three cups shaped like almond blossoms, each with calyx and petals, on one branch, three on the next, and so on--the same for all six branches.
- 33 Three cups shaped like almond flowers with buds and blossoms are to be on one branch, three on the next branch, and the same for all six branches extending from the lampstand.
- 34 On the main stem of the Lampstand, make four cups shaped like almonds, with calyx and petals,
- 34 And on the lampstand there are to be four cups shaped like almond flowers with buds and blossoms.

- 35 a calyx extending from under each pair of the six branches,
35 One bud shall be under the first pair of branches extending from the lampstand, a second bud under the second pair, and a third bud under the third pair--six branches in all.
36 the entire Lampstand fashioned from one piece of hammered pure gold.
36 The buds and branches shall all be of one piece with the lampstand, hammered out of pure gold.
37 "Make seven of these lamps for the Table. Arrange the lamps so they throw their light out in front.
37 Then make its seven lamps and set them up on it so that they light the space in front of it.
38 Make the candle snuffers and trays out of pure gold.
38 Its wick trimmers and trays are to be of pure gold.
39 "Use a seventy-five-pound brick of pure gold to make the Lampstand and its accessories.
39 A talent of pure gold is to be used for the lampstand and all these accessories.
40 Study the design you were given on the mountain and make everything accordingly.
40 See that you make them according to the pattern shown you on the mountain.

Exodus 26

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Make The Dwelling itself from ten panels of tapestry woven from fine twisted linen, blue and purple and scarlet material, with an angel-cherubim design. A skilled craftsman should do it.
1 Make the tabernacle with ten curtains of finely twisted linen and blue, purple and scarlet yarn, with cherubim worked into them by a skilled craftsman.
2 The panels of tapestry are each to be forty-six feet long and six feet wide.
2 All the curtains are to be the same size--twenty- eight cubits long and four cubits wide.
3 Join five of the panels together, and then the other five together.

- 3 Join five of the curtains together, and do the same with the other five.
- 4 Make loops of blue along the edge of the outside panel of the first set and the same on the outside panel of the second set.
- 4 Make loops of blue material along the edge of the end curtain in one set, and do the same with the end curtain in the other set.
- 5 Make fifty loops on each panel.
- 5 Make fifty loops on one curtain and fifty loops on the end curtain of the other set, with the loops opposite each other.
- 6 Then make fifty gold clasps and join the tapestries together so that The Dwelling is one whole.
- 6 Then make fifty gold clasps and use them to fasten the curtains together so that the tabernacle is a unit.
- 7 "Next make tapestries of goat hair for a tent that will cover The Dwelling. Make eleven panels of these tapestries.
- 7 Make curtains of goat hair for the tent over the tabernacle--eleven altogether.
- 8 The length of each panel will be forty-five feet long and six feet wide.
- 8 All eleven curtains are to be the same size--thirty cubits long and four cubits wide.
- 9 Join five of the panels together, and then the other six. Fold the sixth panel double at the front of the tent.
- 9 Join five of the curtains together into one set and the other six into another set. Fold the sixth curtain double at the front of the tent.
- 10 Now make fifty loops along the edge of the end panel and fifty loops along the edge of the joining panel.
- 10 Make fifty loops along the edge of the end curtain in one set and also along the edge of the end curtain in the other set.
- 11 Make fifty clasps of bronze and connect the clasps with the loops, bringing the tent together.
- 11 Then make fifty bronze clasps and put them in the loops to fasten the tent together as a unit.
- 12 "Hang half of the overlap of the tapestry panels over the rear of The Dwelling.
- 12 As for the additional length of the tent curtains, the half curtain that is left over is to hang down at the rear of the tabernacle.

- 13 The eighteen inches of overlap on either side will cover the sides of the tent.
- 13 The tent curtains will be a cubit longer on both sides; what is left will hang over the sides of the tabernacle so as to cover it.
- 14 Finally, make a covering for the tapestries of tanned rams' skins dyed red and over that a covering of dolphin skins.
- 14 Make for the tent a covering of ram skins dyed red, and over that a covering of hides of sea cows.
- 15 "Frame The Dwelling with planks of acacia wood,
- 15 Make upright frames of acacia wood for the tabernacle.
- 16 each section of frame fifteen feet long and two and one-quarter feet wide,
- 16 Each frame is to be ten cubits long and a cubit and a half wide,
- 17 with two pegs for securing them. Make all the frames identical:
- 17 with two projections set parallel to each other. Make all the frames of the tabernacle in this way.
- 18 twenty frames for the south side
- 18 Make twenty frames for the south side of the tabernacle
- 19 with forty silver sockets to receive the two pegs from each of the twenty frames;
- 19 and make forty silver bases to go under them--two bases for each frame, one under each projection.
- 20 the same construction on the north side of The Dwelling;
- 20 For the other side, the north side of the tabernacle, make twenty frames
- 21 (SEE 26:20)
- 21 and forty silver bases--two under each frame.
- 22 for the rear of The Dwelling, which faces west, make six frames
- 22 Make six frames for the far end, that is, the west end of the tabernacle,
- 23 with two additional frames for the rear corners.
- 23 and make two frames for the corners at the far end.
- 24 Both of the two corner frames need to be double in thickness from top to bottom and fit into a single ring--
- 24 At these two corners they must be double from the bottom all the way to the top, and fitted into a single ring; both shall be like that.
- 25 eight frames altogether with sixteen sockets of silver, two under each frame.

- 25 So there will be eight frames and sixteen silver bases--two under each frame.
- 26 "Now make crossbars of acacia wood, five for the frames on one side of The Dwelling,
- 26 Also make crossbars of acacia wood: five for the frames on one side of the tabernacle,
- 27 five for the other side, and five for the back side facing west.
- 27 five for those on the other side, and five for the frames on the west, at the far end of the tabernacle.
- 28 The center crossbar runs from end to end halfway up the frames.
- 28 The center crossbar is to extend from end to end at the middle of the frames.
- 29 Cover the frames with a veneer of gold and make gold rings to hold the crossbars. And cover the crossbars with a veneer of gold.
- 29 Overlay the frames with gold and make gold rings to hold the crossbars. Also overlay the crossbars with gold.
- 30 Then put The Dwelling together, following the design you were shown on the mountain.
- 30 Set up the tabernacle according to the plan shown you on the mountain.
- 31 "Make a curtain of blue, purple, and scarlet material and fine twisted linen. Have a design of angel-cherubim woven into it by a skilled craftsman.
- 31 Make a curtain of blue, purple and scarlet yarn and finely twisted linen, with cherubim worked into it by a skilled craftsman.
- 32 Fasten it with gold hooks to four posts of acacia wood covered with a veneer of gold, set on four silver bases.
- 32 Hang it with gold hooks on four posts of acacia wood overlaid with gold and standing on four silver bases.
- 33 After hanging the curtain from the clasps, bring the Chest of The Testimony in behind the curtain. The curtain will separate the Holy Place from the Holy-of-Holies.
- 33 Hang the curtain from the clasps and place the ark of the Testimony behind the curtain. The curtain will separate the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place.
- 34 Now place the Atonement-Cover lid on the Chest of The Testimony in the Holy-of-Holies.

- 34 Put the atonement cover on the ark of the Testimony in the Most Holy Place.
- 35 Place the Table and the Lampstand outside the curtain, the Lampstand on the south side of The Dwelling and the Table opposite it on the north side.
- 35 Place the table outside the curtain on the north side of the tabernacle and put the lampstand opposite it on the south side.
- 36 "Make a screen for the door of the tent. Weave it from blue, purple, and scarlet material and fine twisted linen.
- 36 For the entrance to the tent make a curtain of blue, purple and scarlet yarn and finely twisted linen--the work of an embroiderer.
- 37 Frame the weaving with five poles of acacia wood covered with a veneer of gold and make gold hooks to hang the weaving. Cast five bronze bases for the poles.
- 37 Make gold hooks for this curtain and five posts of acacia wood overlaid with gold. And cast five bronze bases for them.

Exodus 27

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Make an Altar of acacia wood. Make it seven and a half feet square and four and a half feet high.
- 1 Build an altar of acacia wood, three cubits high; it is to be square, five cubits long and five cubits wide.
- 2 Make horns at each of the four corners. The horns are to be of one piece with the Altar and covered with a veneer of bronze.
- 2 Make a horn at each of the four corners, so that the horns and the altar are of one piece, and overlay the altar with bronze.
- 3 Make buckets for removing the ashes, along with shovels, basins, forks, and fire pans. Make all these utensils from bronze.
- 3 Make all its utensils of bronze-- its pots to remove the ashes, and its shovels, sprinkling bowls, meat forks and firepans.
- 4 Make a grate of bronze mesh and attach bronze rings at each of the four corners.

- 4 Make a grating for it, a bronze network, and make a bronze ring at each of the four corners of the network.
- 5 Put the grate under the ledge of the Altar at the halfway point of the Altar.
- 5 Put it under the ledge of the altar so that it is halfway up the altar.
- 6 Make acacia wood poles for the Altar and cover them with a veneer of bronze.
- 6 Make poles of acacia wood for the altar and overlay them with bronze.
- 7 Insert the poles through the rings on the two sides of the Altar for carrying.
- 7 The poles are to be inserted into the rings so they will be on two sides of the altar when it is carried.
- 8 Use boards to make the Altar, keeping the interior hollow.
- 8 Make the altar hollow, out of boards. It is to be made just as you were shown on the mountain.
- 9 "Make a Courtyard for The Dwelling. The south side is to be 150 feet long. The hangings for the Courtyard are to be woven from fine twisted linen,
- 9 Make a courtyard for the tabernacle. The south side shall be a hundred cubits long and is to have curtains of finely twisted linen,
- 10 with their twenty posts, twenty bronze bases, and fastening hooks and bands of silver.
- 10 with twenty posts and twenty bronze bases and with silver hooks and bands on the posts.
- 11 The north side is to be exactly the same.
- 11 The north side shall also be a hundred cubits long and is to have curtains, with twenty posts and twenty bronze bases and with silver hooks and bands on the posts.
- 12 "For the west end of the Courtyard you will need seventy-five feet of hangings with their ten posts and bases.
- 12 The west end of the courtyard shall be fifty cubits wide and have curtains, with ten posts and ten bases.
- 13 Across the seventy-five feet at the front, or east end,
- 13 On the east end, toward the sunrise, the courtyard shall also be fifty cubits wide.

- 14 you will need twenty-two and a half feet of hangings, with their three posts and bases on one side
- 14 Curtains fifteen cubits long are to be on one side of the entrance, with three posts and three bases,
- 15 and the same for the other side.
- 15 and curtains fifteen cubits long are to be on the other side, with three posts and three bases.
- 16 At the door of the Courtyard make a screen thirty feet long woven from blue, purple, and scarlet stuff, with fine twisted linen, embroidered by a craftsman, and hung on its four posts and bases.
- 16 For the entrance to the courtyard, provide a curtain twenty cubits long, of blue, purple and scarlet yarn and finely twisted linen--the work of an embroiderer--with four posts and four bases.
- 17 All the posts around the Courtyard are to be banded with silver, with hooks of silver and bases of bronze.
- 17 All the posts around the courtyard are to have silver bands and hooks, and bronze bases.
- 18 The Courtyard is to be 150 feet long and seventy-five feet wide. The hangings of fine twisted linen set on their bronze bases are to be seven and a half feet high.
- 18 The courtyard shall be a hundred cubits long and fifty cubits wide, with curtains of finely twisted linen five cubits high, and with bronze bases.
- 19 All the tools used for setting up The Holy Dwelling, including all the pegs in it and the Courtyard, are to be made of bronze.
- 19 All the other articles used in the service of the tabernacle, whatever their function, including all the tent pegs for it and those for the courtyard, are to be of bronze.
- 20 "Now, order the Israelites to bring you pure, clear olive oil for light so that the lamps can be kept burning.
- 20 Command the Israelites to bring you clear oil of pressed olives for the light so that the lamps may be kept burning.
- 21 In the Tent of Meeting, the area outside the curtain that veils The Testimony, Aaron and his sons will keep this light burning from evening until morning before GOD. This is to be a permanent practice down through the generations for Israelites.

- 21 In the Tent of Meeting, outside the curtain that is in front of the Testimony, Aaron and his sons are to keep the lamps burning before the LORD from evening till morning. This is to be a lasting ordinance among the Israelites for the generations to come.

Exodus 28

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Get your brother Aaron and his sons from among the Israelites to serve me as priests: Aaron and his sons Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, Ithamar.
- 1 Have Aaron your brother brought to you from among the Israelites, along with his sons Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar, so they may serve me as priests.
- 2 Make sacred vestments for your brother Aaron to symbolize glory and beauty.
- 2 Make sacred garments for your brother Aaron, to give him dignity and honor.
- 3 Consult with the skilled craftsmen, those whom I have gifted in this work, and arrange for them to make Aaron's vestments, to set him apart as holy, to act as priest for me.
- 3 Tell all the skilled men to whom I have given wisdom in such matters that they are to make garments for Aaron, for his consecration, so he may serve me as priest.
- 4 These are the articles of clothing they are to make: Breastpiece, Ephod, robe, woven tunic, turban, sash. They are making holy vestments for your brother Aaron and his sons as they work as priests for me.
- 4 These are the garments they are to make: a breastpiece, an ephod, a robe, a woven tunic, a turban and a sash. They are to make these sacred garments for your brother Aaron and his sons, so they may serve me as priests.
- 5 They will need gold; blue, purple, and scarlet material; and fine linen.
- 5 Have them use gold, and blue, purple and scarlet yarn, and fine linen.
- 6 "Have the Ephod made from gold; blue, purple, and scarlet material; and fine twisted linen by a skilled craftsman.

- 6 Make the ephod of gold, and of blue, purple and scarlet yarn, and of finely twisted linen--the work of a skilled craftsman.
- 7 Give it two shoulder pieces at two of the corners so it can be fastened.
- 7 It is to have two shoulder pieces attached to two of its corners, so it can be fastened.
- 8 The decorated band on it is to be just like it and of one piece with it: made of gold; blue, purple, and scarlet material; and of fine twisted linen.
- 8 Its skillfully woven waistband is to be like it--of one piece with the ephod and made with gold, and with blue, purple and scarlet yarn, and with finely twisted linen.
- 9 Next take two onyx stones and engrave the names of the sons of Israel on them in the order of their birth,
- 9 Take two onyx stones and engrave on them the names of the sons of Israel
- 10 six names on one stone and the remaining six on the other.
- 10 in the order of their birth--six names on one stone and the remaining six on the other.
- 11 Engrave the names of the sons of Israel on the two stones the way a jeweler engraves a seal. Then mount the stones in settings of filigreed gold.
- 11 Engrave the names of the sons of Israel on the two stones the way a gem cutter engraves a seal. Then mount the stones in gold filigree settings
- 12 Fasten the two stones on the shoulder pieces of the Ephod--they are memorial stones for the Israelites. Aaron will wear these names on his shoulders as a memorial before GOD.
- 12 and fasten them on the shoulder pieces of the ephod as memorial stones for the sons of Israel. Aaron is to bear the names on his shoulders as a memorial before the LORD.
- 13 Make the settings of gold filigree.
- 13 Make gold filigree settings
- 14 Make two chains of pure gold and braid them like cords, then attach the corded chains to the settings.
- 14 and two braided chains of pure gold, like a rope, and attach the chains to the settings.

- 15 "Now make a Breastpiece of Judgment, using skilled craftsmen, the same as with the Ephod. Use gold; blue, purple, and scarlet material; and fine twisted linen.
- 15 Fashion a breastpiece for making decisions--the work of a skilled craftsman. Make it like the ephod: of gold, and of blue, purple and scarlet yarn, and of finely twisted linen.
- 16 Make it nine inches square and folded double.
- 16 It is to be square--a span long and a span wide--and folded double.
- 17 Mount four rows of precious gemstones on it. First row: carnelian, topaz, emerald.
- 17 Then mount four rows of precious stones on it. In the first row there shall be a ruby, a topaz and a beryl;
- 18 Second row: ruby, sapphire, crystal.
- 18 in the second row a turquoise, a sapphire and an emerald;
- 19 Third row: jacinth, agate, amethyst.
- 19 in the third row a jacinth, an agate and an amethyst;
- 20 Fourth row: beryl, onyx, jasper. "Set them in gold filigree.
- 20 in the fourth row a chrysolite, an onyx and a jasper. Mount them in gold filigree settings.
- 21 The twelve stones correspond to the names of the Israelites, with twelve names engraved, one on each, as on a seal for the twelve tribes.
- 21 There are to be twelve stones, one for each of the names of the sons of Israel, each engraved like a seal with the name of one of the twelve tribes.
- 22 "Then make braided chains of pure gold for the Breastpiece, like cords.
- 22 For the breastpiece make braided chains of pure gold, like a rope.
- 23 Make two rings of gold for the Breastpiece and fasten them to the two ends.
- 23 Make two gold rings for it and fasten them to two corners of the breastpiece.
- 24 Fasten the two golden cords to the rings at the ends of the Breastpiece.
- 24 Fasten the two gold chains to the rings at the corners of the breastpiece,
- 25 Then fasten the other ends of the two cords to the two settings of filigree, attaching them to the shoulder pieces of the Ephod in front.
- 25 and the other ends of the chains to the two settings, attaching them to the shoulder pieces of the ephod at the front.

- 26 Then make two rings of gold and fasten them to the two ends of the Breastpiece on its inside edge facing the Ephod.
- 26 Make two gold rings and attach them to the other two corners of the breastpiece on the inside edge next to the ephod.
- 27 Then make two more rings of gold and fasten them in the front of the Ephod to the lower part of the two shoulder pieces, near the seam above the decorated band.
- 27 Make two more gold rings and attach them to the bottom of the shoulder pieces on the front of the ephod, close to the seam just above the waistband of the ephod.
- 28 Fasten the Breastpiece in place by running a cord of blue through its rings to the rings of the Ephod so that it rests secure on the decorated band of the Ephod and won't come loose.
- 28 The rings of the breastpiece are to be tied to the rings of the ephod with blue cord, connecting it to the waistband, so that the breastpiece will not swing out from the ephod.
- 29 "Aaron will regularly carry the names of the sons of Israel on the Breastpiece of Judgment over his heart as he enters the Sanctuary into the presence of GOD for remembrance.
- 29 Whenever Aaron enters the Holy Place, he will bear the names of the sons of Israel over his heart on the breastpiece of decision as a continuing memorial before the LORD.
- 30 Place the Urim and Thummim in the Breastpiece of Judgment. They will be over Aaron's heart when he enters the presence of GOD. In this way Aaron will regularly carry the Breastpiece of Judgment into the presence of GOD.
- 30 Also put the Urim and the Thummim in the breastpiece, so they may be over Aaron's heart whenever he enters the presence of the LORD. Thus Aaron will always bear the means of making decisions for the Israelites over his heart before the LORD.
- 31 "Make the robe for the Ephod entirely of blue,
- 31 Make the robe of the ephod entirely of blue cloth,
- 32 with an opening for the head at the center and a hem on the edge so that it won't tear.
- 32 with an opening for the head in its center. There shall be a woven edge like a collar around this opening, so that it will not tear.

- 33 For the edge of the skirts make pomegranates of blue, purple, and scarlet material all around and alternate them with bells of gold--
- 33 Make pomegranates of blue, purple and scarlet yarn around the hem of the robe, with gold bells between them.
- 34 gold bell and pomegranate, gold bell and pomegranate--all around the hem of the robe.
- 34 The gold bells and the pomegranates are to alternate around the hem of the robe.
- 35 Aaron has to wear it when he does his priestly work. The bells will be heard when he enters the Holy Place and comes into the presence of GOD, and again when he comes out so that he won't die.
- 35 Aaron must wear it when he ministers. The sound of the bells will be heard when he enters the Holy Place before the LORD and when he comes out, so that he will not die.
- 36 "Make a plate of pure gold. Engrave on it as on a seal: 'Holy to GOD.'
- 36 Make a plate of pure gold and engrave on it as on a seal: HOLY TO THE LORD.
- 37 Tie it with a blue cord to the front of the turban.
- 37 Fasten a blue cord to it to attach it to the turban; it is to be on the front of the turban.
- 38 It is to rest there on Aaron's forehead. He'll take on any guilt involved in the sacred offerings that the Israelites consecrate, no matter what they bring. It will always be on Aaron's forehead so that the offerings will be acceptable before GOD.
- 38 It will be on Aaron's forehead, and he will bear the guilt involved in the sacred gifts the Israelites consecrate, whatever their gifts may be. It will be on Aaron's forehead continually so that they will be acceptable to the LORD.
- 39 "Weave the tunic of fine linen. Make the turban of fine linen. The sash will be the work of an embroiderer.
- 39 Weave the tunic of fine linen and make the turban of fine linen. The sash is to be the work of an embroiderer.
- 40 Make tunics, sashes, and hats for Aaron's sons to express glory and beauty.
- 40 Make tunics, sashes and headbands for Aaron's sons, to give them dignity and honor.

- 41 Dress your brother Aaron and his sons in them. Anoint, ordain, and consecrate them to serve me as priests.
- 41 After you put these clothes on your brother Aaron and his sons, anoint and ordain them. Consecrate them so they may serve me as priests.
- 42 "Make linen underwear to cover their nakedness from waist to thigh.
- 42 Make linen undergarments as a covering for the body, reaching from the waist to the thigh.
- 43 Aaron and his sons must wear it whenever they enter the Tent of Meeting or approach the Altar to minister in the Holy Place so that they won't incur guilt and die. This is a permanent rule for Aaron and all his priest-descendants.
- 43 Aaron and his sons must wear them whenever they enter the Tent of Meeting or approach the altar to minister in the Holy Place, so that they will not incur guilt and die. "This is to be a lasting ordinance for Aaron and his descendants.

Exodus 29

MSG

NIV

- 1 "This is the ceremony for consecrating them as priests. Take a young bull and two rams, healthy and without defects.
- 1 This is what you are to do to consecrate them, so they may serve me as priests: Take a young bull and two rams without defect.
- 2 Using fine wheat flour but no yeast make bread and cakes mixed with oil and wafers spread with oil.
- 2 And from fine wheat flour, without yeast, make bread, and cakes mixed with oil, and wafers spread with oil.
- 3 Place them in a basket and carry them along with the bull and the two rams.
- 3 Put them in a basket and present them in it--along with the bull and the two rams.
- 4 Bring Aaron and his sons to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting and wash them with water.
- 4 Then bring Aaron and his sons to the entrance to the Tent of Meeting and wash them with water.

- 5 "Then take the vestments and dress Aaron in the tunic, the robe of the Ephod, the Ephod, and the Breastpiece, belting the Ephod on him with the embroidered waistband.
- 5 Take the garments and dress Aaron with the tunic, the robe of the ephod, the ephod itself and the breastpiece. Fasten the ephod on him by its skillfully woven waistband.
- 6 Set the turban on his head and place the sacred crown on the turban.
- 6 Put the turban on his head and attach the sacred diadem to the turban.
- 7 Then take the anointing oil and pour it on his head, anointing him.
- 7 Take the anointing oil and anoint him by pouring it on his head.
- 8 Then bring his sons, put tunics on them
- 8 Bring his sons and dress them in tunics
- 9 and gird them with sashes, both Aaron and his sons, and set hats on them. Their priesthood is upheld by law and is permanent. "This is how you will ordain Aaron and his sons:
- 9 and put headbands on them. Then tie sashes on Aaron and his sons. The priesthood is theirs by a lasting ordinance. In this way you shall ordain Aaron and his sons.
- 10 Bring the bull to the Tent of Meeting. Aaron and his sons will place their hands on the head of the bull.
- 10 Bring the bull to the front of the Tent of Meeting, and Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands on its head.
- 11 Then you will slaughter the bull in the presence of GOD at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting.
- 11 Slaughter it in the LORD's presence at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting.
- 12 Take some of the bull's blood and smear it on the horns of the Altar with your finger; pour the rest of the blood on the base of the Altar.
- 12 Take some of the bull's blood and put it on the horns of the altar with your finger, and pour out the rest of it at the base of the altar.
- 13 Next take all the fat that covers the innards, fat from around the liver and the two kidneys, and burn it on the Altar.
- 13 Then take all the fat around the inner parts, the covering of the liver, and both kidneys with the fat on them, and burn them on the altar.
- 14 But the flesh of the bull, including its hide and dung, you will burn up outside the camp. It is an Absolution-Offering.

- 14 But burn the bull's flesh and its hide and its offal outside the camp. It is a sin offering.
- 15 "Then take one of the rams. Have Aaron and his sons place their hands on the head of the ram.
- 15 Take one of the rams, and Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands on its head.
- 16 Slaughter the ram and take its blood and throw it against the Altar, all around.
- 16 Slaughter it and take the blood and sprinkle it against the altar on all sides.
- 17 Cut the ram into pieces; wash its innards and legs, then gather the pieces and its head
- 17 Cut the ram into pieces and wash the inner parts and the legs, putting them with the head and the other pieces.
- 18 and burn the whole ram on the Altar. It is a Whole-Burnt-Offering to GOD, a pleasant fragrance, an offering by fire to GOD.
- 18 Then burn the entire ram on the altar. It is a burnt offering to the LORD, a pleasing aroma, an offering made to the LORD by fire.
- 19 "Then take the second ram. Have Aaron and his sons place their hands on the ram's head.
- 19 Take the other ram, and Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands on its head.
- 20 Slaughter the ram. Take some of its blood and rub it on Aaron's right earlobe and on the right earlobes of his sons, on the thumbs of their right hands and on the big toes of their right feet. Sprinkle the rest of the blood against all sides of the Altar.
- 20 Slaughter it, take some of its blood and put it on the lobes of the right ears of Aaron and his sons, on the thumbs of their right hands, and on the big toes of their right feet. Then sprinkle blood against the altar on all sides.
- 21 Then take some of the blood that is on the Altar, mix it with some of the anointing oil, and splash it on Aaron and his clothes and on his sons and their clothes so that Aaron and his clothes and his sons and his sons' clothes will be made holy.
- 21 And take some of the blood on the altar and some of the anointing oil and sprinkle it on Aaron and his garments and on his sons and their

- garments. Then he and his sons and their garments will be consecrated.
- 22 "Take the fat from the ram, the fat tail, the fat that covers the innards, the long lobe of the liver, the two kidneys and the fat on them, and the right thigh: this is the ordination ram.
- 22 Take from this ram the fat, the fat tail, the fat around the inner parts, the covering of the liver, both kidneys with the fat on them, and the right thigh. (This is the ram for the ordination.)
- 23 Also take one loaf of bread, an oil cake, and a wafer from the breadbasket that is in the presence of GOD.
- 23 From the basket of bread made without yeast, which is before the LORD, take a loaf, and a cake made with oil, and a wafer.
- 24 "Place all of these in the open hands of Aaron and his sons who will wave them before GOD, a Wave-Offering.
- 24 Put all these in the hands of Aaron and his sons and wave them before the LORD as a wave offering.
- 25 Then take them from their hands and burn them on the Altar with the Whole-Burnt-Offering--a pleasing fragrance before GOD, a gift to GOD.
- 25 Then take them from their hands and burn them on the altar along with the burnt offering for a pleasing aroma to the LORD, an offering made to the LORD by fire.
- 26 "Now take the breast from Aaron's ordination ram and wave it before GOD, a Wave-Offering. That will be your portion.
- 26 After you take the breast of the ram for Aaron's ordination, wave it before the LORD as a wave offering, and it will be your share.
- 27 "Consecrate the Wave-Offering breast and the thigh that was held up. These are the parts of the ordination ram that are for Aaron and his sons.
- 27 Consecrate those parts of the ordination ram that belong to Aaron and his sons: the breast that was waved and the thigh that was presented.
- 28 Aaron and his sons are always to get this offering from the Israelites; the Israelites are to make this offering regularly from their Peace-Offerings.
- 28 This is always to be the regular share from the Israelites for Aaron and his sons. It is the contribution the Israelites are to make to the LORD from their fellowship offerings.
- 29 "Aaron's sacred garments are to be handed down to his descendants so they can be anointed and ordained in them.

- 29 Aaron's sacred garments will belong to his descendants so that they can be anointed and ordained in them.
- 30 The son who succeeds him as priest is to wear them for seven days and enter the Tent of Meeting to minister in the Holy Place.
- 30 The son who succeeds him as priest and comes to the Tent of Meeting to minister in the Holy Place is to wear them seven days.
- 31 "Take the ordination ram and boil the meat in the Holy Place.
- 31 Take the ram for the ordination and cook the meat in a sacred place.
- 32 At the entrance to the Tent of Meeting, Aaron and his sons will eat the boiled ram and the bread that is in the basket.
- 32 At the entrance to the Tent of Meeting, Aaron and his sons are to eat the meat of the ram and the bread that is in the basket.
- 33 Atoned by these offerings, ordained and consecrated by them, they are the only ones who are to eat them. No outsiders are to eat them; they're holy.
- 33 They are to eat these offerings by which atonement was made for their ordination and consecration. But no one else may eat them, because they are sacred.
- 34 Anything from the ordination ram or from the bread that is left over until morning you are to burn up. Don't eat it; it's holy.
- 34 And if any of the meat of the ordination ram or any bread is left over till morning, burn it up. It must not be eaten, because it is sacred.
- 35 "Do everything for the ordination of Aaron and his sons exactly as I've commanded you throughout the seven days.
- 35 Do for Aaron and his sons everything I have commanded you, taking seven days to ordain them.
- 36 Offer a bull as an Absolution-Offering for atonement each day. Offer it on the Altar when you make atonement for it: Anoint and consecrate it.
- 36 Sacrifice a bull each day as a sin offering to make atonement. Purify the altar by making atonement for it, and anoint it to consecrate it.
- 37 Make atonement for the Altar and consecrate it for seven days; the Altar will become soaked in holiness--anyone who so much as touches the Altar will become holy.
- 37 For seven days make atonement for the altar and consecrate it. Then the altar will be most holy, and whatever touches it will be holy.

38 "This is what you are to offer on the Altar: two year-old lambs each and every day,

38 This is what you are to offer on the altar regularly each day: two lambs a year old.

39 one lamb in the morning and the second lamb at evening.

39 Offer one in the morning and the other at twilight.

40 With the sacrifice of the first lamb offer two quarts of fine flour with a quart of virgin olive oil, plus a quart of wine for a Drink-Offering.

40 With the first lamb offer a tenth of an ephah of fine flour mixed with a quarter of a hin of oil from pressed olives, and a quarter of a hin of wine as a drink offering.

41 The sacrifice of the second lamb, the one at evening, is also to be accompanied by the same Grain-Offering and Drink-Offering of the morning sacrifice to give a pleasing fragrance, a gift to GOD.

41 Sacrifice the other lamb at twilight with the same grain offering and its drink offering as in the morning--a pleasing aroma, an offering made to the LORD by fire.

42 "This is to be your regular, daily Whole-Burnt-Offering before GOD, generation after generation, sacrificed at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. That's where I'll meet you; that's where I'll speak with you;

42 For the generations to come this burnt offering is to be made regularly at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting before the LORD. There I will meet you and speak to you;

43 that's where I'll meet the Israelites, at the place made holy by my Glory.

43 there also I will meet with the Israelites, and the place will be consecrated by my glory.

44 I'll make the Tent of Meeting and the Altar holy. I'll make Aaron and his sons holy in order to serve me as priests.

44 So I will consecrate the Tent of Meeting and the altar and will consecrate Aaron and his sons to serve me as priests.

45 I'll move in and live with the Israelites. I'll be their God.

45 Then I will dwell among the Israelites and be their God.

46 They'll realize that I am their GOD who brought them out of the land of Egypt so that I could live with them. I am GOD, your God.

46 They will know that I am the LORD their God, who brought them out of Egypt so that I might dwell among them. I am the LORD their God.

Exodus 30

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Make an Altar for burning incense. Construct it from acacia wood,
- 1 Make an altar of acacia wood for burning incense.
- 2 one and one-half feet square and three feet high with its horns of one piece with it.
- 2 It is to be square, a cubit long and a cubit wide, and two cubits high--its horns of one piece with it.
- 3 Cover it with a veneer of pure gold, its top, sides, and horns, and make a gold molding around it
- 3 Overlay the top and all the sides and the horns with pure gold, and make a gold molding around it.
- 4 with two rings of gold beneath the molding. Place the rings on the two opposing sides to serve as holders for poles by which it will be carried.
- 4 Make two gold rings for the altar below the molding--two on opposite sides--to hold the poles used to carry it.
- 5 Make the poles of acacia wood and cover them with a veneer of gold.
- 5 Make the poles of acacia wood and overlay them with gold.
- 6 "Place the Altar in front of the curtain that hides the Chest of The Testimony, in front of the Atonement-Cover that is over The Testimony where I will meet you.
- 6 Put the altar in front of the curtain that is before the ark of the Testimony--before the atonement cover that is over the Testimony--where I will meet with you.
- 7 Aaron will burn fragrant incense on it every morning when he polishes the lamps,
- 7 Aaron must burn fragrant incense on the altar every morning when he tends the lamps.
- 8 and again in the evening as he prepares the lamps for lighting, so that there will always be incense burning before GOD, generation after generation.
- 8 He must burn incense again when he lights the lamps at twilight so incense will burn regularly before the LORD for the generations to come.

- 9 But don't burn on this Altar any unholy incense or Whole-Burnt-Offering or Grain-Offering. And don't pour out Drink-Offerings on it.
- 9 Do not offer on this altar any other incense or any burnt offering or grain offering, and do not pour a drink offering on it.
- 10 Once a year Aaron is to purify the Altar horns. Using the blood of the Absolution-Offering of atonement, he is to make this atonement every year down through the generations. It is most holy to GOD."
- 10 Once a year Aaron shall make atonement on its horns. This annual atonement must be made with the blood of the atoning sin offering for the generations to come. It is most holy to the LORD."
- 11 GOD spoke to Moses:
- 11 Then the LORD said to Moses,
- 12 "When you take a head count of the Israelites to keep track of them, all must pay an atonement-tax to GOD for their life at the time of being registered so that nothing bad will happen because of the registration.
- 12 When you take a census of the Israelites to count them, each one must pay the LORD a ransom for his life at the time he is counted. Then no plague will come on them when you number them.
- 13 Everyone who gets counted is to give a half-shekel (using the standard Sanctuary shekel of a fifth of an ounce to the shekel)--a half-shekel offering to GOD.
- 13 Each one who crosses over to those already counted is to give a half shekel, according to the sanctuary shekel, which weighs twenty gerahs. This half shekel is an offering to the LORD.
- 14 Everyone counted, age twenty and up, is to make the offering to GOD.
- 14 All who cross over, those twenty years old or more, are to give an offering to the LORD.
- 15 The rich are not to pay more nor the poor less than the half-shekel offering to GOD, the atonement-tax for your lives.
- 15 The rich are not to give more than a half shekel and the poor are not to give less when you make the offering to the LORD to atone for your lives.
- 16 Take the atonement-tax money from the Israelites and put it to the maintenance of the Tent of Meeting. It will be a memorial fund for the Israelites in honor of GOD, making atonement for your lives."

- 16 Receive the atonement money from the Israelites and use it for the service of the Tent of Meeting. It will be a memorial for the Israelites before the LORD, making atonement for your lives."
- 17 GOD spoke to Moses:
- 17 Then the LORD said to Moses,
- 18 "Make a bronze Washbasin; make it with a bronze base. Place it between the Tent of Meeting and the Altar. Put water in it.
- 18 Make a bronze basin, with its bronze stand, for washing. Place it between the Tent of Meeting and the altar, and put water in it.
- 19 Aaron and his sons will wash their hands and feet in it.
- 19 Aaron and his sons are to wash their hands and feet with water from it.
- 20 When they enter the Tent of Meeting or approach the Altar to serve there or offer gift offerings to GOD, they are to wash so they will not die.
- 20 Whenever they enter the Tent of Meeting, they shall wash with water so that they will not die. Also, when they approach the altar to minister by presenting an offering made to the LORD by fire,
- 21 They are to wash their hands and their feet so they will not die. This is the rule forever, for Aaron and his sons down through the generations."
- 21 they shall wash their hands and feet so that they will not die. This is to be a lasting ordinance for Aaron and his descendants for the generations to come."
- 22 GOD spoke to Moses:
- 22 Then the LORD said to Moses,
- 23 "Take the best spices: twelve and a half pounds of liquid myrrh; half that much, six and a quarter pounds, of fragrant cinnamon; six and a quarter pounds of fragrant cane;
- 23 Take the following fine spices: 500 shekels of liquid myrrh, half as much (that is, 250 shekels) of fragrant cinnamon, 250 shekels of fragrant cane,
- 24 twelve and a half pounds of cassia--using the standard Sanctuary weight for all of them--and a gallon of olive oil.
- 24 500 shekels of cassia--all according to the sanctuary shekel--and a hin of olive oil.
- 25 Make these into a holy anointing oil, a perfumer's skillful blend.

25 Make these into a sacred anointing oil, a fragrant blend, the work of a perfumer. It will be the sacred anointing oil.

26 "Use it to anoint the Tent of Meeting, the Chest of The Testimony,

26 Then use it to anoint the Tent of Meeting, the ark of the Testimony,

27 the Table and all its utensils, the Lampstand and its utensils, the Altar of Incense,

27 the table and all its articles, the lampstand and its accessories, the altar of incense,

28 the Altar of Whole-Burnt-Offerings and all its utensils, and the Washbasin and its base.

28 the altar of burnt offering and all its utensils, and the basin with its stand.

29 Consecrate them so they'll be soaked in holiness, so that anyone who so much as touches them will become holy.

29 You shall consecrate them so they will be most holy, and whatever touches them will be holy.

30 "Then anoint Aaron and his sons. Consecrate them as priests to me.

30 Anoint Aaron and his sons and consecrate them so they may serve me as priests.

31 Tell the Israelites, 'This will be my holy anointing oil throughout your generations.'

31 Say to the Israelites, 'This is to be my sacred anointing oil for the generations to come.

32 Don't pour it on ordinary men. Don't copy this mixture to use for yourselves. It's holy; keep it holy.

32 Do not pour it on men's bodies and do not make any oil with the same formula. It is sacred, and you are to consider it sacred.

33 Whoever mixes up anything like it, or puts it on an ordinary person, will be expelled."

33 Whoever makes perfume like it and whoever puts it on anyone other than a priest must be cut off from his people.' "

34 GOD spoke to Moses: "Take fragrant spices--gum resin, onycha, galbanum--and add pure frankincense. Mix the spices in equal proportions

34 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Take fragrant spices--gum resin, onycha and galbanum--and pure frankincense, all in equal amounts,

- 35 to make an aromatic incense, the art of a perfumer, salted and pure--
holy.
- 35 and make a fragrant blend of incense, the work of a perfumer. It is to be
salted and pure and sacred.
- 36 Now crush some of it into powder and place some of it before The
Testimony in the Tent of Meeting where I will meet with you; it will be
for you the holiest of holy places.
- 36 Grind some of it to powder and place it in front of the Testimony in the
Tent of Meeting, where I will meet with you. It shall be most holy to
you.
- 37 When you make this incense, you are not to copy the mixture for your
own use. It's holy to GOD; keep it that way.
- 37 Do not make any incense with this formula for yourselves; consider it
holy to the LORD.
- 38 Whoever copies it for personal use will be excommunicated."
- 38 Whoever makes any like it to enjoy its fragrance must be cut off from
his people."

Exodus 31

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD spoke to Moses:
- 1 Then the LORD said to Moses,
- 2 "See what I've done; I've personally chosen Bezalel son of Uri, son of
Hur of the tribe of Judah.
- 2 See, I have chosen Bezalel son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of
Judah,
- 3 I've filled him with the Spirit of God, giving him skill and know-how and
expertise in every kind of craft
- 3 and I have filled him with the Spirit of God, with skill, ability and
knowledge in all kinds of crafts--
- 4 to create designs and work in gold, silver, and bronze;
- 4 to make artistic designs for work in gold, silver and bronze,
- 5 to cut and set gemstones; to carve wood--he's an all-around craftsman.

5 to cut and set stones, to work in wood, and to engage in all kinds of craftsmanship.

6 "Not only that, but I've given him Oholiab, son of Ahisamach of the tribe of Dan, to work with him. And to all who have an aptitude for crafts I've given the skills to make all the things I've commanded you:

6 Moreover, I have appointed Oholiab son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan, to help him. Also I have given skill to all the craftsmen to make everything I have commanded you:

7 the Tent of Meeting, the Chest of The Testimony and its Atonement-Cover, all the implements for the Tent,

7 the Tent of Meeting, the ark of the Testimony with the atonement cover on it, and all the other furnishings of the tent--

8 the Table and its implements, the pure Lampstand and all its implements, the Altar of Incense,

8 the table and its articles, the pure gold lampstand and all its accessories, the altar of incense,

9 the Altar of Whole-Burnt-Offering and all its implements, the Washbasin and its base,

9 the altar of burnt offering and all its utensils, the basin with its stand--

10 the official vestments, the holy vestments for Aaron the priest and his sons in their priestly duties,

10 and also the woven garments, both the sacred garments for Aaron the priest and the garments for his sons when they serve as priests,

11 the anointing oil, and the aromatic incense for the Holy Place--they'll make everything just the way I've commanded you."

11 and the anointing oil and fragrant incense for the Holy Place. They are to make them just as I commanded you."

12 GOD spoke to Moses:

12 Then the LORD said to Moses,

13 "Tell the Israelites, 'Above all, keep my Sabbaths, the sign between me and you, generation after generation, to keep the knowledge alive that I am the GOD who makes you holy.

13 Say to the Israelites, 'You must observe my Sabbaths. This will be a sign between me and you for the generations to come, so you may know that I am the LORD, who makes you holy.

- 14 Keep the Sabbath; it's holy to you. Whoever profanes it will most certainly be put to death. Whoever works on it will be excommunicated from the people.
- 14 'Observe the Sabbath, because it is holy to you. Anyone who desecrates it must be put to death; whoever does any work on that day must be cut off from his people.
- 15 There are six days for work but the seventh day is Sabbath, pure rest, holy to GOD. Anyone who works on the Sabbath will most certainly be put to death.
- 15 For six days, work is to be done, but the seventh day is a Sabbath of rest, holy to the LORD. Whoever does any work on the Sabbath day must be put to death.
- 16 The Israelites will keep the Sabbath, observe Sabbath-keeping down through the generations, as a standing covenant.
- 16 The Israelites are to observe the Sabbath, celebrating it for the generations to come as a lasting covenant.
- 17 It's a fixed sign between me and the Israelites. Yes, because in six days GOD made the Heavens and the Earth and on the seventh day he stopped and took a long, deep breath."
- 17 It will be a sign between me and the Israelites forever, for in six days the LORD made the heavens and the earth, and on the seventh day he abstained from work and rested.' "
- 18 When he finished speaking with him on Mount Sinai, he gave Moses two tablets of Testimony, slabs of stone, written with the finger of God.
- 18 When the LORD finished speaking to Moses on Mount Sinai, he gave him the two tablets of the Testimony, the tablets of stone inscribed by the finger of God.

Exodus 32

MSG

NIV

- 1 When the people realized that Moses was taking forever in coming down off the mountain, they rallied around Aaron and said, "Do something. Make gods for us who will lead us. That Moses, the man who got us out of Egypt--who knows what's happened to him?"

- 1 When the people saw that Moses was so long in coming down from the mountain, they gathered around Aaron and said, "Come, make us gods who will go before us. As for this fellow Moses who brought us up out of Egypt, we don't know what has happened to him."
- 2 So Aaron told them, "Take off the gold rings from the ears of your wives and sons and daughters and bring them to me."
- 2 Aaron answered them, "Take off the gold earrings that your wives, your sons and your daughters are wearing, and bring them to me."
- 3 They all did it; they removed the gold rings from their ears and brought them to Aaron.
- 3 So all the people took off their earrings and brought them to Aaron.
- 4 He took the gold from their hands and cast it in the form of a calf, shaping it with an engraving tool. The people responded with enthusiasm: "These are your gods, O Israel, who brought you up from Egypt!"
- 4 He took what they handed him and made it into an idol cast in the shape of a calf, fashioning it with a tool. Then they said, "These are your gods, O Israel, who brought you up out of Egypt."
- 5 Aaron, taking in the situation, built an altar before the calf. Aaron then announced, "Tomorrow is a feast day to GOD!"
- 5 When Aaron saw this, he built an altar in front of the calf and announced, "Tomorrow there will be a festival to the LORD."
- 6 Early the next morning, the people got up and offered Whole-Burnt-Offerings and brought Peace-Offerings. The people sat down to eat and drink and then began to party. It turned into a wild party!
- 6 So the next day the people rose early and sacrificed burnt offerings and presented fellowship offerings. Afterward they sat down to eat and drink and got up to indulge in revelry.
- 7 GOD spoke to Moses, "Go! Get down there! Your people whom you brought up from the land of Egypt have fallen to pieces."
- 7 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go down, because your people, whom you brought up out of Egypt, have become corrupt."
- 8 In no time at all they've turned away from the way I commanded them: They made a molten calf and worshiped it. They've sacrificed to it and said, "These are the gods, O Israel, that brought you up from the land of Egypt!"

- 8 They have been quick to turn away from what I commanded them and have made themselves an idol cast in the shape of a calf. They have bowed down to it and sacrificed to it and have said, 'These are your gods, O Israel, who brought you up out of Egypt.'
- 9 GOD said to Moses, "I look at this people--oh! what a stubborn, hard-headed people!
- 9 I have seen these people, the LORD said to Moses, "and they are a stiff-necked people.
- 10 Let me alone now, give my anger free reign to burst into flames and incinerate them. But I'll make a great nation out of you."
- 10 Now leave me alone so that my anger may burn against them and that I may destroy them. Then I will make you into a great nation."
- 11 Moses tried to calm his GOD down. He said, "Why, GOD, would you lose your temper with your people? Why, you brought them out of Egypt in a tremendous demonstration of power and strength.
- 11 But Moses sought the favor of the LORD his God. "O LORD," he said, "why should your anger burn against your people, whom you brought out of Egypt with great power and a mighty hand?
- 12 Why let the Egyptians say, 'He had it in for them--he brought them out so he could kill them in the mountains, wipe them right off the face of the Earth.' Stop your anger. Think twice about bringing evil against your people!
- 12 Why should the Egyptians say, 'It was with evil intent that he brought them out, to kill them in the mountains and to wipe them off the face of the earth'? Turn from your fierce anger; relent and do not bring disaster on your people.
- 13 Think of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, your servants to whom you gave your word, telling them 'I will give you many children, as many as the stars in the sky, and I'll give this land to your children as their land forever.'"
- 13 Remember your servants Abraham, Isaac and Israel, to whom you swore by your own self: 'I will make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky and I will give your descendants all this land I promised them, and it will be their inheritance forever.' "
- 14 And GOD did think twice. He decided not to do the evil he had threatened against his people.

- 14 Then the LORD relented and did not bring on his people the disaster he had threatened.
- 15 Moses turned around and came down from the mountain, carrying the two tablets of The Testimony. The tablets were written on both sides, front and back.
- 15 Moses turned and went down the mountain with the two tablets of the Testimony in his hands. They were inscribed on both sides, front and back.
- 16 God made the tablets and God wrote the tablets--engraved them.
- 16 The tablets were the work of God; the writing was the writing of God, engraved on the tablets.
- 17 When Joshua heard the sound of the people shouting noisily, he said to Moses, "That's the sound of war in the camp!"
- 17 When Joshua heard the noise of the people shouting, he said to Moses, "There is the sound of war in the camp."
- 18 But Moses said, Those aren't songs of victory, And those aren't songs of defeat, I hear songs of people throwing a party.
- 18 Moses replied: "It is not the sound of victory, it is not the sound of defeat; it is the sound of singing that I hear."
- 19 And that's what it was. When Moses came near to the camp and saw the calf and the people dancing, his anger flared. He threw down the tablets and smashed them to pieces at the foot of the mountain.
- 19 When Moses approached the camp and saw the calf and the dancing, his anger burned and he threw the tablets out of his hands, breaking them to pieces at the foot of the mountain.
- 20 He took the calf that they had made, melted it down with fire, pulverized it to powder, then scattered it on the water and made the Israelites drink it.
- 20 And he took the calf they had made and burned it in the fire; then he ground it to powder, scattered it on the water and made the Israelites drink it.
- 21 Moses said to Aaron, "What on Earth did these people ever do to you that you involved them in this huge sin?"
- 21 He said to Aaron, "What did these people do to you, that you led them into such great sin?"

22 Aaron said, "Master, don't be angry. You know this people and how set on evil they are.

22 Do not be angry, my lord, Aaron answered. "You know how prone these people are to evil.

23 They said to me, 'Make us gods who will lead us. This Moses, the man who brought us out of Egypt, we don't know what's happened to him.'

23 They said to me, 'Make us gods who will go before us. As for this fellow Moses who brought us up out of Egypt, we don't know what has happened to him.'

24 "So I said, 'Who has gold?' And they took off their jewelry and gave it to me. I threw it in the fire and out came this calf."

24 So I told them, 'Whoever has any gold jewelry, take it off.' Then they gave me the gold, and I threw it into the fire, and out came this calf!"

25 Moses saw that the people were simply running wild--Aaron had let them run wild, disgracing themselves before their enemies.

25 Moses saw that the people were running wild and that Aaron had let them get out of control and so become a laughingstock to their enemies.

26 He took up a position at the entrance to the camp and said, "Whoever is on GOD's side, join me!" All the Levites stepped up.

26 So he stood at the entrance to the camp and said, "Whoever is for the LORD, come to me." And all the Levites rallied to him.

27 He then told them, "GOD's orders, the God of Israel: 'Strap on your swords and go to work. Crisscross the camp from one end to the other: Kill brother, friend, neighbor.'"

27 Then he said to them, "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Each man strap a sword to his side. Go back and forth through the camp from one end to the other, each killing his brother and friend and neighbor.' "

28 The Levites carried out Moses' orders. Three thousand of the people were killed that day.

28 The Levites did as Moses commanded, and that day about three thousand of the people died.

29 Moses said, "You confirmed your ordination today--and at great cost, even killing your sons and brothers! And God has blessed you."

29 Then Moses said, "You have been set apart to the LORD today, for you were against your own sons and brothers, and he has blessed you this

day."

30 The next day Moses addressed the people: "You have sinned an enormous sin! But I am going to go up to GOD; maybe I'll be able to clear you of your sin."

30 The next day Moses said to the people, "You have committed a great sin. But now I will go up to the LORD; perhaps I can make atonement for your sin."

31 Moses went back to GOD and said, "This is terrible. This people has sinned--it's an enormous sin! They made gods of gold for themselves.

31 So Moses went back to the LORD and said, "Oh, what a great sin these people have committed! They have made themselves gods of gold.

32 And now, if you will only forgive their sin. . . . But if not, erase me out of the book you've written."

32 But now, please forgive their sin--but if not, then blot me out of the book you have written."

33 GOD said to Moses, "I'll only erase from my book those who sin against me.

33 The LORD replied to Moses, "Whoever has sinned against me I will blot out of my book.

34 For right now, you go and lead the people to where I told you. Look, my Angel is going ahead of you. On the day, though, when I settle accounts, their sins will certainly be part of the settlement."

34 Now go, lead the people to the place I spoke of, and my angel will go before you. However, when the time comes for me to punish, I will punish them for their sin."

35 GOD sent a plague on the people because of the calf they and Aaron had made.

35 And the LORD struck the people with a plague because of what they did with the calf Aaron had made.

Exodus 33

MSG

NIV

1 GOD said to Moses: "Now go. Get on your way from here, you and the people you brought up from the land of Egypt. Head for the land which I

promised to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, saying 'I will give it to your descendants.'

- 1 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Leave this place, you and the people you brought up out of Egypt, and go up to the land I promised on oath to Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, saying, 'I will give it to your descendants.'
- 2 I will send an angel ahead of you and I'll drive out the Canaanites, Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites.
- 2 I will send an angel before you and drive out the Canaanites, Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites and Jebusites.
- 3 It's a land flowing with milk and honey. But I won't be with you in person--you're such a stubborn, hard-headed people!--lest I destroy you on the journey."
- 3 Go up to the land flowing with milk and honey. But I will not go with you, because you are a stiff-necked people and I might destroy you on the way."
- 4 When the people heard this harsh verdict, they were plunged into gloom and wore long faces. No one put on jewelry.
- 4 When the people heard these distressing words, they began to mourn and no one put on any ornaments.
- 5 GOD said to Moses, "Tell the Israelites, 'You're one hard-headed people. I couldn't stand being with you for even a moment--I'd destroy you. So take off all your jewelry until I figure out what to do with you.'"
- 5 For the LORD had said to Moses, "Tell the Israelites, 'You are a stiff-necked people. If I were to go with you even for a moment, I might destroy you. Now take off your ornaments and I will decide what to do with you.' "
- 6 So the Israelites stripped themselves of their jewelry from Mount Horeb on.
- 6 So the Israelites stripped off their ornaments at Mount Horeb.
- 7 Moses used to take the Tent and set it up outside the camp, some distance away. He called it the Tent of Meeting. Anyone who sought GOD would go to the Tent of Meeting outside the camp.
- 7 Now Moses used to take a tent and pitch it outside the camp some distance away, calling it the "tent of meeting." Anyone inquiring of the LORD would go to the tent of meeting outside the camp.

- 8 It went like this: When Moses would go to the Tent, all the people would stand at attention; each man would take his position at the entrance to his tent with his eyes on Moses until he entered the Tent;
- 8 And whenever Moses went out to the tent, all the people rose and stood at the entrances to their tents, watching Moses until he entered the tent.
- 9 whenever Moses entered the Tent, the Pillar of Cloud descended to the entrance to the Tent and GOD spoke with Moses.
- 9 As Moses went into the tent, the pillar of cloud would come down and stay at the entrance, while the LORD spoke with Moses.
- 10 All the people would see the Pillar of Cloud at the entrance to the Tent, stand at attention, and then bow down in worship, each man at the entrance to his tent.
- 10 Whenever the people saw the pillar of cloud standing at the entrance to the tent, they all stood and worshiped, each at the entrance to his tent.
- 11 And GOD spoke with Moses face-to-face, as neighbors speak to one another. When he would return to the camp, his attendant, the young man Joshua, stayed--he didn't leave the Tent.
- 11 The LORD would speak to Moses face to face, as a man speaks with his friend. Then Moses would return to the camp, but his young aide Joshua son of Nun did not leave the tent.
- 12 Moses said to GOD, "Look, you tell me, 'Lead this people,' but you don't let me know whom you're going to send with me. You tell me, 'I know you well and you are special to me.'
- 12 Moses said to the LORD, "You have been telling me, 'Lead these people,' but you have not let me know whom you will send with me. You have said, 'I know you by name and you have found favor with me.'
- 13 If I am so special to you, let me in on your plans. That way, I will continue being special to you. Don't forget, this is your people, your responsibility."
- 13 If you are pleased with me, teach me your ways so I may know you and continue to find favor with you. Remember that this nation is your people."
- 14 GOD said, "My presence will go with you. I'll see the journey to the end."
- 14 The LORD replied, "My Presence will go with you, and I will give you rest."

- 15 Moses said, "If your presence doesn't take the lead here, call this trip off right now.
- 15 Then Moses said to him, "If your Presence does not go with us, do not send us up from here.
- 16 How else will it be known that you're with me in this, with me and your people? Are you traveling with us or not? How else will we know that we're special, I and your people, among all other people on this planet Earth?"
- 16 How will anyone know that you are pleased with me and with your people unless you go with us? What else will distinguish me and your people from all the other people on the face of the earth?"
- 17 GOD said to Moses: "All right. Just as you say; this also I will do, for I know you well and you are special to me. I know you by name."
- 17 And the LORD said to Moses, "I will do the very thing you have asked, because I am pleased with you and I know you by name."
- 18 Moses said, "Please. Let me see your Glory."
- 18 Then Moses said, "Now show me your glory."
- 19 GOD said, "I will make my Goodness pass right in front of you; I'll call out the name, GOD, right before you. I'll treat well whomever I want to treat well and I'll be kind to whomever I want to be kind."
- 19 And the LORD said, "I will cause all my goodness to pass in front of you, and I will proclaim my name, the LORD, in your presence. I will have mercy on whom I will have mercy, and I will have compassion on whom I will have compassion.
- 20 GOD continued, "But you may not see my face. No one can see me and live."
- 20 But," he said, "you cannot see my face, for no one may see me and live."
- 21 GOD said, "Look, here is a place right beside me. Put yourself on this rock.
- 21 Then the LORD said, "There is a place near me where you may stand on a rock.
- 22 When my Glory passes by, I'll put you in the cleft of the rock and cover you with my hand until I've passed by.
- 22 When my glory passes by, I will put you in a cleft in the rock and cover you with my hand until I have passed by.

23 Then I'll take my hand away and you'll see my back. But you won't see my face."

23 Then I will remove my hand and you will see my back; but my face must not be seen."

Exodus 34

MSG

NIV

1 GOD spoke to Moses: "Cut out two tablets of stone just like the originals and engrave on them the words that were on the original tablets you smashed.

1 The LORD said to Moses, "Chisel out two stone tablets like the first ones, and I will write on them the words that were on the first tablets, which you broke.

2 Be ready in the morning to climb Mount Sinai and get set to meet me on top of the mountain.

2 Be ready in the morning, and then come up on Mount Sinai. Present yourself to me there on top of the mountain.

3 Not a soul is to go with you; the whole mountain must be clear of people, even animals--not even sheep or oxen can be grazing in front of the mountain."

3 No one is to come with you or be seen anywhere on the mountain; not even the flocks and herds may graze in front of the mountain."

4 So Moses cut two tablets of stone just like the originals. He got up early in the morning and climbed Mount Sinai as GOD had commanded him, carrying the two tablets of stone.

4 So Moses chiseled out two stone tablets like the first ones and went up Mount Sinai early in the morning, as the LORD had commanded him; and he carried the two stone tablets in his hands.

5 GOD descended in the cloud and took up his position there beside him and called out the name, GOD.

5 Then the LORD came down in the cloud and stood there with him and proclaimed his name, the LORD.

6 GOD passed in front of him and called out, "GOD, GOD, a God of mercy and grace, endlessly patient--so much love, so deeply true--

- 6 And he passed in front of Moses, proclaiming, "The LORD, the LORD, the compassionate and gracious God, slow to anger, abounding in love and faithfulness,
- 7 loyal in love for a thousand generations, forgiving iniquity, rebellion, and sin. Still, he doesn't ignore sin. He holds sons and grandsons responsible for a father's sins to the third and even fourth generation."
- 7 maintaining love to thousands, and forgiving wickedness, rebellion and sin. Yet he does not leave the guilty unpunished; he punishes the children and their children for the sin of the fathers to the third and fourth generation."
- 8 At once, Moses fell to the ground and worshiped,
- 8 Moses bowed to the ground at once and worshiped.
- 9 saying, "Please, O Master, if you see anything good in me, please Master, travel with us, hard-headed as these people are. Forgive our iniquity and sin. Own us, possess us."
- 9 O Lord, if I have found favor in your eyes, he said, "then let the Lord go with us. Although this is a stiff-necked people, forgive our wickedness and our sin, and take us as your inheritance."
- 10 And GOD said, "As of right now, I'm making a covenant with you: In full sight of your people I will work wonders that have never been created in all the Earth, in any nation. Then all the people with whom you're living will see how tremendous GOD's work is, the work I'll do for you.
- 10 Then the LORD said: "I am making a covenant with you. Before all your people I will do wonders never before done in any nation in all the world. The people you live among will see how awesome is the work that I, the LORD, will do for you.
- 11 Take careful note of all I command you today. I'm clearing your way by driving out Amorites, Canaanites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites.
- 11 Obey what I command you today. I will drive out before you the Amorites, Canaanites, Hittites, Perizzites, Hivites and Jebusites.
- 12 Stay vigilant. Don't let down your guard lest you make covenant with the people who live in the land that you are entering and they trip you up.

- 12 Be careful not to make a treaty with those who live in the land where you are going, or they will be a snare among you.
- 13 "Tear down their altars, smash their phallic pillars, chop down their fertility poles.
- 13 Break down their altars, smash their sacred stones and cut down their Asherah poles.
- 14 Don't worship any other god. GOD--his name is The-Jealous-One--is a jealous God.
- 14 Do not worship any other god, for the LORD, whose name is Jealous, is a jealous God.
- 15 Be careful that you don't make a covenant with the people who live in the land and take up with their sex-and-religion life, join them in meals at their altars,
- 15 Be careful not to make a treaty with those who live in the land; for when they prostitute themselves to their gods and sacrifice to them, they will invite you and you will eat their sacrifices.
- 16 marry your sons to their women, women who take up with any convenient god or goddess and will get your sons to do the same thing.
- 16 And when you choose some of their daughters as wives for your sons and those daughters prostitute themselves to their gods, they will lead your sons to do the same.
- 17 "Don't make molten gods for yourselves.
- 17 Do not make cast idols.
- 18 "Keep the Feast of Unraised Bread. Eat only unraised bread for seven days in the month of Abib--it was in the month of Abib that you came out of Egypt.
- 18 Celebrate the Feast of Unleavened Bread. For seven days eat bread made without yeast, as I commanded you. Do this at the appointed time in the month of Abib, for in that month you came out of Egypt.
- 19 "Every firstborn from the womb is mine, all the males of your herds, your firstborn oxen and sheep.
- 19 The first offspring of every womb belongs to me, including all the firstborn males of your livestock, whether from herd or flock.
- 20 "Redeem your firstborn donkey with a lamb. If you don't redeem it you must break its neck. "Redeem each of your firstborn sons. "No one is to show up in my presence empty-handed.

- 20 Redeem the firstborn donkey with a lamb, but if you do not redeem it, break its neck. Redeem all your firstborn sons. "No one is to appear before me empty-handed.
- 21 "Work six days and rest the seventh. Stop working even during plowing and harvesting.
- 21 Six days you shall labor, but on the seventh day you shall rest; even during the plowing season and harvest you must rest.
- 22 "Keep the Feast of Weeks with the first cutting of the wheat harvest, and the Feast of Ingathering at the turn of the year.
- 22 Celebrate the Feast of Weeks with the firstfruits of the wheat harvest, and the Feast of Ingathering at the turn of the year.
- 23 "All your men are to appear before the Master, the GOD of Israel, three times a year.
- 23 Three times a year all your men are to appear before the Sovereign LORD, the God of Israel.
- 24 You won't have to worry about your land when you appear before your GOD three times each year, for I will drive out the nations before you and give you plenty of land. Nobody's going to be hanging around plotting ways to get it from you.
- 24 I will drive out nations before you and enlarge your territory, and no one will covet your land when you go up three times each year to appear before the LORD your God.
- 25 "Don't mix the blood of my sacrifices with anything fermented. "Don't leave leftovers from the Passover Feast until morning.
- 25 Do not offer the blood of a sacrifice to me along with anything containing yeast, and do not let any of the sacrifice from the Passover Feast remain until morning.
- 26 "Bring the finest of the firstfruits of your produce to the house of your GOD. "Don't boil a kid in its mother's milk."
- 26 Bring the best of the firstfruits of your soil to the house of the LORD your God. Do not cook a young goat in its mother's milk."
- 27 GOD said to Moses: "Now write down these words, for by these words I've made a covenant with you and Israel."
- 27 Then the LORD said to Moses, "Write down these words, for in accordance with these words I have made a covenant with you and with Israel."

- 28 Moses was there with GOD forty days and forty nights. He didn't eat any food; he didn't drink any water. And he wrote on the tablets the words of the covenant, the Ten Words.
- 28 Moses was there with the LORD forty days and forty nights without eating bread or drinking water. And he wrote on the tablets the words of the covenant--the Ten Commandments.
- 29 When Moses came down from Mount Sinai carrying the two Tablets of The Testimony, he didn't know that the skin of his face glowed because he had been speaking with GOD.
- 29 When Moses came down from Mount Sinai with the two tablets of the Testimony in his hands, he was not aware that his face was radiant because he had spoken with the LORD.
- 30 Aaron and all the Israelites saw Moses, saw his radiant face, and held back, afraid to get close to him.
- 30 When Aaron and all the Israelites saw Moses, his face was radiant, and they were afraid to come near him.
- 31 Moses called out to them. Aaron and the leaders in the community came back and Moses talked with them.
- 31 But Moses called to them; so Aaron and all the leaders of the community came back to him, and he spoke to them.
- 32 Later all the Israelites came up to him and he passed on the commands, everything that GOD had told him on Mount Sinai.
- 32 Afterward all the Israelites came near him, and he gave them all the commands the LORD had given him on Mount Sinai.
- 33 When Moses finished speaking with them, he put a veil over his face,
- 33 When Moses finished speaking to them, he put a veil over his face.
- 34 but when he went into the presence of GOD to speak with him, he removed the veil until he came out. When he came out and told the Israelites what he had been commanded,
- 34 But whenever he entered the LORD's presence to speak with him, he removed the veil until he came out. And when he came out and told the Israelites what he had been commanded,
- 35 they would see Moses' face, its skin glowing, and then he would again put the veil on his face until he went back in to speak with GOD.
- 35 they saw that his face was radiant. Then Moses would put the veil back over his face until he went in to speak with the LORD.

Exodus 35

MSG

NIV

- 1 Moses spoke to the entire congregation of Israel, saying, "These are the things that GOD has commanded you to do:
- 1 Moses assembled the whole Israelite community and said to them, "These are the things the LORD has commanded you to do:
- 2 "Work six days, but the seventh day will be a holy rest day, GOD's holy rest day. Anyone who works on this day must be put to death.
- 2 For six days, work is to be done, but the seventh day shall be your holy day, a Sabbath of rest to the LORD. Whoever does any work on it must be put to death.
- 3 Don't light any fires in your homes on the Sabbath day."
- 3 Do not light a fire in any of your dwellings on the Sabbath day."
- 4 Moses spoke to the entire congregation of Israel, saying, "This is what GOD has commanded:
- 4 Moses said to the whole Israelite community, "This is what the LORD has commanded:
- 5 "Gather from among you an offering for GOD. Receive on GOD's behalf what everyone is willing to give as an offering: gold, silver, bronze;
- 5 From what you have, take an offering for the LORD. Everyone who is willing is to bring to the LORD an offering of gold, silver and bronze;
- 6 blue, purple, and scarlet material; fine linen; goats' hair;
- 6 blue, purple and scarlet yarn and fine linen; goat hair;
- 7 tanned rams' skins; dolphin skins; acacia wood;
- 7 ram skins dyed red and hides of sea cows; acacia wood;
- 8 lamp oil; spices for anointing oils and for fragrant incense;
- 8 olive oil for the light; spices for the anointing oil and for the fragrant incense;
- 9 onyx stones and other stones for setting in the Ephod and the Breastpiece.
- 9 and onyx stones and other gems to be mounted on the ephod and breastpiece.
- 10 "Come--all of you who have skills--come and make everything that GOD has commanded:

- 10 All who are skilled among you are to come and make everything the LORD has commanded:
- 11 The Dwelling with its tent and cover, its hooks, frames, crossbars, posts, and bases;
- 11 the tabernacle with its tent and its covering, clasps, frames, crossbars, posts and bases;
- 12 the Chest with its poles, the Atonement-Cover and veiling curtain;
- 12 the ark with its poles and the atonement cover and the curtain that shields it;
- 13 the Table with its poles and implements and the Bread of the Presence;
- 13 the table with its poles and all its articles and the bread of the Presence;
- 14 the Lampstand for giving light with its furnishings and lamps and the oil for lighting;
- 14 the lampstand that is for light with its accessories, lamps and oil for the light;
- 15 the Altar of Incense with its poles, the anointing oil, the fragrant incense; the screen for the door at the entrance to The Dwelling;
- 15 the altar of incense with its poles, the anointing oil and the fragrant incense; the curtain for the doorway at the entrance to the tabernacle;
- 16 the Altar of Whole-Burnt-Offering with its bronze grate and poles and all its implements; the Washbasin with its base;
- 16 the altar of burnt offering with its bronze grating, its poles and all its utensils; the bronze basin with its stand;
- 17 the tapestry hangings for the Courtyard with the posts and bases, the screen for the Courtyard gate;
- 17 the curtains of the courtyard with its posts and bases, and the curtain for the entrance to the courtyard;
- 18 the pegs for The Dwelling, the pegs for the Courtyard with their cords;
- 18 the tent pegs for the tabernacle and for the courtyard, and their ropes;
- 19 the official vestments for ministering in the Holy Place, the sacred vestments for Aaron the priest and for his sons serving as priests."
- 19 the woven garments worn for ministering in the sanctuary-- both the sacred garments for Aaron the priest and the garments for his sons when they serve as priests."
- 20 So everyone in the community of Israel left the presence of Moses.
- 20 Then the whole Israelite community withdrew from Moses' presence,

- 21 Then they came back, every one whose heart was roused, whose spirit was freely responsive, bringing offerings to GOD for building the Tent of Meeting, furnishing it for worship and making the holy vestments.
- 21 and everyone who was willing and whose heart moved him came and brought an offering to the LORD for the work on the Tent of Meeting, for all its service, and for the sacred garments.
- 22 They came, both men and women, all the willing spirits among them, offering brooches, earrings, rings, necklaces--anything made of gold--offering up their gold jewelry to GOD.
- 22 All who were willing, men and women alike, came and brought gold jewelry of all kinds: brooches, earrings, rings and ornaments. They all presented their gold as a wave offering to the LORD.
- 23 And anyone who had blue, purple, and scarlet fabrics; fine linen; goats' hair; tanned leather; and dolphin skins brought them.
- 23 Everyone who had blue, purple or scarlet yarn or fine linen, or goat hair, ram skins dyed red or hides of sea cows brought them.
- 24 Everyone who wanted to offer up silver or bronze as a gift to GOD brought it. Everyone who had acacia wood that could be used in the work, brought it.
- 24 Those presenting an offering of silver or bronze brought it as an offering to the LORD, and everyone who had acacia wood for any part of the work brought it.
- 25 All the women skilled at weaving brought their weavings of blue and purple and scarlet fabrics and their fine linens.
- 25 Every skilled woman spun with her hands and brought what she had spun--blue, purple or scarlet yarn or fine linen.
- 26 And all the women who were gifted in spinning, spun the goats' hair.
- 26 And all the women who were willing and had the skill spun the goat hair.
- 27 The leaders brought onyx and other precious stones for setting in the Ephod and the Breastpiece.
- 27 The leaders brought onyx stones and other gems to be mounted on the ephod and breastpiece.
- 28 They also brought spices and olive oil for lamp oil, anointing oil, and incense.

- 28 They also brought spices and olive oil for the light and for the anointing oil and for the fragrant incense.
- 29 Every man and woman in Israel whose heart moved them freely to bring something for the work that GOD through Moses had commanded them to make, brought it, a voluntary offering for GOD.
- 29 All the Israelite men and women who were willing brought to the LORD freewill offerings for all the work the LORD through Moses had commanded them to do.
- 30 Moses told the Israelites, "See, GOD has selected Bezalel son of Uri, son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah.
- 30 Then Moses said to the Israelites, "See, the LORD has chosen Bezalel son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah,
- 31 He's filled him with the Spirit of God, with skill, ability, and know-how for making all sorts of things,
- 31 and he has filled him with the Spirit of God, with skill, ability and knowledge in all kinds of crafts--
- 32 to design and work in gold, silver, and bronze;
- 32 to make artistic designs for work in gold, silver and bronze,
- 33 to carve stones and set them; to carve wood, working in every kind of skilled craft.
- 33 to cut and set stones, to work in wood and to engage in all kinds of artistic craftsmanship.
- 34 And he's also made him a teacher, he and Oholiab son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan.
- 34 And he has given both him and Oholiab son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan, the ability to teach others.
- 35 He's gifted them with the know-how needed for carving, designing, weaving, and embroidering in blue, purple, and scarlet fabrics, and in fine linen. They can make anything and design anything.
- 35 He has filled them with skill to do all kinds of work as craftsmen, designers, embroiderers in blue, purple and scarlet yarn and fine linen, and weavers--all of them master craftsmen and designers.

Exodus 36

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Bezalel and Oholiab, along with everyone whom GOD has given the skill and know-how for making everything involved in the worship of the Sanctuary as commanded by GOD, are to start to work."
- 1 So Bezalel, Oholiab and every skilled person to whom the LORD has given skill and ability to know how to carry out all the work of constructing the sanctuary are to do the work just as the LORD has commanded."
- 2 Moses summoned Bezalel and Oholiab along with all whom GOD had gifted with the ability to work skillfully with their hands. The men were eager to get started and engage in the work.
- 2 Then Moses summoned Bezalel and Oholiab and every skilled person to whom the LORD had given ability and who was willing to come and do the work.
- 3 They took from Moses all the offerings that the Israelites had brought for the work of constructing the Sanctuary. The people kept on bringing in their freewill offerings, morning after morning.
- 3 They received from Moses all the offerings the Israelites had brought to carry out the work of constructing the sanctuary. And the people continued to bring freewill offerings morning after morning.
- 4 All the artisans who were at work making everything involved in constructing the Sanctuary came, one after another,
- 4 So all the skilled craftsmen who were doing all the work on the sanctuary left their work
- 5 to Moses, saying, "The people are bringing more than enough for doing this work that GOD has commanded us to do!"
- 5 and said to Moses, "The people are bringing more than enough for doing the work the LORD commanded to be done."
- 6 So Moses sent out orders through the camp: "Men! Women! No more offerings for the building of the Sanctuary!" The people were ordered to stop bringing offerings!
- 6 Then Moses gave an order and they sent this word throughout the camp: "No man or woman is to make anything else as an offering for the sanctuary." And so the people were restrained from bringing more,
- 7 There was plenty of material for all the work to be done. Enough and more than enough.

- 7 because what they already had was more than enough to do all the work.
- 8 Then all the skilled artisans on The Dwelling made ten tapestries of fine twisted linen and blue, purple, and scarlet fabric with an angel-cherubim design worked into the material.
- 8 All the skilled men among the workmen made the tabernacle with ten curtains of finely twisted linen and blue, purple and scarlet yarn, with cherubim worked into them by a skilled craftsman.
- 9 Each panel of tapestry was forty-six feet long and six feet wide.
- 9 All the curtains were the same size--twenty-eight cubits long and four cubits wide.
- 10 Five of the panels were joined together, and then the other five.
- 10 They joined five of the curtains together and did the same with the other five.
- 11 Loops of blue were made along the edge of the outside panel of the first set, and the same on the outside panel of the second set.
- 11 Then they made loops of blue material along the edge of the end curtain in one set, and the same was done with the end curtain in the other set.
- 12 They made fifty loops on each panel, with the loops opposite each other.
- 12 They also made fifty loops on one curtain and fifty loops on the end curtain of the other set, with the loops opposite each other.
- 13 Then they made fifty gold clasps and joined the tapestries together so that The Dwelling was one whole.
- 13 Then they made fifty gold clasps and used them to fasten the two sets of curtains together so that the tabernacle was a unit.
- 14 Next they made tapestries of woven goat hair for a tent that would cover The Dwelling. They made eleven panels of these tapestries.
- 14 They made curtains of goat hair for the tent over the tabernacle--eleven altogether.
- 15 The length of each panel was forty-five feet long and six feet wide.
- 15 All eleven curtains were the same size--thirty cubits long and four cubits wide.
- 16 They joined five of the panels together, and then the other six,
- 16 They joined five of the curtains into one set and the other six into another set.
- 17 by making fifty loops along the edge of the end panel and fifty loops along the edge of the joining panel,

17 Then they made fifty loops along the edge of the end curtain in one set and also along the edge of the end curtain in the other set.
18 then making fifty clasps of bronze, connecting the clasps to the loops, bringing the tent together.
18 They made fifty bronze clasps to fasten the tent together as a unit.
19 They finished it off by covering the tapestries with tanned rams' skins dyed red, and covered that with dolphin skins.
19 Then they made for the tent a covering of ram skins dyed red, and over that a covering of hides of sea cows.
20 They framed The Dwelling with vertical planks of acacia wood,
20 They made upright frames of acacia wood for the tabernacle.
21 each section of frame fifteen feet long and two and a quarter feet wide,
21 Each frame was ten cubits long and a cubit and a half wide,
22 with two pegs for securing them. They made all the frames identical:
22 with two projections set parallel to each other. They made all the frames of the tabernacle in this way.
23 twenty frames for the south side,
23 They made twenty frames for the south side of the tabernacle
24 with forty silver sockets to receive the two tenons from each of the twenty frames;
24 and made forty silver bases to go under them--two bases for each frame, one under each projection.
25 they repeated that construction on the north side of The Dwelling.
25 For the other side, the north side of the tabernacle, they made twenty frames
26 (SEE 36:25)
26 and forty silver bases--two under each frame.
27 For the rear of The Dwelling facing west, they made six frames,
27 They made six frames for the far end, that is, the west end of the tabernacle,
28 with two additional frames for the rear corners.
28 and two frames were made for the corners of the tabernacle at the far end.
29 Both of the two corner frames were double in thickness from top to bottom and fit into a single ring--

- 29 At these two corners the frames were double from the bottom all the way to the top and fitted into a single ring; both were made alike.
- 30 eight frames altogether with sixteen sockets of silver, two under each frame.
- 30 So there were eight frames and sixteen silver bases--two under each frame.
- 31 They made crossbars of acacia wood, five for the frames on one side of The Dwelling,
- 31 They also made crossbars of acacia wood: five for the frames on one side of the tabernacle,
- 32 five for the other side, and five for the back side facing west.
- 32 five for those on the other side, and five for the frames on the west, at the far end of the tabernacle.
- 33 The center crossbar ran from end to end halfway up the frames.
- 33 They made the center crossbar so that it extended from end to end at the middle of the frames.
- 34 They covered the frames with a veneer of gold, made gold rings to hold the crossbars, and covered the crossbars with a veneer of gold.
- 34 They overlaid the frames with gold and made gold rings to hold the crossbars. They also overlaid the crossbars with gold.
- 35 They made the curtain of blue, purple, and scarlet material and fine twisted linen. They wove a design of angel-cherubim into it.
- 35 They made the curtain of blue, purple and scarlet yarn and finely twisted linen, with cherubim worked into it by a skilled craftsman.
- 36 They made four posts of acacia wood, covered them with a veneer of gold, and cast four silver bases for them.
- 36 They made four posts of acacia wood for it and overlaid them with gold. They made gold hooks for them and cast their four silver bases.
- 37 They made a screen for the door of the tent, woven from blue, purple, and scarlet material and fine twisted linen with embroidery.
- 37 For the entrance to the tent they made a curtain of blue, purple and scarlet yarn and finely twisted linen--the work of an embroiderer;
- 38 They framed the weaving with five poles of acacia wood covered with a veneer of gold, and made gold hooks to hang the weaving and five bronze bases for the poles.

38 and they made five posts with hooks for them. They overlaid the tops of the posts and their bands with gold and made their five bases of bronze.

Exodus 37

MSG

NIV

- 1 Bezalel made the Chest using acacia wood: He made it three and three-quarters feet long and two and a quarter feet wide and deep.
- 1 Bezalel made the ark of acacia wood--two and a half cubits long, a cubit and a half wide, and a cubit and a half high.
- 2 He covered it inside and out with a veneer of pure gold and made a molding of gold all around it.
- 2 He overlaid it with pure gold, both inside and out, and made a gold molding around it.
- 3 He cast four gold rings and attached them to its four feet, two rings on one side and two rings on the other.
- 3 He cast four gold rings for it and fastened them to its four feet, with two rings on one side and two rings on the other.
- 4 He made poles from acacia wood, covered them with a veneer of gold,
- 4 Then he made poles of acacia wood and overlaid them with gold.
- 5 and inserted the poles for carrying the Chest into the rings on the sides.
- 5 And he inserted the poles into the rings on the sides of the ark to carry it.
- 6 Next he made a lid of pure gold for the Chest, an Atonement-Cover, three and three-quarters feet long and two and a quarter feet wide.
- 6 He made the atonement cover of pure gold--two and a half cubits long and a cubit and a half wide.
- 7 He sculpted two winged angel-cherubim out of hammered gold for the ends of the Atonement-Cover,
- 7 Then he made two cherubim out of hammered gold at the ends of the cover.
- 8 one angel at one end, one angel at the other. He made them of one piece with the Atonement-Cover.
- 8 He made one cherub on one end and the second cherub on the other; at the two ends he made them of one piece with the cover.

- 9 The angels had outstretched wings and appeared to hover over the Atonement-Cover, facing one another but looking down on the Atonement-Cover.
- 9 The cherubim had their wings spread upward, overshadowing the cover with them. The cherubim faced each other, looking toward the cover.
- 10 He made the Table from acacia wood. He made it three feet long, one and a half feet wide and two and a quarter feet high.
- 10 They made the table of acacia wood--two cubits long, a cubit wide, and a cubit and a half high.
- 11 He covered it with a veneer of pure gold and made a molding of gold all around it.
- 11 Then they overlaid it with pure gold and made a gold molding around it.
- 12 He made a border a handbreadth wide all around it and a rim of gold for the border.
- 12 They also made around it a rim a handbreadth wide and put a gold molding on the rim.
- 13 He cast four rings of gold for it and attached the rings to the four legs
- 13 They cast four gold rings for the table and fastened them to the four corners, where the four legs were.
- 14 parallel to the table top. They will serve as holders for the poles used to carry the Table.
- 14 The rings were put close to the rim to hold the poles used in carrying the table.
- 15 He made the poles of acacia wood and covered them with a veneer of gold. They will be used to carry the Table.
- 15 The poles for carrying the table were made of acacia wood and were overlaid with gold.
- 16 Out of pure gold he made the utensils for the Table: its plates, bowls, jars, and jugs used for pouring.
- 16 And they made from pure gold the articles for the table--its plates and dishes and bowls and its pitchers for the pouring out of drink offerings.
- 17 He made a Lampstand of pure hammered gold, making its stem and branches, cups, calyxes, and petals all of one piece.
- 17 They made the lampstand of pure gold and hammered it out, base and shaft; its flowerlike cups, buds and blossoms were of one piece with it.
- 18 It had six branches, three from one side and three from the other;

- 18 Six branches extended from the sides of the lampstand--three on one side and three on the other.
- 19 three cups shaped like almond blossoms with calyxes and petals on one branch, three on the next, and so on--the same for all six branches.
- 19 Three cups shaped like almond flowers with buds and blossoms were on one branch, three on the next branch and the same for all six branches extending from the lampstand.
- 20 On the main stem of the Lampstand, there were four cups shaped like almonds, with calyxes and petals,
- 20 And on the lampstand were four cups shaped like almond flowers with buds and blossoms.
- 21 a calyx extending from under each pair of the six branches.
- 21 One bud was under the first pair of branches extending from the lampstand, a second bud under the second pair, and a third bud under the third pair--six branches in all.
- 22 The entire Lampstand with its calyxes and stems was fashioned from one piece of hammered pure gold.
- 22 The buds and the branches were all of one piece with the lampstand, hammered out of pure gold.
- 23 He made seven of these lamps with their candle snuffers, all out of pure gold.
- 23 They made its seven lamps, as well as its wick trimmers and trays, of pure gold.
- 24 He used a seventy-five-pound brick of pure gold to make the Lampstand and its accessories.
- 24 They made the lampstand and all its accessories from one talent of pure gold.
- 25 He made an Altar for burning incense from acacia wood. He made it a foot and a half square and three feet high, with its horns of one piece with it.
- 25 They made the altar of incense out of acacia wood. It was square, a cubit long and a cubit wide, and two cubits high--its horns of one piece with it.
- 26 He covered it with a veneer of pure gold, its top, sides, and horns, and made a gold molding around it

- 26 They overlaid the top and all the sides and the horns with pure gold, and made a gold molding around it.
- 27 with two rings of gold beneath the molding. He placed the rings on the two opposing sides to serve as holders for poles by which it will be carried.
- 27 They made two gold rings below the molding--two on opposite sides--to hold the poles used to carry it.
- 28 He made the poles of acacia wood and covered them with a veneer of gold.
- 28 They made the poles of acacia wood and overlaid them with gold.
- 29 He also prepared with the art of a perfumer the holy anointing oil and the pure aromatic incense.
- 29 They also made the sacred anointing oil and the pure, fragrant incense--the work of a perfumer.

Exodus 38

MSG

NIV

- 1 He made the Altar of Whole-Burnt-Offering from acacia wood. He made it seven and a half feet square and four and a half feet high.
- 1 They built the altar of burnt offering of acacia wood, three cubits high; it was square, five cubits long and five cubits wide.
- 2 He made horns at each of the four corners. The horns were made of one piece with the Altar and covered with a veneer of bronze.
- 2 They made a horn at each of the four corners, so that the horns and the altar were of one piece, and they overlaid the altar with bronze.
- 3 He made from bronze all the utensils for the Altar: the buckets for removing the ashes, shovels, basins, forks, and fire pans.
- 3 They made all its utensils of bronze--its pots, shovels, sprinkling bowls, meat forks and firepans.
- 4 He made a grate of bronze mesh under the ledge halfway up the Altar.
- 4 They made a grating for the altar, a bronze network, to be under its ledge, halfway up the altar.
- 5 He cast four rings at each of the four corners of the bronze grating to hold the poles.

- 5 They cast bronze rings to hold the poles for the four corners of the bronze grating.
- 6 He made the poles of acacia wood and covered them with a veneer of bronze.
- 6 They made the poles of acacia wood and overlaid them with bronze.
- 7 He inserted the poles through the rings on the two sides of the Altar for carrying it. The Altar was made out of boards; it was hollow.
- 7 They inserted the poles into the rings so they would be on the sides of the altar for carrying it. They made it hollow, out of boards.
- 8 He made the Bronze Washbasin and its bronze stand from the mirrors of the women's work group who were assigned to serve at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting.
- 8 They made the bronze basin and its bronze stand from the mirrors of the women who served at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting.
- 9 And he made the Courtyard. On the south side the hangings for the Courtyard, woven from fine twisted linen, were 150 feet long,
- 9 Next they made the courtyard. The south side was a hundred cubits long and had curtains of finely twisted linen,
- 10 with their twenty posts and twenty bronze bases, and fastening hooks and bands of silver.
- 10 with twenty posts and twenty bronze bases, and with silver hooks and bands on the posts.
- 11 The north side was exactly the same.
- 11 The north side was also a hundred cubits long and had twenty posts and twenty bronze bases, with silver hooks and bands on the posts.
- 12 The west end of the Courtyard had seventy-five feet of hangings with ten posts and bases, and fastening hooks and bands of silver.
- 12 The west end was fifty cubits wide and had curtains, with ten posts and ten bases, with silver hooks and bands on the posts.
- 13 Across the seventy-five feet at the front, or east end,
- 13 The east end, toward the sunrise, was also fifty cubits wide.
- 14 were twenty-two and a half feet of hangings, with their three posts and bases on one side
- 14 Curtains fifteen cubits long were on one side of the entrance, with three posts and three bases,
- 15 and the same for the other side.

- 15 and curtains fifteen cubits long were on the other side of the entrance to the courtyard, with three posts and three bases.
- 16 All the hangings around the Courtyard were of fine twisted linen.
- 16 All the curtains around the courtyard were of finely twisted linen.
- 17 The bases for the posts were bronze and the fastening hooks and bands on the posts were of silver. The posts of the Courtyard were both capped and banded with silver.
- 17 The bases for the posts were bronze. The hooks and bands on the posts were silver, and their tops were overlaid with silver; so all the posts of the courtyard had silver bands.
- 18 The screen at the door of the Courtyard was embroidered in blue, purple, and scarlet fabric with fine twisted linen. It was thirty feet long and seven and a half feet high, matching the hangings of the Courtyard.
- 18 The curtain for the entrance to the courtyard was of blue, purple and scarlet yarn and finely twisted linen--the work of an embroiderer. It was twenty cubits long and, like the curtains of the courtyard, five cubits high,
- 19 There were four posts with bases of bronze and fastening hooks of silver; they were capped and banded in silver
- 19 with four posts and four bronze bases. Their hooks and bands were silver, and their tops were overlaid with silver.
- 20 . All the pegs for The Dwelling and the Courtyard were made of bronze.
- 20 All the tent pegs of the tabernacle and of the surrounding courtyard were bronze.
- 21 This is an inventory of The Dwelling that housed The Testimony drawn up by order of Moses for the work of the Levites under Ithamar, son of Aaron the priest.
- 21 These are the amounts of the materials used for the tabernacle, the tabernacle of the Testimony, which were recorded at Moses' command by the Levites under the direction of Ithamar son of Aaron, the priest.
- 22 Bezalel, the son of Uri, son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah, made everything that GOD had commanded Moses.
- 22 (Bezalel son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe of Judah, made everything the LORD commanded Moses;
- 23 Working with Bezalel was Oholiab, the son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan, an artisan, designer, and embroiderer in blue, purple, and scarlet

fabrics and fine linen.

23 with him was Oholiab son of Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan--a craftsman and designer, and an embroiderer in blue, purple and scarlet yarn and fine linen.)

24 Gold. The total amount of gold used in construction of the Sanctuary, all of it contributed freely, weighed out at 1,900 pounds according to the Sanctuary standard.

24 The total amount of the gold from the wave offering used for all the work on the sanctuary was 29 talents and 730 shekels, according to the sanctuary shekel.

25 Silver. The silver from those in the community who were registered in the census came to 6,437 pounds according to the Sanctuary standard--

25 The silver obtained from those of the community who were counted in the census was 100 talents and 1,775 shekels, according to the sanctuary shekel--

26 that amounted to a beka, or half-shekel, for every registered person aged twenty and over, a total of 603,550 men.

26 one beka per person, that is, half a shekel, according to the sanctuary shekel, from everyone who had crossed over to those counted, twenty years old or more, a total of 603,550 men.

27 They used the three and one-quarter tons of silver to cast the bases for the Sanctuary and for the hangings, one hundred bases at sixty-four pounds each.

27 The 100 talents of silver were used to cast the bases for the sanctuary and for the curtain--100 bases from the 100 talents, one talent for each base.

28 They used the remaining thirty-seven pounds to make the connecting hooks on the posts, and the caps and bands for the posts.

28 They used the 1,775 shekels to make the hooks for the posts, to overlay the tops of the posts, and to make their bands.

29 Bronze. The bronze that was brought in weighed 4,522 pounds.

29 The bronze from the wave offering was 70 talents and 2,400 shekels.

30 It was used to make the door of the Tent of Meeting, the Bronze Altar with its bronze grating, all the utensils of the Altar,

30 They used it to make the bases for the entrance to the Tent of Meeting, the bronze altar with its bronze grating and all its utensils,

- 31 the bases around the Courtyard, the bases for the gate of the Courtyard, and all the pegs for The Dwelling and the Courtyard.
- 31 the bases for the surrounding courtyard and those for its entrance and all the tent pegs for the tabernacle and those for the surrounding courtyard.

Exodus 39

MSG

NIV

- 1 Vestments. Using the blue, purple, and scarlet fabrics, they made the woven vestments for ministering in the Sanctuary. Also they made the sacred vestments for Aaron, as GOD had commanded Moses.
- 1 From the blue, purple and scarlet yarn they made woven garments for ministering in the sanctuary. They also made sacred garments for Aaron, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 2 Ephod. They made the Ephod using gold and blue, purple, and scarlet fabrics and finely twisted linen.
- 2 They made the ephod of gold, and of blue, purple and scarlet yarn, and of finely twisted linen.
- 3 They hammered out gold leaf and sliced it into threads that were then worked into designs in the blue, purple, and scarlet fabric and fine linen.
- 3 They hammered out thin sheets of gold and cut strands to be worked into the blue, purple and scarlet yarn and fine linen--the work of a skilled craftsman.
- 4 They made shoulder pieces fastened at the two ends.
- 4 They made shoulder pieces for the ephod, which were attached to two of its corners, so it could be fastened.
- 5 The decorated band was made of the same material--gold, blue, purple, and scarlet material, and of fine twisted linen--and of one piece with it, just as GOD had commanded Moses.
- 5 Its skillfully woven waistband was like it--of one piece with the ephod and made with gold, and with blue, purple and scarlet yarn, and with finely twisted linen, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 6 They mounted the onyx stones in a setting of filigreed gold and engraved the names of the sons of Israel on them,

- 6 They mounted the onyx stones in gold filigree settings and engraved them like a seal with the names of the sons of Israel.
- 7 then fastened them on the shoulder pieces of the Ephod as memorial stones for the Israelites, just as GOD had commanded Moses.
- 7 Then they fastened them on the shoulder pieces of the ephod as memorial stones for the sons of Israel, as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 8 Breastpiece. They made a Breastpiece designed like the Ephod from gold, blue, purple, and scarlet material and fine twisted linen.
- 8 They fashioned the breastpiece--the work of a skilled craftsman. They made it like the ephod: of gold, and of blue, purple and scarlet yarn, and of finely twisted linen.
- 9 Doubled, the Breastpiece was nine inches square.
- 9 It was square--a span long and a span wide--and folded double.
- 10 They mounted four rows of precious gemstones on it. First row: carnelian, topaz, emerald.
- 10 Then they mounted four rows of precious stones on it. In the first row there was a ruby, a topaz and a beryl;
- 11 Second row: ruby, sapphire, crystal.
- 11 in the second row a turquoise, a sapphire and an emerald;
- 12 Third row: jacinth, agate, amethyst.
- 12 in the third row a jacinth, an agate and an amethyst;
- 13 Fourth row: beryl, onyx, jasper. The stones were mounted in a gold filigree.
- 13 in the fourth row a chrysolite, an onyx and a jasper. They were mounted in gold filigree settings.
- 14 The twelve stones corresponded to the names of the sons of Israel, twelve names engraved as on a seal, one for each of the twelve tribes.
- 14 There were twelve stones, one for each of the names of the sons of Israel, each engraved like a seal with the name of one of the twelve tribes.
- 15 They made braided chains of pure gold for the Breastpiece, like cords.
- 15 For the breastpiece they made braided chains of pure gold, like a rope.
- 16 They made two settings of gold filigree and two rings of gold, put the two rings at the two ends of the Breastpiece,
- 16 They made two gold filigree settings and two gold rings, and fastened the rings to two of the corners of the breastpiece.

- 17 and fastened the two ends of the cords to the two rings at the end of the Breastpiece.
- 17 They fastened the two gold chains to the rings at the corners of the breastpiece,
- 18 Then they fastened the cords to the settings of filigree, attaching them to the shoulder pieces of the Ephod in front.
- 18 and the other ends of the chains to the two settings, attaching them to the shoulder pieces of the ephod at the front.
- 19 Then they made two rings of gold and fastened them to the two ends of the Breastpiece on its inside edge facing the Ephod.
- 19 They made two gold rings and attached them to the other two corners of the breastpiece on the inside edge next to the ephod.
- 20 They made two more rings of gold and fastened them in the front of the Ephod to the lower part of the two shoulder pieces, near the seam above the decorated band of the Ephod.
- 20 Then they made two more gold rings and attached them to the bottom of the shoulder pieces on the front of the ephod, close to the seam just above the waistband of the ephod.
- 21 The Breastpiece was fastened by running a cord of blue through its rings to the rings of the Ephod so that it rested secure on the decorated band of the Ephod and wouldn't come loose, just as GOD had commanded Moses.
- 21 They tied the rings of the breastpiece to the rings of the ephod with blue cord, connecting it to the waistband so that the breastpiece would not swing out from the ephod--as the LORD commanded Moses.
- 22 Robe. They made the robe for the Ephod entirely of blue.
- 22 They made the robe of the ephod entirely of blue cloth-- the work of a weaver--
- 23 The opening of the robe at the center was like a collar, the edge hemmed so that it wouldn't tear.
- 23 with an opening in the center of the robe like the opening of a collar, and a band around this opening, so that it would not tear.
- 24 On the hem of the robe they made pomegranates of blue, purple, and scarlet material and fine twisted linen.
- 24 They made pomegranates of blue, purple and scarlet yarn and finely twisted linen around the hem of the robe.

25 They also made bells of pure gold and alternated the bells and pomegranates--

25 And they made bells of pure gold and attached them around the hem between the pomegranates.

26 a bell and a pomegranate, a bell and a pomegranate--all around the hem of the robe that was worn for ministering, just as GOD had commanded Moses.

26 The bells and pomegranates alternated around the hem of the robe to be worn for ministering, as the LORD commanded Moses.

27 They also made the tunics of fine linen, the work of a weaver, for Aaron and his sons,

27 For Aaron and his sons, they made tunics of fine linen-- the work of a weaver--

28 the turban of fine linen, the linen hats, the linen underwear made of fine twisted linen,

28 and the turban of fine linen, the linen headbands and the undergarments of finely twisted linen.

29 and sashes of fine twisted linen, blue, purple, and scarlet material and embroidered, just as GOD had commanded Moses.

29 The sash was of finely twisted linen and blue, purple and scarlet yarn--the work of an embroiderer--as the LORD commanded Moses.

30 They made the plate, the sacred crown, of pure gold and engraved on it as on a seal: "Holy to GOD."

30 They made the plate, the sacred diadem, out of pure gold and engraved on it, like an inscription on a seal: HOLY TO THE LORD.

31 They attached a blue cord to it and fastened it to the turban, just as GOD had commanded Moses.

31 Then they fastened a blue cord to it to attach it to the turban, as the LORD commanded Moses.

32 That completed the work of The Dwelling, the Tent of Meeting. The People of Israel did what GOD had commanded Moses. They did it all.

32 So all the work on the tabernacle, the Tent of Meeting, was completed. The Israelites did everything just as the LORD commanded Moses.

33 They presented The Dwelling to Moses, the Tent and all its furnishings: fastening hooks frames crossbars posts bases

33 Then they brought the tabernacle to Moses: the tent and all its furnishings, its clasps, frames, crossbars, posts and bases;
34 tenting of tanned ram skins tenting of dolphin skins veil of the screen
34 the covering of ram skins dyed red, the covering of hides of sea cows and the shielding curtain;
35 Chest of The Testimony with its poles and Atonement-Cover
35 the ark of the Testimony with its poles and the atonement cover;
36 Table with its utensils and the Bread of the Presence
36 the table with all its articles and the bread of the Presence;
37 Lampstand of pure gold and its lamps all fitted out and all its utensils and the oil for the light
37 the pure gold lampstand with its row of lamps and all its accessories, and the oil for the light;
38 Gold Altar anointing oil fragrant incense screen for the entrance to the Tent
38 the gold altar, the anointing oil, the fragrant incense, and the curtain for the entrance to the tent;
39 Bronze Altar with its bronze grate its poles and all its utensils Washbasin and its base
39 the bronze altar with its bronze grating, its poles and all its utensils; the basin with its stand;
40 hangings for the Courtyard its posts and bases screen for the gate of the Courtyard its cords and its pegs utensils for ministry in The Dwelling, the Tent of Meeting
40 the curtains of the courtyard with its posts and bases, and the curtain for the entrance to the courtyard; the ropes and tent pegs for the courtyard; all the furnishings for the tabernacle, the Tent of Meeting;
41 woven vestments for ministering in the Sanctuary sacred vestments for Aaron the priest, and his sons when serving as priests
41 and the woven garments worn for ministering in the sanctuary, both the sacred garments for Aaron the priest and the garments for his sons when serving as priests.
42 The Israelites completed all the work, just as GOD had commanded.
42 The Israelites had done all the work just as the LORD had commanded Moses.

43 Moses saw that they had done all the work and done it exactly as GOD had commanded. Moses blessed them.

43 Moses inspected the work and saw that they had done it just as the LORD had commanded. So Moses blessed them.

Exodus 40

MSG

NIV

1 GOD spoke to Moses:

1 Then the LORD said to Moses:

2 "On the first day of the first month, set up The Dwelling, the Tent of Meeting.

2 Set up the tabernacle, the Tent of Meeting, on the first day of the first month.

3 Place the Chest of The Testimony in it and screen the Chest with the curtain.

3 Place the ark of the Testimony in it and shield the ark with the curtain.

4 "Bring in the Table and set it, arranging its Lampstand and lamps.

4 Bring in the table and set out what belongs on it. Then bring in the lampstand and set up its lamps.

5 "Place the Gold Altar of Incense before the Chest of The Testimony and hang the curtain at the door of The Dwelling.

5 Place the gold altar of incense in front of the ark of the Testimony and put the curtain at the entrance to the tabernacle.

6 "Place the Altar of Whole-Burnt-Offering at the door of The Dwelling, the Tent of Meeting.

6 Place the altar of burnt offering in front of the entrance to the tabernacle, the Tent of Meeting;

7 "Place the Washbasin between the Tent of Meeting and the Altar and fill it with water.

7 place the basin between the Tent of Meeting and the altar and put water in it.

8 "Set up the Courtyard on all sides and hang the curtain at the entrance to the Courtyard.

- 8 Set up the courtyard around it and put the curtain at the entrance to the courtyard.
- 9 "Then take the anointing oil and anoint The Dwelling and everything in it; consecrate it and all its furnishings so that it becomes holy.
- 9 Take the anointing oil and anoint the tabernacle and everything in it; consecrate it and all its furnishings, and it will be holy.
- 10 Anoint the Altar of Whole-Burnt-Offering and all its utensils, consecrating the Altar so that it is completely holy.
- 10 Then anoint the altar of burnt offering and all its utensils; consecrate the altar, and it will be most holy.
- 11 Anoint the Washbasin and its base: consecrate it.
- 11 Anoint the basin and its stand and consecrate them.
- 12 "Finally, bring Aaron and his sons to the entrance of the Tent of Meeting and wash them with water.
- 12 Bring Aaron and his sons to the entrance to the Tent of Meeting and wash them with water.
- 13 Dress Aaron in the sacred vestments. Anoint him. Consecrate him to serve me as priest.
- 13 Then dress Aaron in the sacred garments, anoint him and consecrate him so he may serve me as priest.
- 14 Bring his sons and put tunics on them.
- 14 Bring his sons and dress them in tunics.
- 15 Anoint them, just as you anointed their father, to serve me as priests. Their anointing will bring them into a perpetual priesthood, down through the generations."
- 15 Anoint them just as you anointed their father, so they may serve me as priests. Their anointing will be to a priesthood that will continue for all generations to come."
- 16 Moses did everything GOD commanded. He did it all.
- 16 Moses did everything just as the LORD commanded him.
- 17 On the first day of the first month of the second year, The Dwelling was set up.
- 17 So the tabernacle was set up on the first day of the first month in the second year.
- 18 Moses set it up: He laid its bases, erected the frames, placed the crossbars, set the posts,

18 When Moses set up the tabernacle, he put the bases in place, erected the frames, inserted the crossbars and set up the posts.

19 spread the tent over The Dwelling, and put the covering over the tent, just as GOD had commanded Moses.

19 Then he spread the tent over the tabernacle and put the covering over the tent, as the LORD commanded him.

20 He placed The Testimony in the Chest, inserted the poles for carrying the Chest, and placed the lid, the Atonement-Cover, on it.

20 He took the Testimony and placed it in the ark, attached the poles to the ark and put the atonement cover over it.

21 He brought the Chest into The Dwelling and set up the curtain, screening off the Chest of The Testimony, just as GOD had commanded Moses.

21 Then he brought the ark into the tabernacle and hung the shielding curtain and shielded the ark of the Testimony, as the LORD commanded him.

22 He placed the Table in the Tent of Meeting on the north side of The Dwelling, outside the curtain,

22 Moses placed the table in the Tent of Meeting on the north side of the tabernacle outside the curtain

23 and arranged the Bread there before GOD, just as GOD had commanded him.

23 and set out the bread on it before the LORD, as the LORD commanded him.

24 He placed the Lampstand in the Tent of Meeting opposite the Table on the south side of The Dwelling

24 He placed the lampstand in the Tent of Meeting opposite the table on the south side of the tabernacle

25 and set up the lamps before GOD, just as GOD had commanded him.

25 and set up the lamps before the LORD, as the LORD commanded him.

26 Moses placed the Gold Altar in the Tent of Meeting in front of the curtain

26 Moses placed the gold altar in the Tent of Meeting in front of the curtain

27 and burned fragrant incense on it, just as GOD had commanded him.

27 and burned fragrant incense on it, as the LORD commanded him.

28 He placed the screen at the entrance to The Dwelling.

28 Then he put up the curtain at the entrance to the tabernacle.

29 He set the Altar of Whole-Burnt-Offering at the door of The Dwelling, the Tent of Meeting, and offered up the Whole-Burnt-Offerings and the Grain-Offerings, just as GOD had commanded Moses.

29 He set the altar of burnt offering near the entrance to the tabernacle, the Tent of Meeting, and offered on it burnt offerings and grain offerings, as the LORD commanded him.

30 He placed the Washbasin between the Tent of Meeting and the Altar, and filled it with water for washing.

30 He placed the basin between the Tent of Meeting and the altar and put water in it for washing,

31 Moses and Aaron and his sons washed their hands and feet there.

31 and Moses and Aaron and his sons used it to wash their hands and feet.

32 When they entered the Tent of Meeting and when they served at the Altar, they washed, just as GOD had commanded Moses.

32 They washed whenever they entered the Tent of Meeting or approached the altar, as the LORD commanded Moses.

33 Finally, he erected the Courtyard all around The Dwelling and the Altar, and put up the screen for the Courtyard entrance. Moses finished the work.

33 Then Moses set up the courtyard around the tabernacle and altar and put up the curtain at the entrance to the courtyard. And so Moses finished the work.

34 The Cloud covered the Tent of Meeting, and the Glory of GOD filled The Dwelling.

34 Then the cloud covered the Tent of Meeting, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.

35 Moses couldn't enter the Tent of Meeting because the Cloud was upon it, and the Glory of GOD filled The Dwelling.

35 Moses could not enter the Tent of Meeting because the cloud had settled upon it, and the glory of the LORD filled the tabernacle.

36 Whenever the Cloud lifted from The Dwelling, the People of Israel set out on their travels,

36 In all the travels of the Israelites, whenever the cloud lifted from above the tabernacle, they would set out;

37 but if the Cloud did not lift, they wouldn't set out until it did lift.

37 but if the cloud did not lift, they did not set out--until the day it lifted.

38 The Cloud of GOD was over The Dwelling during the day and the fire was in it at night, visible to all the Israelites in all their travels.

38 So the cloud of the LORD was over the tabernacle by day, and fire was in the cloud by night, in the sight of all the house of Israel during all their travels.